

The Application of the Speculative Method to Sacred History

R. Nielsen

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The Application
of the Speculative Method to
Sacred History.

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Translator's Preface

[The beginning of the Translator's Preface is missing in the copy used: a whole leaf — two pages — is not included in the scan, and the Preface therefore begins in the middle of a sentence.]

meet us in this work, will surely lead the reader to overlook that deficiency. If the application of the speculative method to theology, in general as in a single sphere, is to be defended in truth, this must first and foremost be done through a thorough opposition, conducted from within, against the middle-way system of critical, moderate rationalism; and this is precisely a chief merit of this work. And while *Dr. Martensen*, in his splendid work “The Autonomy of Human Self-Consciousness”, has from another side carried through a thorough opposition against subjective rationalism and, by proving that Schleiermacher too was a subjective rationalist, has also extended his opposition to Schleiermacher's system, but, owing to the particular economy of his treatise, only briefly touched on objective rationalism, Prof. Nielsen in his second Part, “Sacred History”, has carried the dialectical polemic on into the territory of objective rationalism (of panlogism, of Straußianism), and, in the same way as with subjective rationalism, has endeavored from within to show the logical insufficiency of this system. He has thus opened the struggle between “speculative orthodoxy” and panlogism, which necessarily had to arise among us, just as in Germany, and has carried it onto the only proper ground for such a struggle, namely science.

I take the liberty of referring those who may wish to have a complete survey of the whole train of thought of the work to the review of it that is found in “*Fædrelandet*” No. 329, 1840.

As regards the translation itself, I feel full well how much, particularly with respect

to purity of style and to uniformity of spelling, I stand in need of the lenient judgment of the kind reader; might I only hope, by a true rendering of the author's thoughts and of his light, lively style, to reconcile the reader to those deficiencies!

Copenhagen, the 24th of January 1842.

B. C. Bøggild.

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Errata

Errata,

which the reader is asked to correct before reading the book.

Page	4 line	17: naar den read: naar det
—	4 —	26: de maa read de maae
—	7 —	11: Subfaction read Subtraction
—	10 —	3 from bottom: almindeligt, read almindelige
—	12 —	1 from bottom: gaee ind read slaee ind
—	15 —	4 from bottom: under et nyt read under Skikkelse af et nyt
—	41 —	1: næsten read næste
—	42 —	13: fast read faste
—	48 —	6: Virken read Viden
—	71 —	12: <i>Scholastisme</i> read <i>Scholasticisme</i>
—	89 —	5: κεκαυτερισμένους read κεκαυτερισμένους
—	132 Note. 1:	das Mystische read das Mythische

First Part.

The Relation between Philosophy and History, Considered in General.

§ 1.

The Relation between the A Posteriori and the A Priori.

The old saying “*medium tenere beati!*” is heard not only where drinking is concerned, but also where studying is concerned; and so everyday understanding often recommends this rule when it speaks of the relation between history and philosophy. “One must praise history, it is said, for all thinking would be empty and nebulous if the things themselves were not traced out with the greatest diligence and accuracy; — but philosophy is no less necessary, for the historian needs logical rules, lest the treasury of knowledge become a formless mass, a *rudis indigestaque moles*. Prudence therefore bids that one lean too far neither to the one side nor to the other, so as not to confound the a priori and the a posteriori with each other.”

But however plausible and reassuring this well-meant and friendly admonition to sobriety and moderation may seem at first glance, on closer examination of the matter it nevertheless proves empty and wavering. For if thinking is to be adjusted [2] to experience, and experience conversely corrected by thinking, what then is the touchstone of truth, where then is the supreme judge?

Experience in and for itself cannot occupy the judge’s seat; for in order to prove its title to be the judge of truth, it would have to adduce grounds drawn from thinking; it

would thus, precisely in striving for the office of judge, forfeit it; — thinking, on the other hand, even if it wished to renounce the office of judge, could not do so except by itself judging; the final judgment therefore belongs to thinking; on its truth everything rests. But the investigation of the truth of our thinking necessarily calls forth the question how thinking arises at all, and in answering this we then meet the opposed theories of the sensualists and the idealists.

When the sensualists lay down the principle that everything is owed to impressions from the existence outside us, that the human soul is a “*tabula rasa*”, and that the universal concepts therefore arise by an abstraction, it follows from this that thought is only a shadow, while reality itself must be placed in empirical objects existing outside us. With them, then, the *a posteriori* is the main thing. — But precisely in thus overlooking the moment of subjectivity, they fall prey to subjectivity; they do indeed assert that the human soul is a *tabula rasa*, but since absolute passivity cannot take place, there must necessarily be a subjective moment present in all the subjective impressions. One must thus proceed from special sensations in order to arrive at the universal concepts; but since this cannot take place, because the phenomena of experience are particular, one is forced to acquiesce in subjective assumptions, since one has denied the universal concepts absolute validity. Herein, then, lies the [3] contradiction, that subjectivity on the one hand counts for so little that on the other hand it counts for everything.

If it is thus evident that one is caught up in subjective opinions whenever one attempts to comprehend objective things, these opinions are nonetheless universally valid from the standpoint of the subject. The universal concepts, therefore, cannot derive from an external experience, but must lie in subjectivity as such.

But when all phenomena are apprehended by means of subjectivity and led back to subjectively necessary and universal forms of concept, the universal concepts are, as a consequence, necessary to every experience, so that the opposition between subject and object is not an opposition between thinking and experience, which flow dialectically over into each other, but an opposition between the phenomena and pure, absolute objectivity, the *thing in itself*.

If one now investigates what the thing in itself really is, it will turn out that it has

only a thought existence. For one cannot experience the thing in itself, since every experience rests on subjective concepts; this alone, then, does one know about the thing in itself, that such a thing is. I think not only my thoughts, but I also think that something is outside my thoughts; one must then seek this its being outside, not outside, but within the bounds of subjective thinking.

It is by this path that the idealists have developed their theory, in that they teach that the whole world is posited by the human I itself, although the I was not conscious of this act; the a priori then takes first place, for the hidden I itself is precisely this *prius*.

The science of our time has, however, fully proved that idealism becomes nihilism when it denies objective existence and seeks reality only in its own self-activity. For [4] if all objects are only representations and images formed by the human soul, what then is this I itself? If it is regarded as a resting reality and not as an empty image, must not the same be able to be said of the other objects? And if, on the other hand, one refers the existence of the I too to representation, one surely declares the I itself a representation formed by the I. — The result, then, is an infinite series of representations of representations.

When, therefore, subjective idealism makes the nature of thinking the object of a thorough consideration, it is forced to assume an objective existence and to concede that activity and representation could not be, were there not something that gave activity a substantial content.

The human I thus becomes, precisely at the moment when it rejoices in the feeling of perfect independence, the prey of an alien power, and plunges into the abyss of emptiness just when it arrogates to itself divine majesty.

But precisely this fall of subjectivity prepares salvation and makes a true reconciliation possible between subject and object. For if sensualism proves that there is not a single point in the life of the soul that cannot be led back to an impression from the existence outside us, and if subjective idealism on the other hand demonstrates the uninterrupted self-activity of the human soul, then it follows in truth that thinking and objective existence cannot belong to two opposite spheres; they must then be of the same nature, and we cannot then, as the saying goes, *know ourselves* (γνᾶθι

σεαυτὸν), except through the cognition of the objective phenomena.

Perhaps someone will object that we thus abolish the important difference between individual subjectivity and universal objectivity; but this objection proceeds only from [5] an abstract and external view of the matter: for if we consider only the external world, it cannot occur to us to deny that every human being has his subjectivity and everywhere finds himself surrounded by objects that set themselves up as barriers against him; but the matter must be seen from the inner side, and one will then observe that every subjectivity owes its formation to objectivity, in that the subjective and objective moments will be seen in their mutual, infinite transition into each other. — It is precisely the nature of objectivity everywhere to develop subjectivity, as it is the aim of subjectivity to cultivate objectivity. Therefore everything must be sought *a posteriori* as well as *a priori*, referred to thinking as well as to experience. And from this standpoint, therefore, the remarks so often made, that the cultivation of empirical knowledge would be the restriction of philosophy, or that the flourishing of philosophy would entail the neglect of empirical knowledge, do not hold either.

From this it follows, then, that the middle way in the realm of the sciences deserves no particular recommendation, and that, much rather, every endeavor to keep to the middle way is mediocrity.

§ 2.

Subjective Faith and Speculative Logic.

It is one thing to recognize the identity of phenomena and thoughts, of empirical knowledge and philosophy, and another to subject the moments of this identity to such a scientific analysis that the identity is seen in its mediation, seen through and comprehended from all sides. What matters here, then, is to find the right starting point.

In immediate practical life the relation of the objects met with everywhere to [6] individual subjectivity has the greatest influence; everything is apprehended by the inner and outer senses, and one defends everything just as one has apprehended it.

The one holds to the truth of his statement because his immediate apprehension of the truth happens just now to be so constituted; the other, for the very same reason, defends the exact opposite. They contradict each other, and both lay their hands on their hearts in confirmation of their opposed statements. — What, now, is to move us to respect their assurances? Everything depends on subjective mood. By not granting such statements our credence, therefore, we offend not only against truth in general, but also against the person of the human being who proclaims the truth. Subjective faith constitutes the strength and, so to speak, the marrow of every human being's life, and cannot be changed without a complete change in the human spirit itself; if we therefore deprive anyone of his subjective faith, we deprive him of life. — It is therefore not to be wondered at if human beings, in defense of their various faiths, not only dispute and contradict one another, but also, as life shows by so many examples, contend and fight with a vehemence as though the struggle were for altar and hearth.

But as subjective faith kindles the flames of this war, so it also has the means to quench them. And had it none such, no contradiction could have arisen at all, for in order to disagree there must necessarily be something in which one agrees. An absolute disagreement cannot take place, for if the one did not understand the other, each of them would have been left to, and could only have spoken with, himself; in order to be able to dispute, one must then necessarily have a medium in which one can meet. And what is this medium other than precisely thinking itself? All must think when they wish to explain their faith; but what is thinking other than seeking [7] out and uncovering the universal in the particular, unity in multiplicity, identity in opposition?

Precisely for this reason one must not lose heart amid all these disputes; there always remains in the disagreement a certain agreement. When the debate has risen to the highest point of contradiction, when you hear the asserter's "*it is true!*" over against the denier's "*it is false!*", you must nevertheless not, say the logicians, give up hope of being able to reconcile the agitated minds. This can be done by an easy subtraction: just take away the conflicting predicates "*true*" and "*false*;" there then remains only that "*it is*", and if you promise to draw from it many, and indeed important, consequences for both parties, the combatants will lay down their arms and willingly

concede that the thing about which they are contending, is.

When, then, this debate, this negation, this σκέψις has advanced to that abstract concept, so trivialized in our time, *being*, whose denial contains its affirmation, it must necessarily cease. It is here, then, that the absolute starting point of true knowledge must be sought. But it is quite another question whether, by this beaten path, namely by pursuing the universal concepts, we can succeed in fully uncovering the fullness of life from which we set out.

When the dialectical stimulus lying in the concept *being* had been discovered by Hegel, so that logicians were now no longer compelled to remain standing in the tautology of universality, like the Eleatics of old, who continually repeated their τὸ ἓν τὸ πᾶν, many thought that the fullness of time had come. They then liked to speak of the wondrous poverty and extraordinary richness of this concept, since it showed itself at once as the simplest, in that all preconceived opinions had been cast down [8] into the abyss of abstraction, and yet at the same time enclosed all the treasures of wisdom within itself; in its bosom, they thought, the present and the future, God and the world, lay hidden; in a few words, they extolled the concept *being* as the egg that in truth enclosed the universe within itself, and only needed to be brooded and hatched by a proper speculative philosopher in order to let the true shape of things emerge from it. — Under this star was born logical mysticism, which, as befits a true mysticism, bade farewell to life and its actuality.

But we seem to contradict ourselves when we assert that the absolute starting point must be placed in the concept of being, and at the same time declare that the analysis of the logical concepts cannot lead to the realities themselves; for if we cannot reach the goal by this path, we must seek a new starting point elsewhere; we cannot then rest content with the beginning once made, but must begin afresh once more, or perhaps several times.

One ought therefore to observe in what relation the universal concepts stand to the particular objects. The common opinion about this relation is that the logical concepts are hollow forms into which the solid objects are poured; if the forms are taken away, there remains only a jumbled mass of objects; if the solid objects are taken away, the pure concepts will, in the world as in the logical system, show themselves only as an

artificial net. And this separation between the universal concepts and the particular objects has a true as well as a false side. It is true insofar as it is maintained that the form of the thing is not the thing itself, and that the thing is not the form; for no one can deny that the form is precisely the negation of the thing and thus its limitation; and how, too, should the universal, the abstractly thought, be able to be something particular? By the force of their own contradiction, therefore, these moments exclude [9] each other. But the separation of the moments of existence is fundamentally false if by it is meant that the things and the forms could have subsisted separated from each other, had not God united them by a special act of will. On closer consideration of the matter this will easily become evident.

We are fully right to see in the concept *being* the universal in its highest abstraction, but logic teaches us at the same time that *being* cannot be thought, nor can it be, if there is not something whose predicate it is; in order that *being* itself can be, more than pure being must be given. The pure universal thus splits into two moments, of which the one is pure *being* itself, the other this *something* of which being is predicated; for if these two moments are confounded with each other, being becomes the same as being; but such a tautological being cannot be. But if they are kept in their opposition to each other, and we call the one *A*, the other *B*, it turns out that what is not in *B* must be in *A*, or — in order that the universal can be, the particular moment must necessarily be present as well.

The universal, then, spreads out on all sides into particular objects. But while it has now become clear that the universal is not present anywhere where the particular is not also, nothing has yet been said about this particular moment except that it must be sought everywhere; in other words — the particular moment is here apprehended not in a particular, but in a universal way. What is lacking, then, is the truly particular, and we must then investigate where this is to be found.

The truly particular is like a fixed and immovable point which, considered in and for itself, cannot be referred to a universal concept, but must be capable of being definitely pointed out, so that one can say of it: “it is here! there! thus!” The particular [10] moment is a positive and real moment, which stands firm by itself and must be sought in the realm of empirical knowledge. For the ontological concepts to be grasped,

therefore, a certain empirical knowledge is required, since all such concepts rest on a negation of empirical objects, just as the concept of an object cannot be understood either, except with regard to the determinate empirical object.

But the image of this or that object is presented to the soul only in order that what is common to all, not what is peculiar and particular to the individual objects, may be held fast; the special object is thus called forth by means of representation in order that the particular, that is, the *empirical* moment may be negated. Since empirical knowledge is thus appropriated only in a negative way, there can be no question here of knowledge of the individual phenomena; but when the speculative cognition of the logical concepts has been fully developed, the result is that the principle of all existence is the absolute Idea, or, in other words, that the whole series of real phenomena is rational, so that objective and concrete reason can no more be grasped except through the cognition of the empirical objects than anything can exist if it conflicts with the nature of absolute reason. — But in this way we then leave logic, whose concepts are both universal and necessary, and turn to empirical knowledge, whose realm encompasses the particular and the contingent.

[11]

§ 3.

Vulgar Empirical Knowledge.

Vulgar empirical knowledge, in which everything is particular and contingent, is rightly regarded as the negation of logic; for while in logic we proceeded by denying the senses all authority, we are now to give up the investigation of the universal concepts and appeal to the testimony of the senses. — But here we seem to come into contradiction with ourselves; for we have asserted that there is no difference between the a priori and the a posteriori, and must now nevertheless admit that a difference does obtain. For we know, even before we have apprehended the individual objects through the senses, that there can be nothing that conflicts with the ontological laws; everything that ontology teaches can thus be predicted of the objects, and this is precisely the a priori; but how things are constituted on their particular side, that we

can learn only by experiencing the things themselves, and this is the a posteriori.

But this contradiction finds its resolution in the fact that the difference concerns only the phenomena as such, while the identity is to be sought in their *essential* existence. Now if these were absolutely opposed to each other, the knot could hardly be untied; but everyone knows that thinking does not let the phenomena, as they are immediately apprehended by means of the senses, vanish into essence in order that they should remain sublated, but precisely in order that they should be restored again out of essence, as out of their true ground.

Speculative logic teaches that essence itself is revealed in the phenomena, so that these are the phenomena of essential existence, but cannot be held fast in and for themselves; and experience shows that even those who with the greatest zeal devote themselves to empirical knowledge come up, contrary to their own expectation, [12] against essence in grasping at the phenomenon. What joy, for instance, would he have who delights in contemplating the rays of the sun, if these all at once, as with a single stroke, met his eye, so that for sheer gazing he could think nothing and feel nothing? What joy or fruit would he have who, like one bereft of his senses, were held so fast in beholding the individual things that he understood nothing although he heard with his ears, apprehended nothing although he saw with his eyes? Therefore we also see everywhere in history, where a certain immediate view predominates and where philosophy has not yet been developed into an independent science, not the crude and barbaric empiricism that extinguishes and supplants all thinking, but the freest interplay of the moments of empirical knowledge and of philosophy¹⁾. Now, to be sure, there comes in here the important question whether these or those occurrences really took place as they are narrated, and one then seeks to get clear about how far the external phenomena have reality, as though the historical inquirer had no other task than that of proving that they are reliable and have corresponded to their description; but one must then take careful note that the phenomena are not present when one thus seeks them most eagerly, and that it is much rather their absence that makes us feel the want of them, so that there can be no question here of a sensuous beholding of present objects. Indeed, were the objects that the empiricists search for so eagerly already

¹⁾Cf. Herodotus and others.

uncovered, precisely delimited and brought forth into the light, and had they thus already attained their wish, then either their activity of understanding would have to
[13] cease, or they would have to strike out on another path for their inquiry. We must then consider more closely the distance that lies between the external phenomena and the consciousness of the spectator, in order to see how the identity can be restored.

The observer, after all, cannot render the phenomenon that has presented itself to his gaze in the same immediate way in which it presented itself to him; he cannot describe it by pointing at it; if he therefore wishes to hold it fast, he is compelled to pass a judgment on it. But what is passing a judgment other than referring the phenomenon to the totality of the universal concepts and comparing it with the totality of the experiences already made, in order thereby to assign it its proper place?

But here again are two moments that must be carefully distinguished from each other; for what place the phenomenon is to occupy depends on the one hand on its own nature, on the other hand on the subjective peculiarity of the observer; and since the phenomenon makes itself known to first consideration only in an abstract way (§ 2), it will perhaps come to occupy far too slight a place in his consciousness, because its true properties have not clearly come forward to him. Therefore the way in which the phenomena are apprehended is wavering and indeterminate, and one must use the greatest caution lest an error creep in.

But this difficulty grows when one considers that it is only the fewest phenomena that present themselves immediately to the observer, while in most cases one must see with others' eyes, hear with others' ears, rely on others' understanding and power of judgment. Since the one observer most often observes the phenomenon only with the other's eye, one must therefore at the same time take care to remove scrupulously whatever untruth may have mixed itself into the apprehension of the thing from one
[14] subjectivity or another, and this is exceedingly difficult. For it is not merely another's mistake that one has to fear; but since the reporter may not only have apprehended the object incorrectly, but may also — by virtue of reflection's capacity deliberately to present the same object in a different way — have distorted his judgment according to arbitrary considerations, one must also fear a deliberate falsification. One must therefore investigate the author's credibility; and since the author's credibility depends

on the way in which he describes the thing, while this conversely depends on the author's credibility, one is forced to seek out another, more general and surer criterion of truth. We are thus forced to take refuge in the ontological concepts, and in the conditions without which the thing cannot take place, in order to remove absurdities and separate history from fable. Thus we do not believe someone who would tell us of round squares, and are just as unwilling to believe the Decretals of Isidore when they report that Victor, who was bishop of Rome in the 2nd century, wrote a letter to his dear friend Theophilus of Alexandria, although the latter lived in the 4th century. — Now if we do not wish to remain standing at the trivial tautological rule that the impossible is impossible, we must determine more precisely, with the help of experience, what the concept of possibility means. We then compare what we know from an earlier experience with what experience subsequently presents to us, so that the former shall not be sublated by, or be found to conflict with, the latter.

Here, then, one reasons by means of analogy and induction, in that one accepts as true the phenomena that usually take place, but conceives suspicion against those that are unusual. On the one side, then, one considers the sum of the phenomena, on the other the particular phenomenon, for the judgment of which the former are to furnish the standard. But within the likeness there nevertheless always remains an [15] unlikeness; otherwise nothing new would have been added; it is therefore not the side of the phenomenon from which it resembles the preceding ones that comes into consideration, but it is what is unlike in it that makes a judgment necessary. — But the judgment grounded on a phenomenon's likeness or unlikeness to a preceding one is again external and uncertain; for because the object in question has often taken place before, it does not follow that the same or a similar one took place at the time when it is narrated to have taken place; and because a phenomenon has seldom or never taken place before, it likewise does not follow that the narrative of its having taken place must necessarily be false. — One must then take into consideration the greater or lesser degree of probability, and this consideration now carries the spectator over into the relative territory of subjective conjectures (*calcul des probabilités*). For where there can be talk of probability, there truth must both be present and not be present. It cannot be present; for if one did not lack it, why would one speak of its

external shape, and not far rather of truth itself; and were it not present at all, how could it occur to one to seek it, how could one speak of a probability? The matter, then, seems to stand as follows. Since one recognizes that it is fruitless to compare the individual phenomena with one another, one compares them with the reality that stands above them all, i.e. with truth itself. Now in thus abstracting truth from the phenomena, one sets truth over against the phenomena in an external way, so that it itself emerges in the shape of a new, though more excellent, phenomenon, — for of the immanent relation according to which truth permeates and develops all the [16] phenomena, so that it makes them forms for itself, there can be no talk from this standpoint. But if one now asks how, in the great series of phenomena, one can grasp truth's own phenomenon, one will find that, objectively considered, it lies hidden behind the other phenomena as behind a veil, while, subjectively considered, it dawns upon the spectator's consciousness through an anticipation and happy presentiment, as a standard by which he judges the individual phenomena. But since each spectator now has his own opinion about truth, these different opinions must also be compared with one another; and if one cannot then have absolute unanimity, one must at least have unanimity in the majority, if one is to arrive at any result; and so the general and public opinion that holds sway in the representation of the age that has given the spectator his consciousness will be the deciding factor in the matter. — And yet we have here still no firm standpoint for our judgment; for everyone knows how different opinions have been, in the course of time, about what is possible or impossible. Thus, to name one example, the realm of possibility had a far greater extent in the Middle Ages than in the time in which we now live. We see, then, that the further we pursue truth along this path, the further it withdraws from us.

And lest anyone now object to us that we are merely seeking difficulties in a sophistical manner where in actuality there are none, we must again and again recall that we are far from failing to appreciate the sincere search for truth, the sense for it and the knowledge of it, by which many of the warmest adherents of this method distinguish themselves; — for it is one thing to judge the cognition of truth that one author or another possesses, another to investigate the method by which he believes [17] he has acquired it. We do not censure the comparison of the individual moments in

and for itself; for we know full well that truth does not come in so palpable a manner (μετὰ παρατηρήσεως) that one could say: “Lo, here or there it is!” and we do not think that the observation of the individual phenomena may be neglected, for if the individual parts are taken away, the totality vanishes as well. But unless we are much mistaken, the error of this method lies in this, that although the individual phenomena are set up side by side in an external manner, without permeating one another or being permeated by truth, one nevertheless believes that by comparing all the individual phenomena one can grasp truth, while it is yet as clear as day that by this comparison one can arrive at no other result than this: to see everywhere, not truth itself, but only its semblance, its alteration. — It goes with him who seeks truth along this path as it goes with one who in a foreign land seeks out a friend, enters the inn, hears that he was there a short time ago but has just this moment gone aboard, and now, when he has come down to the harbor, learns that he is already out at sea. For if one seeks truth in subjectivity, criticism refers one to objectivity; if one then wishes to see the objective, universal idea of truth, it analyzes the individual phenomena, and if the talk now turns again to this or that phenomenon, it appeals to the totality.

From this it follows, then, that the rules of criticism are either so general that they are entirely empty of content, or that, when they determine something about the more particular relations, they are of such a nature that one can say of them what most often holds of German grammar in its rules on the gender of nouns: “*quot regulae, tot exceptiones!*”

[18]

§ 4.

Transition to Speculative Empirical Knowledge.

The external phenomena, then, must no longer be considered in and for themselves; what remains of them is only the subjective opinions about them, and in the sum of these truth must then be placed. — Thus, even if I do not know whether I have judged this or that external phenomenon correctly or not, I know at least that I have judged in this or that way; and even if it is not certain whether this or that event

took place or not, this much is certain, that it has been told and must therefore also have been thought by someone; and though I may doubt that miracles took place in antiquity, I cannot doubt that the ancients believed in miracles. It is thus not the historian's business to investigate whether the individual things took place in the determinate external manner in which they are reported; but, just as no deed can do itself, but every deed presupposes someone who does it, so too no occurrence can be held fast in and for itself, but must be able to serve to give us a true representation of the standpoint of the person to whom it is attributed. Hereby, then, the external phenomena are entirely negated. — Spiritual life appears in sensuous phenomena; the phenomena express the essential opinions of the soul, but the essential opinions are thoughts; it should therefore be the historian's task to demonstrate the shape of spirit at the different times, the education of the peoples, reflected in the deeds of the human race as in a bright mirror. — If one considers the matter from this side, one arrives at the standpoint of a, so to speak, historical idealism, which is at least right in [19] this, that thinking and reason seek themselves in history. It is, however, so far from the case that this idealism denies vulgar empirical knowledge all authority, that it rather confirms it, only with the difference that the two moments of history, the real and the ideal, are not taken as though their union were to take place in an immediate manner, the account of the historical data being seasoned with accidental subjective remarks, and a spiritual stream welling up from the dark spring of pious feelings to water the barren fields of earthly existence. While idealism rejects the holding fast of the external phenomena as such and reaches for the inner essence, it recognizes at the same time that it is only through the phenomena that access stands open to spiritual existence. It would indeed also be impossible to form a picture of the spirit of individual human beings or of a whole people if one knew only the bare events and did not also know the names of the persons acting, or if, to name an example, Caesar's deeds were attributed to Pompey; impossible to know and understand the activity of spirit if one did not have exact knowledge of what external barriers it had removed, what raw masses of nature it had worked, what objective spheres it had formed¹⁾. It is,

¹⁾ *Avec le monde a commencé une guerre, qui doit finir avec le monde, et pas avant; celle de l'homme contre la nature, de l'esprit contre la matière, de la liberté contre la fatalité. L'histoire n'est pas autre chose, que le récit de cette indéterminable lutte. Michelet: Introduction a l'histoire universelle.*

for example, of the greatest importance for the right understanding of the spirit of the Jewish people whether we assume that the many miracles attributed to Jehovah actually took place in external nature, or whether we take them merely to be products of the subjective representations of pious individuals. True history, then, does indeed [20] require that one seek objective reason in the external phenomena, but at the same time that the mass of phenomena be completely consumed by the fire of thought, in order to rise like a phoenix from its ashes. But the labor that this thorough negation and the ensuing restoration of the phenomena entail seems to most historians difficult and hazardous. They do not, indeed, excuse themselves from thinking; they are rather quite willing to weave the web of their reflections into the warp of the reported facts; for this way of thinking seems to be the safest: should it namely now happen that their subjective reflections were found uncertain and inconsistent, they still always have the reported facts left; to these they can then in any case hold and say: "The fact itself is here, and it is at least beyond doubt that it occurred at that time or in that place." If, on the other hand, one wishes to leave the empirical phenomena and to turn one's attention to the objective reason in them as such, they turn their backs on us for fear of what they call philosophical preconceived opinions and arbitrary a priori construction.

If it were now really the case that, after having negated all the phenomena, we turned to this or that system in order to apply certain predetermined formulas to them arbitrarily and in an external manner, it would in actuality be fruitless for the philosopher to spend time and diligence on history. But this is not how things stand with philosophical negation. — When in everyday speech one names the concept nothing or negation, one usually thinks of a, so to speak, empty nullity; but it is easy to see that there are as many negations as there are modifications of positive things, since negation is indeed the thing's own limitation or determination. If, for example, someone were merely to say: "*I have nothing*," one would not properly understand [21] him; if, on the other hand, he said: "*before I had wealth, now I have nothing!*", one would easily grasp both what this nothing stood in opposition to and of what nature it itself was, and understand that the man had become poor. — Daily life itself also recommends this way of inferring. Thus when we judge the actions of our intimate friends, we

do not stop at their actions as mere external phenomena, but always look at the same time to the frame of mind, the causes and grounds, from which they proceeded. Every action has its ground, but the ground is the negation of the phenomenon; the phenomenon thus indicates the negative of itself. — That is also precisely why all the proofs of God's existence stand and fall with the truth of speculative negation; for each of them aims precisely at negating a general phenomenon, as the world immediately presents itself to us, and leads us through its negation to God's essence, from which the negated phenomenon is then restored anew.

Thus if we first consider the cosmological proof, we meet in it first the observation of an empirical phenomenon: "*Lo, the world is!*"; but negation steps in at once, as one infers from the contingency of the world: "*If the world is considered in and for itself, it is nothing, has no substance in itself*", and only now follows the conclusion: "*The absolute substance is God,*" whereupon the phenomenon is restored again: "*From God's substance the world receives its substance.*"

From this it is also seen that the essence itself is determined according to the phenomenon that is negated; for while in the cosmological proof we negated the world's substance and through this negation came to God's substance, we would, had [22] we negated another phenomenon, e.g. human thought, which is to take place in the ontological proof, have obtained another form of God's existence. Here too one can clearly see how dangerous it is to stop on the middle way, something we have already once sought to prove.

The point of the ontological proof can be stated thus: "*I think, therefore God exists.*" The phenomenon immediately present is thus human thought and self-consciousness. The absolute negation reads, then, as follows: "*Human thought is nothing of itself*"; if this negation is carried through, the following conclusion emerges: "*Absolute thought, i.e. God's self-consciousness, is*", and now the phenomenon is restored: "*If God's thought and the absolute divine self-consciousness is, then the existence of human thought can also be explained from it.*"

But when Kant now undertook to reject the ontological proof, his separation between a real and an ideal existence, on which his whole argument rested, led him precisely onto the bad standpoint of the middle way. "That man is and can think," he

said, “is a fact; if this is held fast, it is perfectly certain that man is able, as often as he wishes, to refrain from thinking God just as well as to think him.” He thus holds fast to this empirical phenomenon, lets no true negation come about, and so easily makes the proof waver, since the divine thought cannot be placed in an external manner beside human thought. Had he, on the other hand, raised the question whence this human capacity to think had also arisen, his idealism would have separated out the raw, undigested phenomena from human consciousness, and he might then perhaps [23] have come to acknowledge and develop the ontological proof properly.

Just as the bad middle way has had the most harmful influence on theology, so it has also had it, and will continue to have it, on history, until a true negation of the phenomena is carried through. For it is with historical ideas quite as with the theological ideas we have just discussed. One should first of all strive, through the negation of the reported facts, to penetrate to the principle itself. If, e.g., someone wishes to comprehend the spirit of Catholicism, he must first, as far as possible, consider the sum of the phenomena belonging to it, in order to arrive through their negation at the Catholic principle; for if he does not do this, he must involuntarily snatch a principle out of the air, and then it will constantly collide with the historical phenomena. Just as, then, in the cosmological proof the phenomenon of the world was first given in its immediacy and contingency, so too the general phenomenon of Catholicism must first be observed in its contingency before one can penetrate to its ground. And once one has thus appropriated the principle, one must again remember well that it must not be held fast in its abstraction, but that also in its particular development it can be properly appropriated only through the negation of the particular phenomena, so that thought never abandons the historical object. — There are, then, two errors against which one must especially guard: on the one hand, that one not develop purely abstract concepts from such a general principle while neglecting the particular phenomena; on the other, that one not transfer the general principle in an external manner onto all the details. For there is nothing in the study of history that more betrays the bad middle way than applying the general categories: freedom, despotism, hierarchy, or others like them, as clothing for the [24] individual events, so that one does not develop these concepts themselves but only fills

them in with external details. If, e.g., the concept of the hierarchy is to be developed historically, one cannot know from an abstract definition that it changes in the course of the centuries, and if one asks about its individual changes, then it is not enough to enumerate the individual actions or utterances of Irenaeus, Cyprian, and Gregory. — There are, then, three moments to be distinguished in such a development: the first is the general concept of the hierarchy; the second, the individual actions and events that are expressions of the hierarchical idea; the third, the identity of both moments. And what is meant by this identity is not hard to understand; for if one asks why an application of the universal to the individual should take place, then, unless we are mistaken, no other answer can be given than that the general concept, the idea, develops in a peculiar manner in the individual phenomena, so that the concept of the hierarchy appears in a different manner in Gregory the Seventh than in Irenaeus. But from this it evidently follows that Gregory's undertakings can be considered from a twofold side: considered from the one side, they are peculiar, so that we cannot find them again anywhere else in history, and, as such, they constitute the fixed and unshakable moment we spoke of before; but on the other side they reveal in a particular manner the idea of the hierarchy and are thus everywhere permeated by the general moment. The individual moments have thus received the stamp of the universal, while conversely the universal idea has obtained its peculiar modifications. — But from this there emerges the third moment, which can neither be determined [25] as a single object of experience by a "thus or so!" nor be said to be an empty general concept, applicable in any way whatever, but must be called the historical limitation of the concept. And such empirical knowledge, which fully corresponds to and agrees with the underlying reason, is rightly called speculative.

§ 5.

The Relation between Vulgar and Speculative Empirical Knowledge.

The difference between vulgar and speculative empirical knowledge is striking: the former observes the phenomena from without, the latter from within, and, while

the former heaps together a multitude of contingent phenomena, the latter, on the other hand, depicts the organic connection of the moments in such a way that no phenomenon comes into consideration except insofar as it is recognized to have proceeded from the idea itself. Hence the range of the individual phenomena can be far greater in vulgar empirical knowledge than in speculative; for in vulgar empirical knowledge we ask only whether the events took place, not *why* they took place, and therefore have only the task of observing and determining exactly as many individual phenomena as possible. The works of the critics offer many examples of the rich yield of such careful and untiring investigation. The philosophers, on the other hand, constantly pursue the constitutive principle of reason and therefore overlook, as contingent and insignificant, many phenomena in history that are treated by the critics with the greatest exactness. Yet one must not believe that this indifference is a necessary consequence of the nature of the matter, as though this must entail a certain speculative arrogance; for, objectively considered, everything can be appropriated and comprehended, — it is rather a consequence of the imperfection of human thinking, [26] in that this can indeed distinguish the general lineaments of objective reason from one another, but not the countless nuances in which it appears, so that philosophy precisely calls for modesty; — and so far is speculation from weakening the interest in the empirical phenomena that, on the contrary, it increases it. A single action can express only one moment of the universal idea; if, therefore, the other moments are to come in, the other actions must also be taken into consideration. To find out the objective and historical concept, one must therefore have an apparatus of many phenomena; the more phenomena we therefore take up from vulgar empirical knowledge, the better we will succeed in separating out and developing the essential phenomena.

If, therefore, one wishes to describe Gregory the Seventh's hierarchy in the vulgar manner, namely by citing his individual utterances and undertakings, one need only weave in one's definitions here and there and otherwise pick out and present in a convenient order such passages as are suited to illustrate it; (and when a goodly number of such passages, heaped together from everywhere, then make a show in the row of definitions, they will at the same time be a brilliant proof of the great learning

the author possesses). If, on the other hand, one wishes to comprehend this pope's hierarchy in its whole truth, one cannot rest content with having a sum of selected passages; one will then find that one can catch the finer threads of the concept in no other way than by carefully elucidating all the grounds that have given it its peculiar character. The concept of truth is thus entirely different in these two kinds of empirical knowledge. In vulgar empirical knowledge that is true which has actually taken place, without regard to whether it is something significant or something insignificant; in [27] speculative empirical knowledge, on the other hand, truth depends on the relation in which the determinate object stands to the constitutive principle, and much may have taken place in which speculative empirical knowledge finds but little truth. — Thus, while Isidore's Decretals are absolutely rejected by the critic on account of their untruth, they nevertheless have a deeper truth if the phenomenon is considered from its other side; and we have already remarked that these two modes of consideration must be weighed against each other. — A similar difference obtains where the talk is of historical proofs; for though we can often document the matter in question by definite statements or events, we also often maintain, even when we have no such things to hold to, that the truth of the matter follows from the general relation of all the individual objects. It is precisely here that the difference arises between the so-called juridical proofs and those that rest only on a moral conviction; and as we assign the former to vulgar empirical knowledge, so, if we do not wish to remain standing on the shaky ground of probability (*cfr.* §. 3), we must assign the latter to speculative.

If vulgar empirical knowledge could itself solve the task it has before it, the transition to speculative empirical knowledge would be easy and safe; but it is easy to see that the truth of vulgar empirical knowledge cannot be determined by the standard of speculative empirical knowledge alone; if one is to be able to comprehend fully how these two can be neither immediately in agreement nor absolutely in disagreement, it must be shown that the opposition between them has a deeper opposition as its ground, namely an opposition between vulgar and speculative logic.

The external mode of apprehending the objects of existence differs from the one that penetrates to the interior of the objects in this, that the former juxtaposes the

objects in such a way that they do touch one another at certain points but remain [28] separate within the boundaries that enclose them, whereas the latter everywhere lets them coincide and permeate one another. From this it follows, then, that vulgar logic proceeds from the mutual diversity of the phenomena and ascribes only a formal significance to their unity, whereas speculative logic leads us from the unity out into the diversities. In vulgar logic, where the abstract concepts are held fast by themselves and the real objects by themselves, there is nothing one must guard against more than contradiction; for when things touch one another mutually and yet it is the nature of the thing to keep everything foreign outside itself, how then can the thing *A* be at once the same as, and yet not the same as, the thing *B*? When, on the other hand, the consideration is conducted from within, things are not seen in abstract separation from one another; the moments pass infinitely over into, correspond infinitely to, one another, and thus the absolute contradiction sublates itself.

It now becomes easy to account for the many conflicts between everyday understanding and speculative reason. For everyday understanding is outraged to see rules such as that *nothing can come to be from nothing*, or that *three cannot be one and one not three*, rules it has itself recognized as certain and unshakable, trampled underfoot, if one may say so, by speculative logic. It goes, however, with these two kinds of logic as with the two kinds of empirical knowledge: they do not simply cancel or overthrow one another; all these oppositions arise from one's having a different point of departure for consideration, so that a remarkable *concordia discors* obtains between empirical knowledge and philosophy. For when the philosophers speak of the absolute contradiction and teach the identity lying in it, they do not do so in the name of everyday understanding; they readily grant that all the rules of everyday [29] understanding must be accepted by one who stands at the standpoint of everyday understanding; they recognize full well that the middle way deserves recommendation if one wishes to keep to the common opinions about philosophy and history; but they want the standpoint itself changed; they want to change, not the laws of vulgar logic, but vulgar logic itself. The empiricists, on the other hand, do not want to change their standpoint, because they cannot be persuaded that their method is really skewed and one-sided. — It is, then, self-evident that vulgar and speculative empirical knowledge

cannot be placed side by side in an external manner in order, as by a subjective trick, to be reconciled with each other, since the wavering between the two that would thereby arise would call forth a skepticism undermining both, but that the transition from the one to the other happens, and must happen, in countless ways by the thing's own objective power. For the outer must always have the inner in it, — and it does not rest on a subjective whim whether speculative logic is to have precedence over vulgar logic or not; it lies rather in the very nature of vulgar logic that, if only it is carried through and does not stop halfway, it must lead to speculative logic. It is precisely this relation that makes speculative empirical knowledge recognize an essential identity between itself and vulgar empirical knowledge. — From this it is also evident with what freedom the speculative concept can develop. Many, to be sure, are frightened off when one recommends a concept or a system to them, because they reject every edifice of concepts strictly measured out with inner necessity as an intolerable and constricting iron harness in which their thoughts are tormented; but this fear is not grounded in the true nature of the matter, but is a figment of their subjective imagination. For the system does indeed require that the necessary concepts be held fast, but the reason for this is none other than that these make their power felt everywhere in life itself. It requires just as fully that the concept be elucidated and demonstrated through all its peculiar modifications, and thus preserves thought in its freedom in the fullest sense. Both the system and the concept are in truth in possession of the freest mobility; for what else does the system want than to develop all the moments of the concept insofar as they mutually take one another up into themselves; and what else does the concept aim at than precisely the development of the fullness of the pregnant idea? From the inner fullness of the idea proceed the outer modifications of the object, and, if these are considered from without, they are indeed countless and contingent, but if they are considered from within, they are seen to have proceeded from the idea's own self-limited power and are thus limited in the midst of their unlimitedness. The necessity of the concept thus stands in no opposition to the freedom of life.

Nor is the subjective moment of freedom overlooked because we will not leave the true development of life's moments to subjective arbitrariness. For since speculative experience at once corresponds infinitely to, and at the same time deviates infinitely

from, everyday experience, what is required, precisely, in one who is to be able rightly to untie the knot of the intricate moments is a gifted eye, a capacity to seek the idea immediately.

§ 6.

The Concept of Science.

What we have sought to show so far is, in a few words, this: that there are three stages which our cognition has to traverse. The first bids us leave everyday experience with its immediacy and contingency and pass over to speculative logic; the second [31] negates logic and leads us out onto the wide field that the careful testing of everyday experience opens to us; the third presents objective reason made intuitable in the mirror of speculative experience.

If one now wished to place these three mutually negating stages side by side in an external manner, one would need only to seek negation and restoration in three places and three times. But what is thus in general assigned to three stages repeats itself again infinitely within each of them; for what holds of speculative logic, that it looks away from experience altogether, we find again within the boundaries of this logic, since it develops precisely through an uninterrupted negation of empirical moments; and what has been said of everyday experience, that it stands in opposition to logical reason, holds also within the boundaries of this experience: its moments never pass over into one another, and in all of them we see the alteration of reason, not reason itself. The general result at which our cognition arrives through all these stages is, then, this: to see the oppositions in their infinite passing over into one another.

But from this the concept of science emerges, for it is precisely the task of science to lead to an absolute identity of the moments absolutely opposed to one another. If, therefore, one wants a general and formal type of absolute science, we can find one in our own self-consciousness; for since the human I preserves its identity with itself in distinguishing itself from itself, we can rightly say that it knows itself. Now since no self-consciousness can exist without being mediated through real existence, i.e.

[32] through the negative of consciousness, this limitation, if we look to the particular objects, is indeed a sheer negation of consciousness and thus an annulment of all knowledge; but if, on the other hand, we look to real negation in general, we can truly say that our knowledge is expanded the more consciousness is limited.

For if self-consciousness cannot be except through an other that is opposed to it, it must also at every point be permeated by this foreign moment and, as often as it grasps itself, grasp this as well; there is therefore in self-consciousness at once a separation between what is its own, the formal moment, and the foreign, the real moment, and at the same time an identity of both; it therefore knows its other at the same time as it knows itself. And from this it is also easily understood in general that one can at once know God and nature without any confusion whatsoever of the creature and the Creator. Those, therefore, who distort the well-known proposition of the philosophers that only like can grasp and cognize like (*simile modo simile capere et cognoscere*), forget, alas, that the absolute identity of self-consciousness with the object to be cognized results solely and exclusively from the absolute opposition between them.

It therefore follows from the very nature of science that every kind of cognition that places thinking in an external relation to the objects to be cognized must be banished from its sanctuary. Whatever in any way belongs to everyday experience and everyday logic is too immediate and undigested to be taken up into the realm of science.

But since everyday experience, as we have already remarked before, cannot be dispensed with and yet stands outside the boundaries of science, one must carefully distinguish between the elements that prepare science and science itself; and important [33] are the consequences that flow from this distinction. In the first place, then, we no longer stray onto the wrong path of peddling, under the name of science, rudiments mixed with trivial concepts, in the belief that we had appropriated science—a wrong path that would lead us further and further away from all true science. To expound the science of history is thus not to tell stories; only what we have conceived and seen through in history should we reproduce; everything else we must set aside as apparatus, which we shall have to examine anew in order to become clear with

ourselves whether or not it can occupy a place in science. But the bad habit of putting forward critical elements under the name of positive science, and of answering the one who seeks a concept that penetrates all particulars: “that is something historical; here there is to be no philosophizing!”, has spread so far that dogmaticians who teach us virtually nothing else about God than that there exists a highest being, who in Hebrew is called *Elohim*, in Greek *Θεός*, in Latin *Deus*, and in German *Gott*, and so forth, and that these names have been explained in various ways, win a great name as cultivators of “positive science.” Indeed, when speculative dogmatics excludes as something foreign everything that the religious self-consciousness cannot conceive, they even raise vehement complaints against it in the name of Holy Scripture and the Church, as if speculative concepts did not require persistent study of the teaching of Holy Scripture and the Church. And when they see the dogmas proceed from one another in an unbroken sequence of thought, they accuse the dogmatics of being derived from some philosophical system or other, while they themselves think they best secure the transition from one part of dogmatics to the other by citing parallel passages from Scripture, and thereby betray that they are not free of a certain superstition, since one no more keeps dogmatic error away from oneself by placing passages of Scripture at the head than one drives away the Devil by making the sign of the cross. [34]

Secondly, this separation makes evident how much exertion and diligence is required in order to arrive at true science. When the empiricists and the critics congratulate one another as the only ones who dare to take on the great masses of the sciences, while the philosophers occupy themselves solely and exclusively with their own empty speculations, they truly show that they think far too highly of themselves and have far too slight a notion of the activity of thinking. But the same people who pass so harsh a judgment on speculative thinking set science itself now far too high, now far too low. They have far too exalted a notion of it when they assert that human beings cannot, by their thinking, conceive anything fully and with absolute truth, and therefore place the entire yield of their study in the increase and arrangement of the material of everyday experience; far too slight a notion of it when they think that, with little trouble and on their own, they can themselves bring along the requisite thinking, provided only the positive objects are at hand. Had they properly considered

how much diligence it takes to pursue an absolute concept in the right way through all its modifications, they would surely admit that Jehovah's word to Adam: "In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread!" can in this respect too be applied to the philosopher.

Although it is thus not to the critics and the empiricists alone that the honor of exertion and diligence belongs, in another respect the burdensome part of the work is nonetheless shifted onto them; for one must distinguish well between the thought that is thought for its own sake and the preparatory investigation that has its goal outside [35] itself. The former belongs to speculation, the latter to the everyday understanding and to criticism. For it lies in the nature of critical labors never to be satisfying in and for themselves; and this holds not only of the investigations that aim at inquiring into the authenticity of a writing, without regard to whether it is a sacred writing or not, but it holds also of the manner in which they treat the ideas themselves. When criticism develops dogmatic concepts, e.g., creation, inspiration *or the like*, it does sometimes get so far as to have the problem correctly posed, but the problem itself it never solves.

The creation of the world, it is said, must be thought neither in such a way that we confuse the world with God, as the pantheists do, nor in such a way that the world is assumed to have posited itself, as the atheists teach; for such thoughts are impious and pernicious in their consequences; it must be thought as a free act of God. But this freedom they do not themselves dare to think; they thus demand something that they do not themselves do (*λέγουσι γὰρ καὶ οὐ ποιοῦσι*).

Inspiration is treated in the same way: it must be thought neither in such a way that God has transgressed the laws of the nature of the human spirit, nor in such a way that the spirit of man is assumed not to have been touched at all by the Spirit of God, but in such a way that the Spirit of God has enlightened the spirit of man. They thus demand in plain words that inspiration be thought in this way, and yet we call on them in vain to think it. We are not, however, so much surprised that they will not answer the question themselves, — they could indeed reply that they have not taken it as their task to solve the problem, but only to pose it; but since the critical investigations have taken the place of true science, their supreme contradiction shows itself in this: that although they call on us to think, they nevertheless themselves [36] declare that these questions about how God created the world or how he inspired the

prophets and apostles are useless and impossible to answer.

What we have here sought to develop must not be presented as though we had meant that the investigations of the empiricists and critics were to be despised or at any rate regarded with indifference; for from the relation that, according to our preceding development, obtains between vulgar and speculative experience, it follows precisely that they are altogether necessary; only they must not be confused with science proper. Should philosophy therefore reproach criticism with the insignificance of its labors and boast of itself being in full possession of the truth, criticism could with the greatest right answer it in the same words with which Themistocles, in Plutarch, has the feast day answer the day that follows it: *Αληθῆ λέγεις. ἀλλ' ἐμοῦ μὴ γενομένης σὺ οὐκ ἂν ᾔσθαι.*

§ 7.

The Scientific Method.

In its striving to lead to an absolute identity of thought and the object thought, science always has in view the goal of developing this identity through all the particular modifications of the object. If, therefore, self-consciousness cannot be except through an other, and indeed a real other, the task becomes to bring about a complete reconciliation of this positive, which comes forth in the whole multitude of positive elements, with self-consciousness, so that the former can at every point correspond to the latter. Every science depends on this reconciliation, but the reconciliation depends in turn on the *scientific method*.

The contradiction from which the true method must necessarily proceed shows [37] itself in this: that while formal knowledge and the real fullness of existence seem mutually to exclude each other, they nevertheless, as we have previously shown, agree in this, that they both *are*. And it is in this point of identity that the whole opposition and every disagreement between them is to find its sublation. We know, then, that it is objective being that constitutes subjective being, that formal being proceeds from real being, the being of our thinking from the being of substance.

But once we have sublated this opposition between the formal and the real moment, a new contradiction shows itself in turn. For self-consciousness attains complete agreement with objective reality only by an accommodation, in that it renounces every other predicate than the simple one, that it *is*, although it nonetheless has many more moments in it than this; and if we look to the objective, we find that real existence too performs the same *συγκράτασις*: although it overflows in infinite fullness, it too lays aside all its predicates except the one, that it *is*. Hence, as often as we wish to acquiesce in the concept of being, the contradiction arises that of an object which has a far richer content than mere being we assert nothing but this one thing, that it *is*. And we cannot avoid this contradiction, because self-consciousness, which is the medium through which we arrive at this assertion, will always assert its right. Now what thus holds of the beginning holds likewise of every intermediate stage and of the conclusion itself. Every concrete determination or designation that one is compelled to ascribe to self-consciousness must also necessarily be asserted of real existence. If, [38] therefore, it is not sufficient to designate the relation between I and Me, so as thus to name the subject and object of formal knowledge, by the relation between essence and phenomenon, cause and effect, we can also be certain that this determination does not even fully express the nature of the real object. Herein lies precisely the dialectical stimulus that does not let the thinker find rest until he has arrived at the developed concept of self-consciousness. But when one has at last reached this highest point of the development, it will also turn out that not merely a subjective advance has been made, but that the very same movement has also taken place in real being. As, therefore, at the beginning of the development we say that objective and real being constitutes subjective and formal being, so we now understand and conceive, when we come to the conclusion of the system, that it is an objective and real self-consciousness that constitutes the subjective and formal self-consciousness.

And yet the contradiction does not cease even here; for the identity between formal and real self-consciousness that we have thus established contains at the same time an essential difference. — While the absolutely real self-consciousness has the whole fullness of reality in itself, it turns out, after all, that the identity of formal self-consciousness with it was found only in the purely formal. The reality that we

previously gave up for the sake of identity we must now restore anew. But in this way the dialectical stimulus drives us through the whole of speculative theology.

That God is thus thought as absolute freedom by no means entails that one must give up dialectical necessity; for where there is freedom, there *must* also be manifestations of freedom. But on the other hand, God's absolute freedom is no more sublated by this necessity of the concept; for there is the following circle in the proof: through the negation of the world we came to the freedom that must have given the world its [39] origin; as a consequence of this we must, if we wish to exhaust the concept of this freedom, return once more from freedom to the world it has created; as long, therefore, as we occupy ourselves with the development of absolute freedom considered in and for itself, we shall constantly feel this dialectical necessity of advancing further. The same dialectical necessity that makes the *ground*, in order to be a ground, have to have a *consequence*, the same thus also makes freedom, in order to be absolute, have to have a world. — And if we look to the special moments in history, we also find in them the very same relation again. We cannot, e.g., conceive all the individual data that depict the relation between Germany and Italy, between the political and the ecclesiastical power at the time of the pornocracy, except by penetrating, through the totality (§ 4) of the reported facts, to the principle in its simplest and most general form in such a way that the very same contradiction we spoke of above will return here too, if we now wish to remain standing at the first, abstract point of departure (cf. §. 10). Thus even human arbitrariness, which is so often assumed to lack all rational necessity and to be entirely accidental, is bound to objective laws, without thereby ceasing to be arbitrariness; and were it not so, we could neither accept as true the objections that are made against the indeterminists, nor rightly understand the nature and essence of obduracy. And everyone who has noticed that man's resistance to the object of truth is itself also determined and modified by the nature of this object will grant that the cruelty of Messalina and Agrippina was of a different nature from that of Fredegund and Brunhild, and that the cruelty of Theodora and Mariuccia in turn had a peculiar character of its own. Thus, too, the obduracy that the Catholics showed when they [40] denounced Luther as a heretic was of a different nature from that which the Jews showed when they persecuted Christ, because the truth here appears in altered form.

As in the sensuous world we look at the same point with both eyes, and both therefore constitute, so to speak, only one eye, so on the other hand the soul is indeed ascribed only one eye, but this in actuality looks at two points at once and can therefore be taken as two eyes. For as soon as we begin to think, we always come up against the reality that immediately confronts us, whose negation thinking seeks to find; therefore the soul of the thinker must always hold fast the positive fullness with the one eye, while with the other it seeks to find the simplest and purest moment in the existence of that fullness. The distance between the point of departure and the fullness that has resulted from it thus constitutes the fundamental contradiction from which all the contradictions lying in between the two proceed, so that every science can in this sense be called hypothetical.

If this is so, one can also rightly assert that the chief task of method is this: fully to uncover the fundamental contradiction in all the individual spheres of existence. For the difference between these individual contradictions rests on the difference between the positive realities from whose negation one proceeds.

The first positive from which we proceed is, of course, our own self-consciousness, which rests on objective reality, and since this is the most universal foundation of all, it follows that its fundamental contradiction must extend everywhere, and that we cannot take it to be tied to any hypothesis, since hypothesis is precisely thinking's own necessary condition. This contradiction we may then call the *ontological*.

[41] The next positive foundation emerges when one proceeds by negating reality itself, whose author is the absolute self-consciousness, and in particular the reality that we have most immediately before our eyes, namely our world; from this too there arises a fundamental contradiction, but in such a way that the hypothetical here comes forward far more strongly; for it is indeed certain that the absolute self-consciousness can acquiesce in itself, but what reality is to proceed from it seems to be hypothetical and to presuppose freedom as its necessary condition, since our world is presumably not the only one in which the divine life can reveal itself. If, therefore, in dogmatics we consider theology (the Kingdom of the Father), Christology (the Kingdom of the Son) and pneumatology (the Kingdom of the Spirit), we may observe that what we are to negate in the first kingdom is reality in its pure universality, whereas in the second

and third kingdoms we fix our gaze more specifically on the reality of our world, so that in these the contradiction and the necessity are set within certain definite limits; for it is a definite world, namely our world, in which Adam sinned and Christ became incarnate, that is here negated. We may therefore call this fundamental contradiction the *dogmatic*.

But as universal reality passes over into being the reality of this world, so too the reality of this world issues forth in more special realities; hereby we come to the third form of the fundamental contradiction, in which hypothesis indeed asserts its power far more still, but which nonetheless, within its limits, also brings dialectical necessity with it; and this is the *historical*.

We believe, then, that we have thus proved that every method leads through contradiction, that every science requires that its moments mutually sublate one another, and that all dialectic is negative. [42]

§ 8.

Conceiving and Intuiting.

The objective fullness that we seek, with the help of science, to take thoroughly into ourselves must be considered from the following two sides. On the one side, one must undertake an analysis of the individual moments in order to get to see them in their proper mutual light; but on the other side the totality of all the moments also presents itself to our eye and thus demands at the same time an immediate intuiting. Every concept is thus determined in a twofold way; for on the one hand it must, within its own limits, have a peculiar distinctiveness by which it distinguishes itself from the other concepts and keeps them outside itself, — and this constitutes the fixed, immovable moment of individuality that we have spoken of earlier (§ 2), — but on the other hand, in order to be able to be established as a concept, it must necessarily also be capable of being dissolved into other concepts. To grasp the relation between the individual concepts by comprehending several moments at once may be called *conceiving*, whereas the peculiarity that belongs to each of them must be referred

to *intuition*; science therefore takes both moments into itself, both conceiving and intuiting. If one wished to determine a concept solely by stating its relation to other, kindred concepts, then *eo ipso* all determination would thereby cease; for if one can determine what *A* is only by referring to *B*, and again what *B* is only by referring to *C*, determination vanishes into the infinite, and as shadow follows upon shadow, every light of cognition is extinguished. And if, on the other hand, the object is presented as a resting, dead object without inner mobility, one does indeed get a petrified positivity,
 [43] but here too no true cognition. The identity of these two opposite sides, too, is present formaliter in formal knowledge, but is present realiter and absolutely in God.

As the thinker is, so too are his thoughts. From this proposition one must proceed if one wishes to determine the nature of divine thinking. The absolutely real self-consciousness knows itself at the same time as the absolute positivity. It concentrates itself, so to speak, in its will, in that it affirms itself and thereby has all the elements of its life in complete possession. In making itself an object for itself, it beholds not an empty shadow but the fullest reality, and therefore all the thoughts that mediate this its self-contemplation also partake of the same reality; for if God did not himself utter his absolute “Here am I!” (*Hinnen*), neither would the things he posits attain to any true individuality. But in thus positing himself and positing all, he at the same time intuites all. He intuites in positing, and thus reveals himself as the absolute substance; he posits in intuiting, because he is the absolute freedom: “*Truth is because God wills it.*” — Now if this relation were confined to the life of the Godhead alone, the whole of existence would split apart into monads which, as Leibniz says, had no windows through which they could see into one another. But from God’s own individual existence it follows that his thoughts too pass infinitely over into and interpenetrate one another. Since it is the same God, the same self-consciousness, that thinks all, his different thoughts must also stand in mutual connection with one another. For God does not merely intuit the individual things piecemeal, since his knowledge is simultaneous, but he also derives the one from the other and considers the mutual relation among them all;
 [44] and were it not so, he could neither clearly distinguish nor fully penetrate things with his knowledge; — without abstraction, no distinction.

The absolute ideality of divine thinking does indeed require that each of his

individual objects have the totality of all his other thoughts in it; but if this is not to be a merely tautological thinking, it is on the other hand equally necessary that the fullness of the ideas be present in the different objects in different ways. God, then, cannot think the object *A* without at the same time abstracting from it the object *B*; — the point of difference is the point of departure of abstraction. — Therefore those who emphasize God's knowledge as that which is simultaneous and intuits everything at once must not forget that the divine thoughts form a system, and that God, in intuiting the individual things, runs through the whole long path of thought from the point of beginning, pure nothing, to the individual concrete thing, so that his immediate knowledge has at the same time from eternity been, and will always continue to be, a mediated one.

Should anyone object that we are thereby transferring unfitting anthropomorphisms to God, and apply to us Athanasius's well-known words: "*o ludicram doctrinam aedificantem simul et demolientem*", we must ask him to remember well that abstraction and mediation are not separated in an external manner from simultaneous knowledge, but that conceiving and intuiting rather coincide. In that God conceives himself and his thoughts hang together with one another by a bond of necessity, he has the absolute truth: "*God wills because it is truth.*" The more precise development of this must, incidentally, be left to speculative theology; we have touched on these points only in order to present the archetype of human knowledge. Human self-consciousness, [45] which is an image of the divine, contains the above-mentioned moments within itself in a formal manner. For the *I* passes continually over into the *Me*, and the *Me* into the *I*; the one thought constantly takes up the other, constantly dissolves itself in the other; there must thus take place a conceiving; — but intuition is no less present; for when the *I* regards the *Me*, the former must always see the latter as something positive; for were this not the case, one could not grasp what the *I* is either, and there could then be no self-consciousness at all. But that the positive and intuitable is a necessary moment, if self-consciousness is to have the fullness of reality, is easy to see. For if one is to be able to arrive at a conceiving, one must also be able to intuit the real fullness, and such an intuition is not only necessary in general but is also required in the individual concepts, in order that each individual concept may thereby obtain its

true intensity. — That this is so is shown also by dialectic itself; for when one wishes to develop a concept from the concepts that precede it, one does indeed first indicate and describe it with other expressions, but then passes over from these to its own true and necessary designation. But the addition of such a category can have no other ground than this: that it brings with it the intuition of a certain positive and peculiar moment, and that this is necessary in order that the concept may in actuality obtain individuality. — One can therefore also demonstrate the significance of intuition in ontology itself. Does there not, for instance, seem to lie a far more powerful stimulus to dialectical advance in the doctrine that pure being passes over into pure nothing than in the doctrine that the idea of the world-soul must necessarily pass over into the idea of abstract personality? This can hardly be denied; but the reason for it is not [46] so much that doctrine's greater conceivability as, far rather, its greater intuitability. For only one who has immediately experienced the significance of personality can recognize that the universe cannot be held fast or conceived except by being seen as having issued from a person. Indeed, the necessity of such a pre-given intuition will always repeat itself anew, since God's absolute freedom has created not merely reality in general but also this determinate world and all the determinate phenomena that meet us in it. One must then have put oneself in possession of the whole doctrine of the Church before one can develop what this freedom is like, and only after having developed freedom in general can one pass on to the individual phenomena in history. From this one sees, then, what it means that it is necessary to believe, a demand so often made when true science is spoken of. I grasp God's personality by carrying through the negation of my own personality; now had I not myself a real personality, I could not have any higher concept of personality either; but if it is to be real, it must also be religious; — to know God is thus to confess God, i.e., to surrender oneself to God. As, therefore, considered objectively, everything is taken up into an existence that is not merely thinking but also willing, so too, considered subjectively, knowing God lies not merely in the cognition of him but also in the will's readiness to submit [47] to him.¹⁾ It is precisely at this point that the ontological proof of God's existence

¹⁾"Since, then, one comes in the light of conscience to a true cognition of an *author* of all human self-consciousness, we can determine it more precisely as the light in which man is revealed as *God's creature*; in this cognition lies the germ of all religion and worship."

coincides with the testimony of the religious self-consciousness; as the former speaks to our conceiving, so the latter speaks to our intuition. One must then have religious faith and experience in order rightly to be able to develop the dogmas of the Christian religion; — that one must have appropriated the doctrine of the Church we have indicated above — for it is through these that the soul is filled with inner truth; it is therefore also only through them that we become able to penetrate the dialectical moments. But this faith is precisely genius in its highest form, i.e., religious genius.

§ 9.

Our Knowledge Is Relative.

From the mutual relation between conceiving and intuiting it follows, however, that our knowledge cannot become complete before the life of God has been revealed in its whole fullness, or, in other words, before the Kingdom of blessedness has come. For the clarity of our concept is, after all, always won through a greater or lesser loss of the real fullness, and the more we turn our attention to concrete and peculiar objects, the more we are drawn into the hypothetical sphere of freedom. Indeed, this even has its natural ground in the relation of mutual dependence in which the disciplines of science stand to one another, which entails that none of them can be completely closed, [48] because the completeness of the one depends on that of the other. As long as the two different ways of regarding objects, the vulgar through the senses and the speculative through thinking, only take each other up in that they infinitely presuppose each other, that is, as long as we dwell in this life, so long does a relative darkness continue to reign in our knowledge (*βλέπομεν γὰρ ἄρτι δι' ἐσόπτρου ἐν αἰνίγματι*). This must not be ascribed merely to a deficiency in our consciousness; the clarity of our knowledge is rather darkened by the unclarity of the sensuous world itself. We cannot cognize

H. Martensen, *Selvbevidsthedens Autonomie*, translated by Petersen, P. 10.

“— — — since, moreover, freedom is the principle of every cognition, in that one rational being can communicate itself to another, and live and move in it, only through the mediation of freedom: man must freely submit to God in order that the divine idea may really be able to penetrate into his spirit and be inwardly united with his consciousness; man must, in other words, *believe in order to cognize*.” Ibid., P. 15.

anything before it comes forth in the objective light¹⁾. We can therefore expect to arrive at absolute knowledge neither in nature nor in history, and just as little in religion itself, since it is precisely the peculiar character of this world (*τοῦ αἰῶνος τούτου*) that all the elements of life in it are split up into detached fragments. And how, indeed, should we be able to grasp the truth before it has itself attained an adequate form in which it can fully reveal itself, since it is, after all, precisely the truth itself that forms self-consciousness in us?

It is precisely this limitation of our knowledge that is designated in the vulgar saying that there are indeed several things that men can conceive, but that they cannot conceive everything, not the highest.

But if one now tries to refer all things to two classes, the conceivable and the inconceivable, so that they are to stand separated, each on its own side, one will in [49] truth arrive at the result that either they are all conceivable, or that none of them is. For if we first look to the things we call conceivable, they are surely limited and determined precisely by their relation to those we call inconceivable. And if we proceed from the inconceivable things, these must surely of necessity step out into the things that are conceivable, and thus themselves become conceivable. We can adduce examples of this from dogmatics itself: precisely by urging that human nature has preserved its powers unimpaired, the Pelagians think to explain all the phenomena of religious life, whereas the Augustinians, on the contrary, in order to interpret the nature of sin and of regeneration, refer to Adam's fall as ruinous for the whole human race, and to God's grace and justice, with the addition that God had not predestined Adam's fall; indeed, the Calvinists go still further, in teaching that God has predestined everything. Thus they all wish to *conceive* the phenomena of religious life, in seeking to explain them and to reconcile them with one another; but in striving to reach this goal they all, each in his own place, come to smuggle in an inconceivable moment, and precisely for that reason none of them arrives at a true conceiving. It is indeed generally assumed that the propositions of the Pelagians are easier to conceive than those of the Augustinians and the Calvinists; but since the relation between divine and human freedom that the

¹⁾Every science is a knowledge of something that science does not produce, but that exists independently of it. *Mynster*: "Om Begrebet Dogmatik." § 4. Cf. *Sibbern*: "Om Erkjendelse og Grandskning." § 1. *Scimus, quia acceperimus*: All cognizing is a finding, a receiving and a beholding.

Pelagians teach evidently stands in opposition to the concept of God's omnipotence and grace, and all human actions are thus expressions of an inconceivable human freedom, all these actions surely betray everywhere an inconceivable moment and are therefore themselves inconceivable¹⁾. — On the other hand Calvin, since he has [50] given the premises, cannot refrain from completing his inference for the benefit of human cognition; he therefore refers everything to a *decretum absolutum* in God that surpasses all human understanding, and so, in his striving to conceive the relation, arrives at a result that is altogether inconceivable.

We thus find that it does not depend on the nature of the matter itself where this birthmark of human cognition, if we may so call it, is to be found, or how it is to be concealed, but that it rather has another ground, whether we now wish to call this subjective arbitrariness or religious tact¹⁾. It is therefore evident that one cannot draw that separation in an external manner.

If the mystery must thus pervade all moments once it is present at a single point, [51] we can also conclude conversely that our knowledge must be able to extend itself to all objects as soon as it is present at merely a single point; for were it bound to succumb to the mystery, it could not exist at all, since the mystery asserts its power everywhere; in other words: the limitation of our knowledge is not metaphysical, but empirical. The laws to which our cognition is bound hold for all eternity, and this

¹⁾That *Augustine* was an infralapsarian gives *Neander* (Allgem. Gesch. d. Rel. und Kirche. 2 Band. 3te Abtheil, p. 876) occasion for the following remark: "Aber es war dies eine schöne Inconsequenz, welche aus dem Siege seines religiössittlichen Gefühls über seine dialektisch=speculative Richtung herrührte."

¹⁾Hence the objections that have been advanced even in our own time against Calvin's consequences in this respect may also well deserve a hearing. Thus *Guerike* says, Kirchengesch. P. 1020, Not. 216: "Die heilsam inconsequente Vorstellungsweise der Concordienformel im Verhältnisse zu der selbst gotteslästerlich consequenten Calvins ist also kurz diese: Seligkeit und Hoffnung ist nach beiden nur ein Werk der göttlichen Gnade, Verdamniß eine Folge der eignen Schuld. Während aber nun die Concordienformel demüthig bei diesem letzteren Satze stehen bleibt argumentirt Calvin weiter etc." But when *Guerike* saw fit to add: "Gott also hat selbst die Sünde der Menschen gewollt. Diese letzte, nothwendige, ob auch noch so bemäntelte Schlußfolge" he seems, by adding this new inference, himself to have sinned against the pious reverence for the holy that he praised in the Formula of Concord, and I do not doubt that Calvin, were he still alive, would answer him with the same words with which he answered the irreligious striving of his time to conceive the divine mysteries: "*Arripiunt subito, fatcor, profani homines in prædestinationis materia, quod vel carpant, vel cavillentur, vel allatrent, vel subsannent. At si nos absterret eorum procacitas, celanda crunt præcipua quæquæ fidei dogmata. (Institut. christ. rel. De prædest. cap. XIV.)*."

accords, too, with the nature of truth; for of truth the same holds as of God, that it is not far from any one of us (*Ἡμῖν δὲ ἀπεκάλυψε ὁ θεὸς διὰ τοῦ πνεύματος αὐτοῦ* 1 Cor. 2, 10).

Human consciousness, therefore, has only to hold unshakably fast to the divine and real object and diligently strive to penetrate its moments; it will then find within itself what it seeks (*quod petis hic est*), and the bounds of absolute cognition will thus expand more and more for it from within.

§ 10.

The Relation between Dogmatics and Sacred History.

In order to develop more fully the relative limitation of our knowledge, we must consider more closely the relation between speculative dogmatics and speculative history. — Our knowledge is absolute, partly because consciousness is perfectly [52] clear to itself about its content, partly because the real moments it comprises are altogether universal and universally valid. From this it follows that dogmatics is the most real of all the sciences. For the concepts of ontology are altogether abstract, and the knowledge that history imparts is far too hypothetical. Therefore that positive moment which, as we have remarked earlier, is always necessary in order to call forth the negative stimulus of dialectic, does not in the domain of history attain any true intuitive clarity, but often has the effect that the dialectical sting, too, is blunted, because it is itself surrounded by sensuous obscurity. Dogmatics, by contrast, does take account of positive reality, but not of its more special modifications, and precisely thereby brings it about that the contradiction always comes forward, so that the concept is preserved. But this peculiarity of dogmatics calls forth a certain opposition. For if the individual phenomena are effaced, the more general reality itself disappears as well; one must then take refuge in everyday experience, in order with its help to gain from every quarter the missing fullness, — but since every such experience is a negation and limitation of science, everyday experience must transform itself into a speculative experience, i.e. history must become science.

The two different kinds of history each require a faith of their own; the faith necessary in vulgar history is mediated through the spirit of this world, which considers only trivial actuality; the faith of scientific history, by contrast, is mediated through the divine spirit, which posits ideal actuality. About some events the two kinds of faith agree; about others, or rather about most, they cannot, on the other hand, come to agreement.

We have touched on these relations here in passing, although they will later become the object of a closer consideration, in order to make it evident that dogmatics is a necessary presupposition for all historical knowledge. For one cannot conceive [53] the deeds of the human race without having grasped the idea of freedom in its truth; but in order to understand the freedom of man it is necessary to have understood the freedom of God; one can therefore conceive history only once one has appropriated the idea of religion and of revelation. So far, then, is sacred history from being violated when we seek to conceive it through philosophy, that it is much rather profaned whenever the phenomena are presented in an external manner, torn loose from the idea of God. Since, then, vulgar history is always profane, whereas speculative history is sacred, sacred history must be speculative.

Second Part.

Sacred History.

§ 11.

Catholicism.

Sacred history requires that the invisible divine nature present itself in visible phenomena; it thus sublates the opposition between the sensuous sphere of created things and the spiritual sphere of divine existence, in that spiritual objects come forth sensuously so that sensuous objects may be explained in the light of spirit; it likewise sublates the antinomy between the freedom of the Creator and that of the creature, in that God lays upon himself the bonds of finitude in order to give created freedom occasion to choose and to act. While it thus entails an immediate identity of the [54] supernatural and the natural realm, it must nonetheless just as surely let an opposition between the two come into view. For if God's history is to be sacred, God must be honored as the Holy One; and if God is to be honored as the Holy One, he must be exalted above created nature in infinite majesty. But sacred history removes this self-contradiction by referring to an opposition between different times and places. In some places and at some times, namely, the life of the world, so to speak, does not accord with the life of God and shows itself torn loose from it, but in other places and at other times the two come forth in immediate reconciliation. On this account no perceptible discord arises between vulgar and speculative experience; for in the world of sense we behold everywhere, with the eyes of faith, the supernatural beings, and as often as the laws of the world are interrupted by a higher order of things, as soon as mysteries make their appearance, everyday consciousness willingly surrenders without any philosophical tumult; but scarcely has the natural order returned before it again enters into its old rights. Wherever there is a revelation, this reciprocal relation between the two spheres always comes about; in the absolute, the Christian, religion it therefore appears in the highest measure.

When the apostles saw Christ, of whose appearing the Evangelist solemnly testifies: "And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth," they in truth beheld neither a merely sensuous figure nor an abstract spiritual idea, but they beheld in him the divine and the human nature in perfect identity, so that his history could with full right be called sacred and divine. And when he had gone away to the Father and had sent out the Spirit, the life of God so pervaded the apostles and all the faithful, [55] the power to work miracles was present in such full measure, the angels of heaven

revealed themselves so clearly to all, the divine counsels made themselves known so plainly in the intrigues of the adversaries (*τῶν θεομάχων*), that we also with the greatest right call apostolic history a sacred history. — Even after the death of the apostles, when the machinations of this world increased and the implacable enemy of Christianity *devised new intrigues in order, under the very cover of the Christian name, to lead the thoughtless astray*¹⁾, the source of revelation seemed unable to be exhausted; the more men mingled truth and falsehood, the greater was the need to have God visibly present in holy persons, in infallible doctrines, in external criteria of the congregation of true Christians, in short, in every way. Thus the Church, in the tribulations and darkness of this world, *taught by the Holy Spirit, who each day imparted to it the whole truth*, developed its excellent institutions. The priests came forth as God's representatives, a visible ruler established the visible unity, so that Christ's bride should not have her fair *countenance marred by any spot or wrinkle*. In the mystical nimbus of the sacraments one sees Christ himself, daily the number of miracles grows, and as the divine nature ever anew descends in the form of flesh, heaven opens itself to the faithful, and all the barriers of everyday experience are overstepped: one hears the myriads of angels praise the majesty of the Almighty, and, surrounded by the host of victorious martyrs, the pious *Mother of God* smiles upon the praying pilgrims, while the inhabitants of paradise rejoice and the monsters of hell tremble. Thus the Church holds at once earth and heaven, the present and the future, [56] the natural and the supernatural in its embrace, so that for Catholics the history of the Church is, in the fullest sense of the word, a sacred history.

§ 12.

The Fundamental Contradiction of Catholicism.

But this glory of Catholicism contains a fundamental contradiction. It is always the nature of essence to create its phenomenon; since, then, the Holy Spirit must

¹⁾Cf. *Cyprian: de unitate ecclesiae*.

necessarily create forms and traditions, one rightly says: “*Where the Spirit is, there must the Church also be*” (*Ubi spiritus, ibi ecclesia*).

Now since the institutions of the Holy Spirit are infallible, since the individual propositions of tradition are words dictated by God and therefore unchangeable, the object of truth is absolutely present, so that the invisible and the visible Church perfectly coincide. If the human spirit, therefore, wishes to grasp the truth, it need only throw itself entirely into the arms of the Church; its whole knowledge consists in the cognition that the Church has the truth, and everything that is true it will find expressed in the precepts and doctrines of the holy Mother¹).

[57] But in this one forgets to carry out the negation and restoration of the phenomena of which we spoke above (§ 4); a certain ecclesiastical sensualism then sets in, in that the unchangeable forms of the Holy Spirit are impressed upon the religious mind as upon a *tabula rasa*; the mind becomes not a free organ for the truth, but a form for the forms of the Holy Spirit, and therefore regards the phenomena from outside through a vulgar empirical knowledge and acquiesces in empty, subjective opinions¹); thus the proposition comes to hold: “*Where the Church is, there is the Spirit*” (*ubi ecclesia, ibi spiritus*). If the ecclesiastical institutions are now to be maintained, the Holy Spirit must have certain immediate organs, i.e. the Church must have priests. Since these neither descend from heaven nor are born as such, they must be chosen from the midst of the laity; hence the transition from the class of the laity to the priestly estate is of thoroughgoing significance. Since all laymen are struck with equal blindness, so that, when questions arise about improvements or corrections in ecclesiastical doctrines, no account is taken of differences either in mental gifts or in education, there can in this respect be no question of different degrees of enlightenment. Before ordination the Spirit is present only immediately; only through lawful ordination does the Holy

¹)Baur: Gegens. d. Kath. und Protest. p. 501–504.

Sollte jener freiere Begriff der Tradition seine Gültigkeit haben, so dürfte das eigene Urtheil des Einzelnen nicht schlechthin ausgeschlossen werden, es müsste jedem überlassen bleiben, die Unterscheidung, die zwischen Form und Inhalt, zwischen dem Wesentlichen und Unwesentlichen, dem Allgemeinen und Besondern gemacht werden soll, auch wieder auf alles dasjenige anzuwenden, was die Obern der Kirche als allgemeine Lehre der Kirche geltend machen. p. 505.

¹)It (i.e. the Catholic Church) does not derive its authority from its Christianity, but its Christianity from its authority.

Dr. H. N. Clausen, Cathl. og Protest p. 10. 11.

Spirit step in and stamp the one consecrated with the mark of infallibility (*character indelebilis*). It is thus indeed the Spirit that makes him a priest, but there is no other mark of the Spirit's presence than ordination, i.e. no one becomes a priest because he has the Spirit, but everyone who is a priest has the Spirit¹⁾. Nor is it through the priest's [58] teaching that the truth of the Spirit dwelling in him makes itself known; for although each individual priest is in possession of the Spirit, they all nonetheless remain weak mortals who can sin and go astray. One cannot, then, establish the infallibility of the individual priest except by the testimony of the Church; the priest therefore owes the Church the same obedience as the layman owes the priest. But through whose mouth can the Church speak, if not through that of the priests? Therefore each individual priest must be subject to the united opinion of all the others: *the majority is decisive*. For if the one were to convince the other of the truth by the truth's own power, one would surely have to negate the infallibility of the form as such; but once such a negation and free inquiry had asserted itself at a single point, it would penetrate to all parts of the Church, the lesser along with the greater, and then the very idea of Catholicism would disappear. Every inquiry rather rests on external traditions, and in such an inquiry each person's immediate opinion now comes into play, so that it is always something accidental which opinion will get the plurality on its side²⁾. It contributes but little to the removal of this difficulty that Catholicism has instituted different grades in the hierarchy of the priestly estate and of ecclesiastical jurisdiction³⁾; the possibility of the distortion of the truth is thereby only ramified the [59] further. For what does it help that the opinions of the presbyters conform to those of the bishops, if the bishops contradict one another among themselves? It then becomes necessary to have a visible ruler to whom one can turn in order to hear the living voice of the Holy Spirit. We have thereby arrived at the well-known disputes between Episcopalists and Curialists¹⁾. But that episcopatism is the system that strives to keep

¹⁾*Quodsi rasuram, unctionem et longam tunicam tantum possunt ostendere pro suo sacerdotio, permitimus illis gloriari. Lutherus de instituendis ministris. Cf. Dr. F. C. Baur. Der Gegensatz des Cathol. und Protest. P. 475.*

²⁾Denn ich glaube weder dem Pabst noch den Concilien allein nicht, weil es am Tag und offenbar ist, daß sie oft geirrt haben, und ihnen selbst sind widerwärtig gewest. Luther.

³⁾Cf. Clausen Cathol. og Protest. P. 91 f.

¹⁾The same: Cath. og Prot. Det curialistiske System P. 14—26. Det episkopale Kirkesystem P. 43—52.

to the bad middle way in the Catholic Church is well known.

The glory of Catholicism, like its fundamental contradiction, culminates in the person of the Pope; on the one hand the Pope is a weak and sinful man, on the other hand he is God's representative, in whom the fullness of the living Spirit takes up its dwelling; but who is now to decide when he speaks as Pope, driven by the Holy Spirit, and when he acts according to his own subjective arbitrariness? The councils, which were supposed to have the whole fullness of spiritual life within them, are surely subordinate to the Pope. Protestant science, therefore, has long since proved²⁾, that the objective idea of Catholicism — precisely where it has reached the highest summit of objectivity — has passed over into, and disappeared in, an arbitrary subjectivity, [60] whose whole infallibility consists in its declaring itself infallible. Therefore all Catholic institutions, although they are of such a nature that they can be forms for the Holy Spirit, can at the same time, when they are appropriated in an external manner, be held fast in and for themselves.

The Church thus often presents empty forms, and the falsity in Catholicism lies precisely in this, that whoever is in possession of the forms is also assumed to possess the Spirit. Under such a relation it is no wonder that the external phenomena have often been forsaken by spirit and truth to such a degree that not even the semblance of decency has been preserved, and that Catholicism has often had to blush at the testimony of history, although it is precisely in this testimony that it has put its trust¹⁾.

§ 13.

The Transition from Catholicism to Protestantism.

In the attempt to present the absolute object of truth to the beholder, Catholicism

²⁾Clausen *l. l. P.* 58.

Curialism forms in the Church a theocratic monarchy so unlimited that in actuality it must pass over into despotism, for it combats not only external relations and connections, but also the spiritual personality of every individual human being, every expression of independent thought and will; and in return the Church relieves its citizens who are obedient in faith of all responsibility of conscience, and grants them undisturbed security and peace; but it is the peace of death on the grave of slain enemies.

¹⁾Baronius "*significavit suo Jac. Sirmondo, nihil se æque reformidasse, quam pervenire ad hoc tempus (i.e. magni Schismatis Occidentis) de quo, quid statuendum, non esset libere pronuntiaturus*" *l. l. p.* 49.

constantly strives to bring human self-consciousness to turn its gaze away from itself toward external objects. But from this it follows that the objects in the kingdom of God, by being fixed in concrete images, come to be ranked alongside earthly objects, so that the holy is profaned, while on the other hand the descent of heavenly beings into earthly forms entails that temporal objects are accorded divine holiness, because they enclose the divine within themselves, so that what is in itself unholy becomes an object of worship¹⁾. When this barbarous confusion of opposed elements had become [61] plainly manifest in the theocracy of government, in the scholasticism of science, in the significance ascribed to good works, self-consciousness, which had long been banished from its own interior, began by various paths to return to itself²⁾. If one now investigates how it was possible that so great a split could arise in the Church, one will find that the only means of thoroughly reforming the Church was to negate the phenomena in order to penetrate to the essence, to draw a sharp separation between the idea and the form, between the invisible and the visible Church, and in consequence to enter into open struggle against the hierarchy. For where consciousness can do nothing but become a slave under a foreign authority, no true unity of subject and object can ever emerge; one therefore sees in such a positivism a constant wavering between obedience and rebellion. The obedience is blind so long as the subject can be bound to seek the substance outside itself; rebellion arises when this substance is not seen to constitute the subject's own nature, but, as a foreign power, only strikes fear; therefore the *faith* of the Catholics is a relation of *bondage* and always contains a certain mistrust.

If the true is to be beheld in the light of truth, objective reason must necessarily pervade subjective reason; otherwise we cannot be as certain and firm in possession of the thing itself as we are in possession of our own self-consciousness. Only where [62] this relation is immediately present is there a true faith. — With such a faith, so far is subjective life from being hampered by the objective bonds, that the subject rather surrenders itself with full confidence to the object, in the cognition that it is

¹⁾Cf. Hegel, *Geschichte der Philosophie*. 3ter Band, P. 253 f.

²⁾Hegel *l. l.* P. 267. Die andere Seite ist, daß das Ewige, was an und für sich wahr ist, auch erkannt, aufgefasst werde durch das reine Herz selbst; der eigene Geist mach sich für sich das Ewige zu eigen. Das ist der lutherische Glaube ohne anderes Beiwesen (die Werke, wie man es nannte).

precisely from the objective that it draws its true nourishment. This is the Protestant faith, which breaks the chains of positivism and founds an actual freedom. What deceptive phenomenon could mislead consciousness, what external power could shake the strength of the soul, once one has found this palladium of freedom? Therefore the man of God, whom we praise with grateful hearts as the prince of Protestantism, stood unshakably firm; girded with the belt of truth, he dispersed the fog of traditions and fables; protected by the shield of faith, he quenched the fiery darts of ecclesiastical tyranny¹⁾: with the drawn sword of the Spirit, the word of God, he attacked the unholy idols of superstition²⁾. From him went forth the first crisis, — the false beauty vanished, [63] and the history of human errors was drawn forth into the light.

§ 14.

Faith and Holy Scripture.

And yet this first crisis did not dissolve the bond between the natural and the supernatural realm; faith did indeed exchange the external elements for the inner moments of spirit, so that the motley splendor of images disappeared; but nonetheless the good angels still continued to look down upon men with their fair countenances through the clouds of heaven¹⁾, the devil, *this caricature of God*²⁾, continued under countless transformations to tempt the children of men³⁾. Nor did the freedom with which the truth of the phenomena was negated go so far that no infallible form of the

¹⁾Es thut dir wehe im Herzen mein fröhlicher großer Muth. Ich bin aber, und will, ob Gott will, auch bleiben, gegen dir und Ecken, Pabst und eurem Hauffen, auch dem Teufel, mit Gottes Hülfe, in einem beständigen, hochmüthigen, unerschrocknem Geist, und euch trotzen und verachten ... Luthers Schutz=Schriften v. An. 1524 wied. Hier. Emsern u. Paris. Theologos etc.

²⁾Hörst du es, Pabst, nicht der Allerheiligste, sondern der Allersündigste, daß Gott deinen Stuhl vom Himmel auf's schierste zerstöre und in Abgrund der Hölle senke. Cf. Pfizer L. L. P. 161.

¹⁾Luther: Daß man also Cherubim verstehe für Engel, die da erscheinen, nicht mit einem runtzlichten, noch traurigen Angesichte, sondern mit einem fröhlichen Geberde, und vollem feistem Angesichte ... Ausleg. des 3ten Capit. des 1sten Buch Mose.

²⁾*Simia dei* an allusion to Luther's words about the devil: "der Affe Gottes." Translator's note.

³⁾Luther: Er (der Teufel) ficht mich selbst offtmahls so gewaltig an, und überfället mich so hefftig mit schweren und traurigen Gedanken, daß ich meines Herrn Christi gar vergesse ... ist er dennoch heimlich bei uns, schleicht Tag und Nacht um uns her ... Ausleg. d. Epistel a. d. Galater Cap. 3.

truth should have remained; — the more the corruption of the existing Church gave offense, the more gladly one sought out its original pattern: the bolder one was in rejecting the divinity of the traditions, the more firmly one attached oneself to the Gospel in its original form. The Catholic Church had in a special way exalted the apostolic age and acknowledged its writings as canonical; since, then, the religious consciousness had beheld the truth in these books in unadulterated form, one eagerly seized upon *Holy Scripture* as the true pillar of faith. Yet this is not to be understood as if, [64] in urging Holy Scripture, one merely wished to set up a petrified norm in a positivistic manner, so that Catholicism, which had long prided itself on the agreement of its doctrine with that of the apostles, could have continued this self-praise undisturbed for a long time yet, had not some theologians happened by chance upon Holy Scripture, read it quite carefully, and undertaken a comparison. That was impossible; for had they not already harbored great doubt about many of the propositions of Catholicism, they would surely have expounded Scripture according to the rule laid down by the Church. The truth is present everywhere and at every time; therefore the Spirit, which never forsakes its Church, revealed itself at once, as soon as the false veil that had covered it had been cast off. — One must therefore bear well in mind that when the champions of the Protestants constantly appealed to Scripture as the highest testimony of truth, they could do so solely and only because the truth itself was the witness of Scripture, so that they honored the spirit in it and not its letters. — When the Reformers had noticed the disagreement of the traditions with Scripture¹⁾ and found that they had distorted rather than developed the Christian idea, it lay in the nature of the matter that they had at once to ascribe to Scripture *clarity* and *completeness* (*perspicuitas et sufficientia*)²⁾; but one must note well that they, brought up as they

¹⁾Was Christum nicht lehret, das ist noch nicht apostolisch, wenn es gleich S. Petrus oder S. Paulus lehrete. Wiederum was Christum prediget, das wäre apostolisch, wenns gleich Judas, Hannas, Pilatus und Herodes thät. Luther: Vorrede auf die Epistel St. Jacobi. Cf. with this: Ein Stück der Vorrede auf das N. Testament: Welches die rechten und edelsten Bücher des Neuen Testaments sind. An. 1521.

²⁾Da erdenken sie eine neue Lüge, finden Degen und Spies und dergleichen Narrenwerk, und sprechen: Die Schrift sey so finster, daß wir sie nicht mögen verstehen ohne der heiligen Väter Auslegung ... Wenn sie denn nun einen Spruch der Väter wieder mich aufbringen, so läuten sie alle Glocken, schlagen alle Drummeln, und schreien feindlich, sie haben gewonnen. Luther: Von dem bleyern Degen Bocks Emsers.

And the more everything was referred to the substantiality of faith and not to the contingency of works, the easier it was to show the completeness of Scripture. Therefore he said, when the Catholics

[65] were, in the Catholic Church and devoted to it with their hearts, were so thoroughly permeated by the Church's teaching in its entirety that, as their interpretation too sufficiently proves, they did not so much draw the fundamental dogmas of faith out of Scripture as recognize them as deposited in it; and although, in opposition to the allegories the Catholics employed so as to be able to interpret every passage to their own advantage, they insisted on the literal meaning and on a comparison of parallel passages of Scripture, they nonetheless wanted Scripture explained in the light of the totality, so that the Old Testament could not be unfolded except with the help of the [66] New Testament¹⁾. Nor was this to be wondered at, for despite the differences of the times the Holy Spirit had been the same, and it could in truth have had Christ in mind, although it addressed its words to the Jews¹⁾.

Here, then, is where the negation and restoration of the phenomena of which we spoke above has its beginning. For when Luther undertakes to read Scripture and to judge the greater or lesser truth of the traditions, the Spirit of truth is present in his consciousness, so that he does not judge merely by a subjective estimate. But how did he obtain this Spirit? Not through any peculiar inspiration, like the *Enthusiasts*²⁾;

referred to John 21, 25: Es ist nicht alles geschrieben, was wir thun sollen. Danck habt ihr guten Gesellen, ihr wisset der Schrift Auslegung wohl zu geben. S. S.

¹⁾Die heilige Schrift dringet vielmehr auf den Sohn, als auf den Vater: denn die ganze Schrift ist um des Sohnes willen geschrieben: darum sind auch im alten Testament mehr Sprüche oder Zeugnisse vom Sohne als vom Vater. — Luth. Schrift. III. 4. Denn da steckt es, da bleibt es, wer diesen Mann, der da heist Jesus Christus Gottes Sohn, den wir Christen predigen, nicht recht und rein hat, noch haben will, der lasse die Bibel zu frieden, das rathe ich, er stößt sich gewisslich und wird, je mehr er studiret, je blinder und toller.

Wenn es nun sollte Wünschens und Wählens gelten, entweder, daß ich S. Augustini und der lieben Väter, das ist der Apostel Verstand in der Schrift sollte haben, mit dem Mangel, daß S. Augustinus zuweilen nicht die rechten Buchstaben oder Worte im Ebräischen hat, wie die Juden spotten ... ich liesse die Juden mit ihrem Verstande und Buchstaben zum Teufel fahren, und führe mit S. Augustini Verstande ohne ihre Buchstaben zum Himmel. Auslegung der letzten Worte Davids 2 Sam. 23, 1—7. Schr. IV. 303.

¹⁾Thus Luther himself cannot refrain, quite contrary to his own principle, from sometimes adding an allegorical meaning, e.g. Genes c. 9 on Noah: Darum willst du es ohne Gefahr deuten, so deute es auf den Herrn Christum. Denn wie *Noah den Weinberg pflanzt und des Weins trincket*, davon *truncken wird* und einschläfft, *und bloß in der Hütten lieget*, und wird von diesem verlacht, aber von andern *zugedecket*: also ist es auch Christo ergangen.

²⁾Thus he writes to Amsdorff about the new prophets: Durch die Zwickauer Propheten lasst Euch nicht so schnell bewegen! Ihr habt ja Zeugnisse der Schrift, die Euch sicher machen, daß Ihr nicht sündiget, so Ihr sie hinausschiebet und zuerst die Geister prüfet, ob sie aus Gott sind ... Mir wahrlich ist das dem ersten Anblick nach gar verdächtig, daß sie sich der Gespräche mit der göttlichen Majestät

but through the total impression he received in his persistent study of the traditions and of Scripture. A true reconciliation of the objective and the subjective moment had thus taken place; that he asserted his subjective freedom is seen from the fact that no opinion given from outside produced a blind submission in him; but objective reality was preserved just as well, for he recognized that only through the appropriation of the objective phenomena can one come to the truth¹⁾. At this standpoint, then, a [67] true transition is also possible from the pure universality of spirit to its particular concrete determinations; for when the universal idea of truth has by its light negated the traditions and the passages of Scripture in their particularity, it will always strive anew to restore the negated forms; and when Luther insisted that Holy Scripture should be the norm for the unfolding of the opinions of the Fathers, and faith in Christ a necessary condition for the unfolding of the individual passages of Scripture, it was not the idea of Christ torn loose from its particular determinations that he insisted on; this careful examiner of the very least utterances of Scripture²⁾ never made Christ the object of his thought without at the same time looking to all the individual passages of Scripture that portray Christ for us³⁾. As the moments thus flow infinitely over [68] into one another, we see the objective spirit really present in Luther, we see it make his spirit into an organ for itself, inasmuch as he, as an *ἄνθρωπος πνευματικὸς*, tests everything *through faith*¹⁾. It therefore lay in the nature of the case that preachers of

rühmen..

¹⁾So Gott sein Heiliges Evangelium hat aus lassen gehen, handelt er mit uns auf zweierley Weise. Ein äusserlich; das andere mahl innerlich. Äusserlich handelt er mit uns durch mündliche Wort des Evangelii und durch die leiblichen Zeichen, als da ist, Tauffe und Sacrament. Innerlich handelt er mit uns, durch den H. Geist und Glauben ... also, daß er's beschlossen hat, keinem Menschen die innerlichen Stücke zu geben, ohne durch die äusserlichen Stücke. Wieder die himmlischen Propheten. Schrift. XIX., 186.

²⁾Ach es ist Dollmetschen ja nicht eines Jeglichen Kunst, wie die tolln Heiligen meinen; es gehöret dazu eine recht fromm, treu, fleissig, furchtsam, christlich, gelehrtes, erfahren, geübt Herz. Cf. Pfizer S. S. P. 843—852.

³⁾Also weiset er uns allenthalben in die Schrift, warum das? Darum daß du kannst bewahren den Christlichen Glauben. Es ist mir wohl selbst begegnet, wenn ich das Wort habe fahren lassen, daß ich Gott, Christum und alle mit einander verlohren habe. *Es ist auch kein leichter Weg alle Artickel des Glauben zu verlieren, denn ausser der Schrift daran zu gedencken.* III. Predigt über das Evangelium am Ostermont. Luc. 24, 13, 25, zu Coburg geh. 1530. Schrift. XV. 631.

¹⁾Ich will mich hören lassen, und wie St. Petrus lehret, meiner Lehre Ursach und Grund beweisen für alle Welt, und sie ungerichtet haben von jedermann, auch von allen Engeln. Denn sintemal ich ihr gewiß bin, will ich durch sie, euer und auch der Engel (wie St. Paulus spricht) Richter seyn, daß wer meine Lehre nicht annimmt, daß der nicht möge selig werden.

the Word who came forward, driven by the unshakable conviction of its truth, had to declare their opponents either deceived or deceivers, even though they thereby seemed to stand in open contradiction with themselves, since they themselves were weak mortals and were preaching precisely against the infallibility of any mortal. This contradiction was resolved, however, by their sharply distinguishing between the teaching insofar as it was their own and the objectively grounded truth that had its immediate and original expression in Holy Scripture²⁾. For the sake of their hearers' welfare they had to make this separation, which was as far from weakening the force of their own conviction as it was from having arisen out of a feigned modesty; for even if their words were the most perfect expressions of the truth, the hearers could nevertheless not make what they had heard their true property except by themselves [69] making it the object of an investigation; nor was the speaker's conviction of the truth of his teaching thereby shaken, since he hoped precisely, through a thorough and open investigation of the matter, to be able to convince others too of the truth of that at which he himself had arrived by the way of conviction, and to be able to trace back whatever difference of opinion might possibly remain to a merely subjective peculiarity in the contending parties; unity, then, was sought not in everyone's holding the very same opinions, but in the fullness of truth satisfying everyone's religious need. Truth, then, exists only for the testing consciousness¹⁾, is not content with dead propositions but desires living subjects; it therefore appears in a peculiar shape in each individual's consciousness; there are, then, as many truths as there are subjectivities. But so as not itself to vanish through subjective particularism in the dispersal of its elements, it gathers its confessors and summons them to mutual communication and discussion; thus the religious colloquy is called forth. Hence the age of the Reformers may rather be called the age of colloquies than the age of councils. Councils suit hierarchs, who, although they lay claim to a priestly infallibility, treat truth in the

²⁾Nicht also du Narr, höre und laß dir sagen. Zum Ersten bitte ich, man wollt meines Namens schweigen und sich nicht Lutherisch sondern Christen heissen. Was ist Luther? Ist doch die Lehre nicht mein. Luthers tr. Ermahn. a. all. Christen Schrift. XVIII. P. 289.

¹⁾Für das erste (viz. werden die Geister geprüft) durch ein innerlich Urtheil, da ein jeder Christ durch den Heiligen Geist und Gottes Gnade, für sich und sein Gewissen, also erleuchtet ist, daß er aufs allergewisseste schliessen und urtheilen kann von allen Lehren.

Und diese Gewißheit gehört zum Glauben, und ist von nöthen einem jeden Christen, ob er gleich nicht ein Prediger oder in öffentlichem Amte ist. Luth. w. Crasm. Schr.: XIX.

manner of laymen, by comparing opinions and counting votes in an external way; colloquies, on the other hand, suit laypeople, who lay aside the borrowed nimbus of infallibility and, in the name of objective truth, set faith over against faith, subjectivity over against subjectivity, in order through this ordeal by fire to come to certainty as [70] to who are the true priests¹⁾. But in such religious colloquies two moments are to be observed: on the one side, namely, each of the disputants has his own spiritual fullness, to which his consciousness is *inwardly* bound in a universal way; on the other side he turns *outward*, in that he wants to describe and defend this subjectivity of his; each therefore endeavors to determine his subjectivity more precisely through particular opinions and to secure it through particular grounds, so that they may thus correct one another and arrive at the perfect truth. — But if all difficulties are to be removed along this path, then, in the first place, the mystical and obscure side that is usually found in every human being's interior must come forth clearly before consciousness; for only when one is perfectly clear to oneself can one give others a perfect portrayal of one's subjectivity, — but this will hardly be able to happen before the kingdom of blessedness has come —; and next, the utterance of subjective truth must not be a merely subjective confession, but must be traced back to an inner necessity, as the true method demands, — but method was foreign to the spirit of this age.

Those sermons and religious colloquies aimed more at becoming conscious of their mutual spiritual kinship than at arriving at true conceptual clarity²⁾. It was the feeling of this spiritual kinship, awakened by the Master's mighty voice, that founded the Church to which we confess; and so quickly did this feeling penetrate [71] that, although the subjective Luther, if we may so put it, left the council at Worms as an outlaw, scarcely 10 years had passed before the objective Luther returned to the council at Augsburg, strengthened by the rich blessing of the Reformation. And just as Luther constantly appealed to the objective testimony of God's Word, although he

¹⁾It was therefore natural that the Pope did not hasten to convene a council for the Protestants' sake; for he wanted to command, whereas they wanted to dispute and "to bring their case before a general, free and Christian council."

²⁾Therefore at the council in Marburg, after they had discussed everything without coming to agreement, from the metaphysical properties of the body down to the most insignificant particles of Scripture, Luther pushed away the hand that Zwingli, with tears in his eyes, held out to him, with the words: "Ihr habt einen andern Geist, denn wir!"

held unshakably fast to his faith, so too the Augsburg Confession arrogates to itself no authority beside or above Scripture, but on the contrary derives its whole validity from it¹⁾.

§ 15.

The Symbols. Lutheran Scholasticism.

The external organism that the objective spirit forms for itself from within, it breaks down again from within in the course of time. So long as it is still occupied with this, the basic features of the organism remain the same, and all is calm, although the form grows old and the vigor of youth withers; but once time has carried its fruit to term, then it is seized by labor pains, then the elements of life are shaken, and amid violent pangs of birth the new shape of things breaks forth. The spirit of Protestantism, which had not been willing to bear the Catholic yoke, had given subjective freedom [72] such slack reins²⁾ that even its champions often shrank back; one cannot wonder, then, that they now sought, as far as possible, to raise a dam against the rushing torrent. But the best means of giving the teaching the necessary firmness was that public confession of faith. For people soon became conscious of the distance that, by the nature of the case, must always obtain between the objective truth of Scripture and the subjective religious consciousness, and as a consequence the general endeavor aimed not so much at proving the unconditional validity of Scripture — for on that everyone already agreed —, as at interpreting it rightly; but the only infallible criterion of a true interpretation of Scripture is that consciousness be able to find itself again in it, and just such a criterion was furnished by the symbols of Protestantism.

Thereby a bond was also laid upon the opposition that had arisen in the individual congregations between the various subjectivities. For since subjective faith, which

¹⁾*Offerimus in hac religionis causa nostrorum concionatorum et nostram confessionem, cujusmodi doctrinam ex scripturis sanctis et puro verbo Dei hactenus illi in nostris terris ... et in ec clesiis tractaverint. Præf. ad Cæs.*

²⁾Ulrich von Hutten's words to Luther: Wache auf die edle Freiheit! were a cry that had scarcely echoed across Germany before it called the most diverse combatants to arms.

Protestantism cannot combat with external weapons, had been led by the inner power of spiritual kinship to give its assent to the public confession and to acknowledge the teaching set forth in it in its entirety, it followed that individuals no longer contended with one another about their subjective faith, but that the individual subjectivity was judged by the universal objectivity¹⁾. But thereby there also arose, little by little, a [73] certain external limitation; the bold negation of forms and phenomena ceased, and since a violation of the validity of the confession of faith was now also regarded as a violation of truth itself, so that it was held to be a duty to exclude from the Church, or to imprison, those who twisted truth into a lie, the State too was at once at hand with its weapons¹⁾. — And yet the need to institute investigations and to raise objections had a far deeper ground than empty hair-splitting or quarrelsomeness. It lay, to be sure, in the nature of Protestant faith that at the beginning of the Reformation it addressed itself almost exclusively to the immediate religious consciousness, so that it not only separated the dogmas from purely historical objects²⁾, but even began, within the dogmas themselves, to separate the moral and practical moments from the objective and mysterious ones³⁾; but if this faith (ὑπόστασις) is to be able to find [74]

¹⁾*Omnino Philippus Melancton privatus hanc insignem mutationem (de confessione variata dicitur) fecit, inconsultis, quorum communis causa agebatur. Quare statim ac ista innotuit, improbavit illam elector Saxoniae, Johannes Fredericus, misitque ad Melanctonem cancellarium Pontanum, qui eum objurgaret: ... Walch: Introductio in libr. eccl. Luth. symb. p. 188.*

How often he had to defend his teaching against objections is shown by the following words of his own: *Non gigno novas opiniones, nec aliud majus scelus esse in Ecclesia Dei sentio, quam ludere fingendis novis opinionibus, et discedere a Prophetica et Apostolica scriptura et consensu vero Ecclesiae Dei. Sequor autem et amplector doctrinam Ecclesiae Vitebergensis et conjunctarum, qui sine ulla dubitatione consensus est Ecclesiae catholicae. Melanch. Opera p. I. p. 148 Locor. Theol. præfatio.*

¹⁾Compare with this — not to speak of the Calvinists' church discipline — the events in the crypto-Calvinist controversies. Walch. Historische und theologische Einleitung in die Religions=Streitigkeiten. 1 Th. 2 Cap.

²⁾Denn wo ich je deren eines mangeln sollte, derer Wercke oder der Predigt Christi; so wollte ich lieber derer Wercke, denn seiner Predigt mangeln. Denn die Wercke hülffen mir nichts; aber seine Worte, die geben das Leben, wie er selbst sagt Joh. 5, 51. Vorrede auf das N. T. XII. 55.

³⁾*Mysteria divinitatis rectius adoraverimus, quam vestigaverimus ... Proinde non est, cur multum operæ ponamus in locis illis supremis, de Deo, de unitate, de trinitate Dei, de mysterio creationis, de modo incarnationis ... Reliquos vero locos, peccati vim, legem, gratiam, qui ignorarit, non video, quomodo Christianum vocem; nam ex his proprie Christus cognoscitur, siquidem hoc est Christum cognoscere beneficia ejus cognoscere. Melancht. Loci com. præfatio ed. principis (ad ann. 1521 ref.)*

Hinfürder lehret er (Carlstad) uns, was Frau Hulda, die natürliche Vernunft, zu diesen Sachen sagt: gerade als wüsten wir nicht, daß die Vernunft des Teufels Hure ist und nichts kann denn lästern und schänden alles, was Gott redt und thut. Wieder die himmlischen Prophet. Schrift. XIX. p. 199 cf. Von

perfect rest in its substance, it must also have the fullest confidence in the firmness of the foundation on which it rests; for if it has its ground only in itself, then it cancels itself. Therefore faith cannot meet contradiction without passing over to testing the objectivity of its object as such, that is, to thinking¹⁾; by what path this transition takes place is another question.

[75] Absolute faith surrenders the whole human being to God in unconditional submission; it not only recognizes, in a practical respect, the great corruption of nature and the impotence of good works, but also, in a theoretical respect, calls darkened reason back to obedience under faith¹⁾. Nor was the severity with which that age sought to suppress reason mere subjective arbitrariness; for by reason was understood the everyday understanding, which abstracts all its concepts in an external way (cf. § 5), and must thus necessarily enter into sharp opposition to faith, which considers everything from within. Hence the theologians of that time laid so much weight on the proposition that a true and saving cognition of God could be drawn only from a special revelation²⁾. — But how can darkened consciousness be receptive to a true revelation? The greater the separation and opposition between the holy God and corrupted nature, the more wondrous must be the activity by which the dividing wall

Frau Hulda der klugen Vernunft Doctor Carlstads. Schrift. XIX. p. 208.

¹⁾Therefore Luther too cannot refrain, although he combats reason, from defending his teaching with objective grounds and analogies drawn from metaphysical relations; therefore he expressly takes refuge in thinking, so as not to confuse “*usus passionis*” with “*factum passionis*” or “*quod*” with “*qualiter*”: “Gilt denken und ist genug, so will ich auch denken, besser denn sie ...” cf. Bekenntniß vom Abendmahl Christ. XIX. 440. Melancthon too shows this transition from subjectivity to objectivity, in that, e.g., in the first edition of his *loci* (1521) he passed over the mystery of the Trinity and that of the Incarnation, among others, but in the later ones not only added them but even sought to explain them. Cf. *Edit. ann. 1548 absoluta* (In *Opp. Viteb. 1580 I. pg 148*).

Filius dicitur Imago et λόγος. Est igitur imago cogitatione Patris genita, qvod ut aliquo modo considerari possit, a nostra mente exempla capiamus ... Mens humana cogitando mox pingit imaginem rei cogitatæ, sed nos non transfudimus nostram essentiam in illas imagines ... At Pater æternus sese intuens gignit cogitationem sui, quæ est imago ipsius non evanescens, sed subsistens communicata ipsi essentia ... Dicitur λόγος, qvia cogitatione generatur. Dicitur Imago, qvia cogitatio est imago rei cogitatæ ... De Filio pg. 152.

¹⁾*Hominis intellectus et ratio in rebus spiritualibus prorsus sunt coeca, nihilque propriis viribus intelligere possunt. Form. Concord. Cfr. Hase: Hutterus red. 3 Aufl. Pg. 65 etc.*

²⁾*Datur quidem revelatio naturalis, sed prorsus mutilata: Ut post splendidæ domus conflagrationem favillæ et adustæ particulæ, aut post collapsum gravissimo casu ædificium rudera nonnulla remanent, ita quoque vix tenues qvædam reliqvæ ac ἐρείπια divinæ imaginis et parvæ scintillæ primævæ lucis, qvæ in mente hominis ante lapsum fulgebat, in natura jacente et misere prostrata supersunt. Qvenst. Theolog. Pars I p. 7. Θέσις XIII not. III.*

between the two is broken down. If, then, a revelation is to become possible, nature must become other, he who is above nature must show himself visibly in it; there must appear an immediate identity of the mutually opposed moments, i.e. a miracle must take place. But if God is to make himself known through miracles, he can be cognized in his phenomena only in the following way. One hears God speak, one sees heavenly figures reveal themselves; everything that is heard with the ears and [76] seen with the eyes is fact for the pious believer. In everything that shines forth in the phenomena, the mysteries of divine truth are revealed. — But a contradiction lies hidden in the concept of a revealed mystery; for insofar as a revelation takes place, to that extent the mystery descends into the sphere of phenomena; through this descent a natural moment shows itself in the mystery, and in this respect it cannot then be distinguished from other phenomena; but insofar as it is a revelation of the mystery, it also contains a supernatural moment and is infinitely exalted above all other phenomena. One must therefore know how to distinguish the phenomenon of the mystery from all other phenomena. But if one cannot acknowledge the divinity of the phenomenon without knowing the mystery, and cannot know the mystery without acknowledging the divinity of the phenomenon, then surely a revelation is required in order to cognize the revelation, then surely the cognition of the mysteries and miracles is itself a miracle.

Every special revelation of God can thus be referred to the two principal miracles, inspiration and the illumination mediated from inspiration through the Church. — As the former has given us a perfect presentation of divine things in infallible Scripture¹⁾, so the latter enlightens consciousness to see clearly and rightly¹⁾. It is then easy to [77] understand what is meant by the demand that we take reason captive. For all the

¹⁾... *revelationes certis testimoniis in verbo suo proposuit, in quo ceu foetus in alvo materna nutrimentum attrahens ex umbilico et cotyledonibus nos quoque sedemus inclusi, et attrahimus agnitionem Dei et vitam ex verbo Dei, ut cum invocemus, sicut se patefecit. Melancht. l. c. cap. I pg. 151 ... in Scriptura Canonica nullum est mendacium, nulla falsitas, nullus vel minimus error sive in rebus, sive in verbis. Qvenst. l. l. p. I. p. 77.*

¹⁾... *adeo ignorans et perversa est ratio illa, ut etiamsi ingeniosissimi et doctissimi homines in hoc mundo Evang. de Filio Dei et promissiones divinas de æterna salute audiant, tamen ea propriis viribus percipere et vera esse statuere nequeant. F. C. cfr. Hntt. red. Pg. 67.*

Fides divina, qva qvi infallibiliter credit, hoc verbum, qv od Scriptura proponit, esse vere Dei verbum, immediate oritur a vi et potestate S. Scripturæ intrinseca, qva Scriptura ipsa ad generandam fidem sibi debitam efficax est. Qvenst. p. I. pg. 98.

phenomena of revelation must be considered from a twofold side. Considered from the objective side, God reveals himself in them: he truly thinks as he speaks; he is in himself as he wills to be represented by human beings; he is triune, for he has revealed himself as triune; he is *truthful*²⁾. But although God is truth, and his nature cannot contradict itself, human reason nevertheless grasps only those properties in God that resemble its own and belong to our world; since, then, God has a nature of his own, reason itself recognizes that with respect to this nature it must deny its own [78] validity³⁾. But on the other side we are surely to know the phenomena of revelation and apply them to our own life; if, now, human reason had to declare them to contradict one another, so that we would always have to be in doubt about their truth, then in actuality no revelation would fall to our share at all. It will therefore be expedient, in the realm of the divine phenomena, to employ reason in a formal respect¹⁾. — What, now, is the supreme law that reason, reinstated in its lawful dominion, must lay down? Since the revealed truths cannot be conceived in the sense that one could demonstrate the dialectical transition between them, and the ordering activity has only the task of showing that they can all exist alongside one another, because the certainty of their existence derives solely from their having been revealed²⁾, one must above all hold fast to the well-known proposition that what is actual must also be [79] possible (*ab esse ad posse valere consequentiam*). This law entails that logic itself now renounces the use of its own rules, now is summoned to use them. Thus in the dogma

²⁾ *Causa certitudinis est revelatio Dei, qui est verax. Melanch. l. l. pg. 148.*

³⁾ *Quando obijciunt adversarii (Socin, Armin.) religionem multa habere supra, nihil vero contra rationem, respondeo: 1) Articuli fidei in se non sunt contra rationem, sed solum supra rationem; per accidens vero fit, ut sint etiam contra rationem, quando ratio iudicium sibi de illis sumit ex suis principiis, nec sequitur lucem verbi, sed eosdem negat et impugnat. Qvenst. p. 45 XIX Distinct.*

Cognitio Dei naturalis non extendit sese ad essentiam divinam, quatenus illa relativa seu in Tribus Personis consideratur ... Ibid. p. 265 Θεσις.

Congruentiae naturales et analogia creaturarum rerum cum hoc mysterio non divinam fidem, sed opinionem tantum humanam generant ... Ibid. "Εκθεσις p. 266 IV. Obst

¹⁾ *Aliud est principia et axiomata philosophica in Theologia adhibere illustrationis, declarationis et secundariae probationis gratia, ubi res e Scriptura definita est; et aliud, adhibere eadem decisionis et demonstrationis causa, vel principia philosophica et ratiocinationes ex illis factas pro principio in Theologia agnoscere, aut ex illis de rebus fidei iudicium ferre. Ibid. p. 42 II Obs. cf. III. IV. V VI. Distinct.*

²⁾ *Etsi autem omnes Angelicae et humanae mentes obstupescunt admiratione hujus arcani, quod Deus Filium genuit ... tamen sic sentire necesse est, quia, ut toties jam dictum est, de Deo sentiendum est, sicut se patefecit ... quoniam haec arcana non penitus perspicimus, tamen in hac vita Deus inchoari vult hanc agnitionem, et invocationem nostram a falsa discerni. Ibid. p. 15.*

of the Trinity logic falls silent; for one God has revealed himself in three persons, therefore One can be in Three; on the other hand, one ought to listen to reason when, according to its own rules, it sets forth the doctrine of the omnipresence of Christ's body, although this is not expressly set forth in Scripture, for Christ has surely been revealed as the one who at once sits at God's right hand and is really present in the Lord's Supper¹). Hence there also arises the division of the *articuli fundamentales* of faith into *primarii* and *secundarii*, and of its *articuli conservativi* into *antecedentes* and *consequentes*²). — Since by this mode of treatment one could arrive at no insight into the essence of the divine nature, but only consolidated an external acquaintance with its mysteries, and these were not drawn forth from the phenomena in which they had appeared but rather remained enclosed in them, a separation between the idea and its external form was naturally impossible, and one only tied the external bond [80] between dogmatics and sacred history all the tighter. Human traditions had been rejected and the Catholics' *τερατολογία* given up; one was therefore all the more zealous in guarding the foundation of supernatural facts that had been left untouched by doubt, and could not concede, even in the most insignificant points of sacred history, the possibility of any error in inspired Scripture¹). Since the theologians thus

¹) Gerhard: *Qværitur, sitne corpus Christi vere et substantialiter in coena præsens? Affirmant Eccles. nostræ, qvia Christus dicit: Hoc est etc. Negant adversarii ex hoc principio, qvia verum et naturale corpus non potest simul et semel esse in pluribus locis. Addunt, rationem renatam non posse aliter de corpore statuere, testimonium ergo ejus audiendum esse. At inquam, ratio renata, qvatenus talis de art. fidei statuit ex Dei verbo, et limites ejus non egreditur. Cfr. Hutt. red. p. 71.*

²) Divisions which show that our fathers did not neglect to take account of the principles of reason: "*Articuli consequentes sunt, qvi explanant fidei salvificæ consequentia, qvibus positus fides confirmatur, non positus evanescit.*" *Art. secundarii, qvi "licet ignorari possint illæso fidei salutisque fundamento, pertinaciter tamen negari salvo illo non possunt, nedum impugnari."* Hutt. rediv. § 17 p. 24. 25.

¹)... *omnia et singula sunt verissima, qvæcunqve in illâ traduntur: sive dogmatica illa sint sive moralia, sive Historica, Chronologica, Topographica, Onomastica, nullaue ignorantia, incogitantia aut oblivio, nullus memoriæ lapsus Spiritus Sanctus amanuensibus in consignandis sacris litteris tribui potest aut debet. Qvenst. p. I pg. 77 Θέσις.*

And it was not only dogmatists toward the end of the 17th century who put forward such opinions; historians too, in the latter part of the 19th century, have in like manner distinguished between divine and human sources:

Ihre (i.e. Holy Scripture's) Verfasser haben nicht allein nie geirret, sondern auch nicht einmal irren können, und ihre Erzählungen sind daher nicht allein so gewiß, als jede andere historische Wahrheit, sondern auch untrüglich gewiß. Ch. W. F. Walch, krit. Nachricht v. d. Quellen der Kirchengeschichte. Leipz. 1770 p. 23. — They therefore not only, following Luther's example, made manifold fruitful applications of sacred history to the life of Christians in a moral respect, but even grounded important dogmas on events narrated in Scripture:

[81] regarded Scripture's letters as the sole and sufficient foundation for positive doctrine, while they denied the Enthusiasts (the Schwenkfeldians and Weigelians), with their spiritual inspirations and angelic revelations, all credence, their whole endeavor went toward fixing the objective forms of faith. They therefore did indeed abstain from empty speculations, for they would not, like the Scholastics, "set up a centaur-like theology, a *mixtum compositum* of divine revelations and philosophical inferences of reason"; but they nevertheless left to reason the important calling of ordering and arranging the material. For in the great mass of objects one might fear that the one would seem to contradict and cancel the other, and one therefore had to take care to demonstrate, as best one could, the possibility of the mutual subsistence of all

[82] the moments. Reason then had to undertake to carry out this laborious work by its affirmations, negations, distinctions, divisions, and exceptions. And as it now, in the subtle analysis of the individual moments, stated τὸ ζητούμενον, set up τὴν θέσιν, added τὴν ἀντίθεσιν, took on τὴν βεβαίωσιν, the work grew into such a mass of propositions that we are uncertain what we should most admire, — the perseverance with which reason, admittedly quite mechanically, fitted together all the individual parts, or — the strength that enabled faith to bear this great building, erected out of the most opposed elements¹. This magnificent temple in the grand style, which the

Thus, e.g., E. Brochmand, by comparison and ingenious analysis of a few passages of Scripture (Gen. 1, 26, 27; Eph. 4, 24; Col. 3, 10), refutes with little trouble all of Bellarmine's objections against the doctrine of the perfection and immortality of the first human being. *Univ. Theol. Syst. p. 124. Quæst. III. IV.*

In his proof that there was in the first human being's cognition a special agreement with God "ὁ πρωτοτύπος", Qvensted says: ... *Ex Adami factis qvalia sint* 1) Ονοματοθεσία, *sive nominum conveniens impositio* Gen. 2. 19, *qvæ erat non solum Grammatica, qvoad nomenclaturam animalium, sed vel maxime Logica, qvoad verissimam definitionem*. Indeed, the personality of the Holy Spirit was proved in the same historical manner; so already Melanchton: ... *impio sophismati Ecclesia vera opponit testimonia in scripturis tradita, qvorum primum et maxime illustre est revelatio divinitatis, facta in baptismo Christi, ubi clare discernuntur tres personæ. Pater inquit: Hic est Filius meus dilectus. Est igitur alia persona Patris, alia Filii. Descendit autem Spiritus Sanctus in specie columbæ. Jam si Spiritus esset agitatio in animis creata, non appareret peculiari specie corporali.*

Sic et in Pentecoste apparet Spiritus Sanctus peculiari specie corporali. Hæ patefactiones non sunt frustra factæ, immo sunt excellentia beneficia Dei, in qvibus Deus se patefecit Ecclesiæ, et testificatus est Spiritum Sanctum esse personam. S. S. Pg. 137.

And following his example Qvensted too proves the Trinity "ex singulari illa θεοφανεία, facta in baptismo Christi ... ut vere dictum sit ab antiqvis: 'abi Ariane ad Jordanem! et videbis Trinitatem'" Pg. 324.

¹)Das dogmatische System des 16-und 17 Jahrhunderts kam mir vor wie einer unsrer alten deutschen

human spirit, returning from exile, built for itself, was built up and fortified amid the manifold storms of a turbulent age; always in arms, always ready for battle, these men raised their building; — whether it was gold and silver and precious stones of which they built it, or whether it was wood and hay and straw, only the dawning day, the testing fire, will show.

§ 16.

Continuation. Transition to Criticism.

The absolute agreement between the essence and its phenomena, on which this building rests, sublates itself. For since the divine nature has revealed itself not in one but in several phenomena, and is expressed not in one but in many mutually contradictory ways, there must truly be in every expression of the idea of God something more or less inadequate¹⁾; one must consequently be able to take the individual word in different senses in its different places, and to distinguish between what is said in a proper and what in an improper sense²⁾. One then reverses the rule and infers from a thing's impossibility to its non-actuality (*a non posse esse ad non esse valere consequentiam*), — but in this way reason recovers its lost freedom, for it is, after all, reason that must compare the individual expressions. Where two expressions are so opposed to one another that the one obviously excludes the other, the result will of course differ according as one takes the one or the other of them to be certain. But which is to remain standing and which is to go can be decided as little by the sum of the revealed utterances — for it is precisely the individual utterances that are at issue —, as by reason itself, for what subjective reasoning at this standpoint is concerned with,

Münster mit seinen himmelstrebenden Spitzbogen und wunderlichen sinnvollen Zierrathen ... Einen Dom wie unsre Vorfahren kann auch unsre Zeit nicht wieder bauen ... es wird einem aber doch ganz besonders wie in einem Gotteshause darin zu Muth. Hase: Der theol. Facult. zu Tübingen (*Hut. rediv.*)

¹⁾*Quia intellectus noster finitus infinitam et simplicissimam Dei essentiam uno conceptu adæquato adæquate concipere nequit, ideo distinctis et inadæquatis conceptibus essentiam divinam inadæquate repræsentantibus eandem apprehendit. Quenst. P. 284.*

²⁾Here belong all anthropomorphisms; thus Qvensted distinguishes “*ea, quæ imperfectionem aliquam subinferunt et Deo proprie tribui nequeunt, sed improprie et per ἀνθρωποπάθειαν ipsi adscribuntur, ut affectus et organa corporea, ut ira, odium, manus, pedes, oculi*” etc. ... P. 296.

solely and exclusively, is precisely to have a fixed and unshakable point of departure; but in this way the entire system of objective doctrine vanishes, and only subjective [84] faith in its full indeterminacy remains. One can then grant that one God has revealed himself in three persons, and yet at the same time, by the rule cited above, conclude that where three persons in God are spoken of, this can, on account of God's unity, only be taken in a figurative sense¹⁾. — Since one sought to fix doctrine in this way, it was a matter of course that subjective faith also had to hold fast to the individual propositions of doctrine, just as it sought to defend the truth revealed in Scripture in general; for if the truth of one article of faith could be called into doubt, it would of course also be easy in the same way to weaken faith in each of the others. Therefore in the religious colloquies one could not give way on any point whatsoever; disputes were always conducted *de omni et de nullo*. Hence the unhappy outcome of the irenic colloquies²⁾; hence the fruitlessness of the Syncretists' efforts to keep to the middle [85] way; hence the vehemence, the partisanship, the fanaticism and the furious rancor of the theologians of that time. It is only by developing to the extreme that such systems are completed and sublated; therefore one must always observe them in the course of their own development.

The fundamental principle of faith is thinking; therefore faith demands an immediate identity of the subjective and the objective moment; but in this there also lies hidden an immediate opposition. The former emerges first, the latter later. When the subject, in immediate agreement, gives itself over to the object, it does not occur to the believer to institute an external comparison between himself and the object of his

¹⁾Thus the Socinians' objection: *Quoniam essentia divina tantum unica est numero, ideo nullatenus plures in eâ possunt esse personæ. Catech. Racov. Cap. 1, p. 21.*

Indeed, Volkeliu*s* *Libr. V. de V. R. cap. IX. fol. 401* goes so far as to ascribe the doctrine of the Trinity to "the old liar Satan"; and Joachim Stegmannus teaches that this mystery conflicts both with *Scripture* and with *reason*. Cf. Quenst. P. 345.

²⁾Thus, e.g., complaints are made in vehement terms about the Colloquy at Thorn:

Quæ sunt gesta tribus Thoruna mensibus urbe,

Hæc potuere tribus cuncta diebus agi.

and

Quid synodus? nodus. Patrum chorus integer? æger.

Conventus? ventus. Gloria? stramen. Amen.

Cf. Dr. K. H. Hagenbach: *Vorles. üb. W. Geschicht. d. Reform. 4 Theil, P. 148—149.*

On the syncretistic controversies, which furnish rich contributions to the characterization of that age, cf. J. G. Walch. *R. Str. 1 Theil, § 5, P. 216 ff.*

faith, — for the thought of having to institute a careful and petty examination of the properties of both, or that these should need to be adjusted to one another in order to accord with one another, is unnatural to the first, immediate faith —; but, gripped by the greatness of the object in which he believes, his whole endeavor goes toward determining and fixing the forms of objective faith. From this arose precisely the Protestant faith's desire to set up systems. — But when faith has thus immersed itself in pure objectivity, the relation changes. For the absolute validity of the objective system shows itself in this, that the objects hold not because they are conceived, but because they are factually given. The system then appears as something foreign that is to be obeyed because it demands obedience, i.e., objectivity swallows up subjectivity. But thereby the system also tears itself down; for though its subjective origin has been forgotten, it is in actuality faith that created it; therefore the subjective consciousness feels itself hampered by foreign, external bonds when the system would assert itself over spirits in an external manner; it begins to reflect, and now the oppositions come forth; but then the objective system, too, will dissolve and perish, because it is only [86] on the immediate sympathy of subjectivity with it, if one may say so, that its whole power rests.

Since, therefore, the individual propositions of faith had been immediately set up in this theology, faith itself passed over into being a sum of external propositions, a petrified formalism. One collected with the greatest avidity *dicta probantia* and *loci communes*, not in order to justify the statements of Scripture from within, in the name of truth, but in order, in the name of Scripture, to come in an external manner into tangible possession of the truth: one worshiped the individual words and signs in Scripture. Therefore spirit withdrew from this objectivity of spirit; therefore the true light of the Bible was darkened under this *bibliolatry*. — A negation of the positive forms followed upon this formalism; the religious consciousness began to seek the truth in its own interior, and the powers of our Scholastics were exhausted in struggles against the Pietists.

Thus the second moment in faith now emerged. The subject is indeed to give itself over to the object with its whole heart; but — once bitten, twice shy; therefore the believer must first turn his eye inward into the depths of his own consciousness and

examine his own heart. — Protestantism thus contains not only its own negation but in equal measure its own restoration; as the real moment had at the beginning been the preponderant one, precisely because it immediately gripped conviction, so now little by little the formal moment gained greater significance, so that philosophy, at the very same time as Protestantism, after the end of the Thirty Years' War, obtained full recognition and legal existence in the state, could turn away from theology and teach *that one should doubt everything*. In the name of concrete faith Luther asserted freedom of conscience in the 16th century; in the name of freedom, in the 18th and [87] 19th centuries, his true followers defended freedom and thinking, and so make possible a rebirth of the objective, concrete doctrine of faith¹⁾.

§ 17.

Subjective Rationalism. The Profanation of Sacred History.

After the path on which one had previously sought to set up doctrine had been abandoned, the objective forms of faith, too, could not, at least for a time, escape being disdained, since these after all made up the proper basic material of the obsolete system; eager for occasion to undertake investigations and to exercise its thinking, the human spirit leaves untouched only that part of divine truth which immediately grips the religious heart, and then turns to other regions that can offer a new and richer material for it to work upon. — The objects of faith recede into the background, while the objects of this world lie nearest to the observer; the sensuous perceptions and [88] impressions, through which access to the wide field of experience stands open, are the first to meet the gaze that seeks an immediate identity of subject and object. Yet the

¹⁾... even in the case that the Reformers had meant not only to depict the spirit and tendency of Protestantism, and along with it their own and their contemporaries' religious conviction, but also to set up in this conviction an unalterable norm of faith for the following generations, one would have to lament the lot of humanity, which is weakness even in its greatest strength; but no obligation for the Protestant Church could be derived from this. Clausen: Cath. og Protest. P. 331.

Der Protestantismus hat, was vom Anfange in ihm lag, offenbart, die Entwicklung der religiösen Selbständigkeit, die durch freie Liebe und Einsicht am kirchlichen Vaterlande festhält so daß die Treue an Luthers Geiste zum Abfalle von seinen Buchstaben ... geworden ist. Hase: Kirchengesch. (1834) § 545.

observer will not long be satisfied with roaming about in external actuality, foreign to consciousness; he will soon recognize that it is only empirical things that are here the object of his thought. Thinking is a negation of the thing; therefore he turns his gaze away from sensuous nature and seeks a rational world order, in order to find himself again in this objectivity. Now although empiricism and abstract rationalism are wholly opposed to one another, since the one occupies itself with individual, concrete objects, the other, by contrast, solely with universal and abstract ones, they nonetheless readily join hands, for the elements of both attract consciousness, and abstract reason needs empirical knowledge in order to give its hollow concepts content out of the latter's fullness. As for the doctrine of faith, both stand in a wavering relation to it; on the one hand they are akin to faith: the content of faith is, after all, nothing other than the sum of spiritual realities, the same holds also of the objects we meet in our conscience, and finally both demand that the thinking spirit be able to find itself again in objectivity, but this the nature of faith also demands; — on the other hand they stand in direct opposition to faith. For faith derives all its elements from the holy God, exalted above our nature; these, by contrast, proceed from the subject and created nature and never overstep the profane bounds of this world of ours.

On account of this dubious kinship they enter into a double relation to the Church. For as soon as they betray the profane nature of their principles, they are turned away in the name of offended religiosity, and if they seek, with banner raised and drums beating, to storm the fortress of Christ, they fall before the sword of the mightier Spirit; if, on the other hand, they succeed in sneaking into the fortress in disguise, they [89] begin a secret undermining. Yet the cunning of these enemies is not to be understood as though they had by some means or other bribed conscienceless (κεκαυτερισμένους τὴν ἰδίαν συνείδησιν) theologians to cast suspicion on the truth of religion; on the contrary, theologians of this sort generally act from the fullest conviction and with a bold countenance. The struggles that arise from this are therefore also not waged directly over who is Christ's friend or enemy, but over what belongs to the essence of religion and what belongs only to its phenomena. For those who remain with the older method of teaching urge the supernatural moment in the sacred phenomena, declaring that these constitute the objective forms of faith and therefore cannot be

classed with the ordinary events that are subject to our judgment, any more than [90] they can be altered or volatilized without the greatest harm to religion itself¹⁾. The fundamental error in the investigation thus lies in this, that one does not infer from the truthfulness of the self-revealing God to the truth of the phenomena and forms through which the revelation takes place, but believes that through an investigation of the phenomena one can determine which moments are essential to the revelation. They therefore, trusting in the infallibility of human investigation, urge the natural side of the phenomena, and declare it a *petitio principii* if anyone, in the name of faith, holds fast to the individual forms and phenomena, since only by an investigation of them can one come to determine the objects of faith. And it is on this conviction, that truth cannot contradict truth, that empirical truth cannot sublate the truth of religion, that this school rests its authority¹⁾.

¹⁾The controversies that took place in the Reformed Church on the occasion of the critical treatment of Holy Scripture furnish, so to speak, a prototype for all similar debates. Thus Buxdorf declared Ludv. Capellus a novator, propheta, videns, *qui somniis indulgeret*. Capellus, by contrast, replied (*advers. Censorem Buxdorfium ... brevis oeconomia*): *Satis, mihi fuisset id ostendisse adversus Censorem meum ... nisi illi ipsi et aliis multis altius animo insedisset et infixæ esset hæc opinio: Actum esse de Dei verbo ejusque apud nos auctoritate, atque ex consequenti de hominum salute, (quæ non aliunde quam ex Dei verbo pendet), si apiculi isti non statuatur esse a Mose et Prophetis, libris suis, Deo eos docente, additi et adscripti*. And rightly does Georgius Pasor put the following words in the mouth of Sebastianus Pfoechenius, who is famous from the purist controversies:

*Diligo Philologum, qui eviscerat abdita verba,
Jure novum Chrtsti sed mage fedus amo,
Ergo novo quisquis de federe tenuia dicit,
En pupillam oculi vulnerat ille mei.*

*Falx critica in quosvis per me grassetur. At unis
A Bibliis fas est abstinuisse manus.*

¹⁾*Sunt tamen et pii et docti viri, qui cum vix habeant, quod tam manifestæ veritati opponant, pergunt nihilominus periculosas inde metuere consequentias. Quasi vero a veritate ullum jure metuendum sit veritate periculum! Verum certe vero semper consonat fertque opem, nunquam repugnat aut officit ... Ergo candido et christiano pectore, et forti constantique animo dignius esse existimavi, fateri in hac causa, quod res est, quam cum nonnullis id oppugnare, quod sine rubore ab eo, cui ingenua est frons, negari non potest. Ludv. Capellus. Arcan. punct. Præfatio ad lect.*

That thinking, like cognition itself, is universally valid, since it has faith as such within itself, Hegel has fully proved in his *Phænomenologie des Geistes* (Werke P. 410): Von dieser Seite, daß beide wesentlich dasselbe sind und die Beziehung der reinen Einsicht durch und in demselben Elemente geschieht, ist ihre Mittheilung eine unmittelbare, und ihr Geben und Empfangen ein ungestörtes Ineinanderfließen ... Die Mittheilung der reinen Einsicht ist deswegen einer ruhigen Ausdehnung oder dem Verbreiten wie eines Duftes in der widerstandslosen Atmosphäre zu vergleichen ... ein unsichtbarer und unbemerkter Geist, durchschleicht sie die edlen Theile durch und durch, und hat sich bald aller Eingeweide und Glieder der bewußtlosen Götzen gründlich bemächtigt, und "an einem schönen Morgen giebt sie mit

Under such a relation there could naturally no longer be any question of fixing [91] the positive forms of faith; the phenomena of revelation, which stemmed from grey antiquity, and the forms which had already been fixed in the course of time, became merely external objects for the investigator, and the results of his investigations could therefore consist only in finding out which events could have taken place, which had actually taken place, and which, finally, were to be regarded as products of a superstitious fantasy. Faith was then no longer the constitutive principle in theology, and although that which is taken as the standard can by its nature admit or recognize nothing other than what lies within its own bounds, nature was nevertheless made the standard for, and the judge over, supernatural things. One cannot therefore wonder that the positive elements of religion became fewer and fewer and at last vanished entirely. While empiricism thus proved that the Hebrew vowels had been invented neither by Adam nor by Moses, nay, not even by Ezra, that the Greek of the New Testament was not classically pure, that the reports of Holy Scripture were both self-contradictory and at variance with the testimony of credible profane writers, and that many of the individual books were by no means authentic¹⁾, subjective [92] rationalism, on the other hand, (which shows precisely the mutual relation between empirical knowledge and thinking), demonstrated the unreasonableness of assuming a supernatural inspiration²⁾, raised doubts about the possibility of miracles³⁾, and declared that regeneration was to be thought of solely and exclusively as a subjective change in man's free will⁴⁾.

dem Ellbogen dem Kammeraden einen Schub und Bautz! Baradautz! der Götze liegt am Boden."

¹⁾Cf. Selmers Abhandlung von freier Untersuchung des Kanon.

²⁾Cf. Eckermann: Beweis, daß der biblische Begriff der Offenbarung kein andrer, als Offenbarungsbe-
griff der gesunden Vernunft sey.

³⁾Die Verächter der Bibel nehmen gerade die gefährlichsten Waffen, womit sie das Ansehen, die Ehrwürdigkeit und Glaubwürdigkeit der Bibel bestreiten, aus der Behauptung der Vertheidiger derselben her, daß ihre Verfasser sich einer unmittelbaren und übernatürlichen Offenbarung und Eingebung rühmen. Die Verfasser der Bibel werden deswegen als eine Reihe von Schwärmern angeklagt und herabgewürdigt. The same: Handbuch der christ. Glaubenslehre 1 Theil P. 410.

Aber sagt man, wenn ein Mann von erprobter Frömmigkeit, Rechtschaffenheit und Wahrheitsliebe ... versicherte, daß Gott dies unmittelbar und übernatürlich bewirke ... sollten wir denn das einem solchen Manne nicht glauben? Die Vernunft antwortet: Nein! Es ist unmöglich, daß ein Mensch unmittelbaren Wirkungen Gottes erkenne! Auch der redlichste Mensch irrt, wenn er etwa dergleichen zu erkennen glaubt ... Ibid. P. 456.

⁴⁾Thus Paulus (Comment. over d. N. Test.) paraphrases John 3, 6 τὸ γεγεννημένον ἐκ τοῦ πνεύματος:

The higher the sun of reason climbed in the heaven of enlightenment, the farther the light of experience spread its rays, the more the radiance of the heavenly figures [93] paled, the more lights were extinguished in the supernatural heaven. The acuity of reason come of age discovered that the voice of God and the appearances of angels, of which Scripture so often reports, were indeed something that could appeal to minors (οἱ νήπιοι), but in actuality were for the most part only consequences of natural events, thunder and lightning or the like, and products of an excited fantasy; such revelations, then, consist not in the divine mysteries revealing themselves in transfigured nature, but in quite natural events being wrapped in the misty veil of human fantasy; one then need only draw the veil away in order to grasp the naked truth¹⁾. God, then, did not with an audible voice from the thorn bush choose Moses as his messenger in spite of his refusal, no! Moses imagined he heard Jehovah in the thorn bush set alight by the lightning, because his head was full of great plans; and neither is it God who dictated the Law through Moses, no, it was Moses who did so in God's name, since it is beneath [94] God's dignity to speak in articulated tones²⁾. Not only the angelic appearances of the Old Testament but also those of the New are to be regarded as human illusions. Sound reason teaches us, after all, that since no angels appear to us, neither can Gabriel have announced to Mary that she was to bear Christ; and since it is certain that nothing can come from nothing, and since what is natural, moreover, can be no shame to anyone, we do best to admit that Jesus was begotten in the natural way by Joseph and Mary¹⁾.

der Mensch, welcher durch seine Geisteskraft, Einsicht und Wollen des Guten sich selbst zeugt ... which he elucidates further by referring to Seneca, *de brev. vitæ*: "*Solemus dicere, non fuisse in nostra potestate, quos sortiremur parentes ... nobis vero ad arbitrium (!) uasci licet.*"

¹⁾Excellent examples of such a revelation are found in G. L. Bauer (*Mythologie des alten und neuen Test.* Leipzig 1802), and so ingenious are these that we cannot refrain from sharing some of them with the kind reader. Thus on Moses, P. 271. 1 Band: Moses stellte sich vor, ein brennender Dornbusch sey Jehova. *Kann das Geschichte seyn? Kann der brennende Busch wirklich Gott, oder nur Gott in demselben gewesen seyn? Ist Gott ein Feuer?* — P. 272: Ein Blitzstrahl fuhr in einen Dornbusch, als Moses weidete am Horeb mit seiner Heerde: Es war aber ein kalter Strahl, der nicht zündete ... Nach Hezel wars electrisches Feuer.

²⁾Ibid. P. 225 2 Band: Und daß Gott selbst vom Himmel geredet habe, ist auch schwer zu glauben, wenn reden heissen soll articulirte Töne, Worte der damaligen palästinischen Landessprache aussprechen; and P. 296. 1 Band: Hätte Gott selbst gesprochen, sollten denn die Israeliten so gar dumm, unempfindlich und hartnäckig gewesen seyn, daß sie gleich darauf sein Verbot des Bilderdienstes vergassen? Und für die zehn Gebote, welche zwar gut und meistens Natur- und Vernunftgebote sind, zu deren Erfindung aber kein göttlicher Verstand gehört, sollte eine Gesetzgebung vom Himmel nöthig sein?

¹⁾Soll die Erscheinung nur von einer Vision oder innern Intuition oder den eigenen Gedanken der

But how can one who is born in the natural way employ supernatural powers in his service! — John the Baptist likewise imagined that he saw the Holy Spirit, while in actuality he saw nothing but an ordinary dove that happened to fly past¹⁾. And the [95] apostles no doubt believed that Christ, transfigured on the mountain, had spoken with Moses and Elijah; but if one considers the matter a little more closely, it is easy to see that the disciples had merely slept and dreamed that night and then, when they had been awakened, rubbed their eyes and seen Christ lit up by the morning sun²⁾. One will therefore also see, on considering the true connection of the matter, that sacred history is not very different from profane history. For the heathen, too, believed they heard the voice of God in sudden thunder; their lawgivers, too, gave out their laws as dictated by God; indeed, these too took omens from the flight of birds (as John the Baptist did from that dove), just as they also readily believed in virgin-born heroes with divine fathers. Nonetheless one must not disdain the stories of Holy Scripture; for while many people awaken from apparent death without one's being able to see the purpose of Providence in it, one must praise divine Providence, because it has visibly so directed things that the most perfect and most pious man, who is set before us as a model for imitation, returned to life in order to raise up again the sunken courage of his disciples; and even if we can hardly infer from his resurrection to the immortality of our souls, we can nevertheless now have this confidence in God, that [96] we too, should we be carried off by an all-too-early apparent death, will, if God so

Maria erklärt werden, so fällt zwar der Einwurf von der persönlichen Erscheinung eines Engels weg, aber dafür ist unaufgeklärt, wovon denn die Maria ist schwänger geworden. Durch die bloße Einbildung hat sie doch wohl nicht schwanger werden können ... Weit natürlicher ist's, Jesum für einen Sohn des Josephs und der Maria, unsere Sage aber für eine später entstandenes Raisonement über die Entstehung des Messias zu halten Ibid. P. 192. 1 Band.

Neque vero fieri potest, ut religionis christianæ auctori major dignitas aut excellentia concilietur, si vitæ ejus partes et casus non secundum naturalem rerum humanarum viam a Deo constitutam, sed supranaturali sive miraculosa quadam ratione evenisse dicantur. Nam si hoc esset, consequeretur, naturales rerum in orbe gerendarum leges, a divina sapientia et omnipotentia constitutas, quasi minorem quandam dignitatem habere, hominumque præstantiam ex iis potius, quæ ipsis accidunt, quam ex ipsorum consiliis et factis debere existimari. Wegscheider: Institutiones Theol. Halæ 1833. p. 442 not. a.

¹⁾Der heilige Geist kann nicht wie eine Taube mit sichtbarer Gestalt herabgefahren seyn, denn er ist Gottes unsichtbare überall wirksame Kraft, wie hätte dieses sollen sichtbar werden? Bauer: I. I. P. 225. 2 Band.

²⁾The same, P. 213. 2 Band.

³⁾Ibid. P. 230. 2 Band.

⁴⁾Ibid. P. 192. 1 Band.

wills, return to this life in order thereby to promote the cognition of a rational world order; and although Christ did not ascend to heaven in a visible manner, but merely, hidden by a cloud, went down the mountain by an unknown path, he has nevertheless in this way received a far more glorious apotheosis than Romulus and Drusilla¹⁾, and rightly do we admire his virtue and strive to follow his example; only let one beware of worshipping him as though he were a god.

§ 18.

Faith and Knowledge in Critical Theology.

After criticism had thus sufficiently shown what it had in view, one would expect that it would either have been expelled from the Church or would itself have overthrown the Church's building; and yet, by the nature of the case, neither was possible. Criticism does indeed contain a negation of faith, but the question is at what point the [97] negation lies. Inasmuch as empiricism and subjective rationalism urge the worldly and, if one may say so, purely human moments, they at the same time negate the reality of the objects of faith, i.e., declare them to lie outside the limits of their own cognition. But this negation is not yet an assertion that that reality does not exist at all; for just as within the limits of their own cognition they hold fast in a positive way to the objects that belong to their sphere, so they can also very well acknowledge the existence of a reality lying outside the limits of their cognition. — But in this way a new reconciliation between faith and knowledge is prepared¹⁾. One cannot,

¹⁾Therefore Paulus says, not without religious emphasis, on the occasion of Luke 21, 51: Welch ein Gegensatz gegen dergleichen Apotheosen lag in Jesu ἀναλήψις, auf welche ... das alte Römergesetz würdig anzuwenden ist: *Divos et eos, qui coelestes semper habiti*, colunto, et illos quos endo coelo merita locaverunt, *Herculem, Liberum, Æsculapium, Castorem, Pollucem, Quirinum, et Horatii*:

*"Virtus, recludens immeritis mori
Coelum, negata tentat iter via:
Coetusque vulgares et udam
Spernit (!) humum fugiente penna."*

(Comment. üb. d. N. T. 3 Theil. Leip. 1805).

¹⁾How Kant, Jacobi, Schleiermacher, Friis and the eclectic theologians have in different ways modified these theorems of critical reason, it is not for us to develop more closely here, since our inquiry concerns only the nature of criticism in general.

to be sure, think the sum of the phenomena without assuming a unity of essence in them, cannot think the finite without thinking the infinite, cannot think the visible without thinking the invisible; but what can be conceived must belong to the finite sphere, for where there is conceiving, there one must also be able to separate the moments, and where the moments can be separated, there they must also be finite. Cognition therefore subjects to itself the whole sphere of finite objects and moments, but willingly renounces every conceiving of the realm of infinite and invisible existence, although from the limitation and restriction of its own sphere it concludes with certainty that this sphere must have its ultimate ground of existence in that realm. If, therefore, access to that realm is not to be closed to man, he must possess another faculty of reception than cognition; but in this way there arises a new separation in human consciousness itself, between cognition on the one side and will and feeling on the other side. By the *will* man is able, with the whole force of his subjectivity, to [98] surrender himself to the eternal and infinite realm, and by this surrender both the finite and the infinite moment are preserved; for as the finite subject is made subject to the dominion of the infinite subject, the latter is satisfied, while on the other side finite man satisfies himself by surrendering himself of his own free will. — By pure *feeling*, purified of all particular affections, the same reconciliation falls to the share of the religious mind. For in feeling there is an immediate identity of the subjective and the objective moment; one then need only abstract from all particularities, and one will then have the universal subject and the infinite object on which the former is absolutely dependent. — But from this there follows another, extremely important separation, namely a separation between the religious idea itself and the form in which it appears; and so great is the significance of this separation that from it one can derive the great change that has taken place in more recent theology.

For since forms and phenomena by their nature belong to the realm of the finite and must therefore be conceivable, one can in truth conclude conversely that God cannot be conceived by us, and that it cannot be the purpose of religion to make God an object of our conceiving; we must then distinguish between God as he is in himself, infinite and inconceivable, and the forms and phenomena in which he has revealed himself for our salvation. It is thus at this point that the newer theology departs from the

older. In the older theology God finds his true determination through his phenomena; he is himself present in them; they must therefore be received as they are given to us in revelation; — in critical theology, by contrast, the infinite God cannot be contained [99] in or limited by any form; therefore the phenomena and forms through which divine things are revealed to us must be regarded only from man's standpoint. The visible and the invisible, the realm of cognition and that of faith, therefore cannot, however much they may diverge, be kept perfectly separate from each other; like France and Spain, Spain and Portugal, they have the same borders in common, and since the concept of space cannot fittingly be applied to this relation, we rightly say that in the finite realm there are symbols and signs of, marks and traces of, the infinite realm. — Only by laying down these conditions did criticism, after so many fierce battles, bring about a peace between *faith* and *reason*, according to which everything that belongs to experience and logic was to fall to critical reason, yet on the condition that it abstain from everything that could in any way injure faith; on the other side faith was to content itself with its own realm, not to begrudge free reason its earthly goods, and to demand nothing of it except that it be ready for its defense and watch over its interests¹⁾. According to this agreement the character of the theological method can [100] be set forth in the following way: Everyone who has Christian faith acknowledges that he has been brought up in this faith in the Church, since the Christian idea of religion shines forth through the life all around him, through family life and the sacred assemblies; but once he has reached a certain maturity of spirit, he at the same time perceives that not even these forms are perfect expressions of the objects of faith, since the Church's ministers and teachers are human beings who can err like anyone else; he therefore subtracts the universal idea from the forms the Church has

¹⁾The inviolability of this pact is depicted by De Wette in the following strong expression: Der Verstand muß wissen, was er zu bestreiten hat, und was nicht; er muß nicht, vom blinden Widerspruchsgeist getrieben, seine Waffen gegen dasjenige richten, was er, als hoch über ihm stehend, achten und schonen soll; und der Glaube, seiner hohen Abkunft sich bewußt, muß es verschmähen, sich in die niedere Sphäre des Verstandes herabzusenken und diesen freigebornen Sohn der menschlichen Vernunft in Sklavenfesseln legen zu wollen. Herrschen soll der Glaube im Menschen, als der der himmlische Genius, gesandt, dessen dunkles Daseyn zu erhellen und zu verschönern: aber die wahre Herrschaft läßt alle unter ihr stehende Kräfte frei walten in dem ihnen angewiesenen Gebiet, und findet in der freien Harmonie des Ganzen ihr schönes Ziel. Ueber Religion und Theologie. Vorred. P. VII.

handed down, and seeks out for himself others that are more adequate; for though he cannot himself set up true forms, he can nonetheless, when more perfect forms present themselves to him, rejoice in them and acquiesce in them, since he himself has faith. In his search he is supported on the one side by reason and external empirical knowledge, on the other side by faith, internal empirical knowledge. — The Christian religion is a positive religion, which arose at a certain time and under certain external conditions; one must therefore examine its historical documents. We thus come to the testing of the authenticity, axiomaticity, and integrity of Holy Scripture, — and although by these investigations we do not exactly arrive at any mathematical certainty that Scripture is the pure and unadulterated source of religion, we do arrive by them at a high degree of probability of it. This probability becomes absolute certainty when faith is added. For one can rightly conclude that as surely as God has communicated a revelation to us, so surely does he also will that it should come unadulterated to all by the surest way; since human tradition, the oral tradition, as the theologians call it, can go astray, we hold ourselves assured that Scripture is the true source of religion. But Scripture itself has a double side from which it ought to be regarded, the historical and the religious. From its historical side Scripture must be an object of [101] criticism's investigation, and one must grant here that one may hold different opinions and voice doubts about much concerning the origin of the individual writings and the disagreement between the individual accounts, without thereby harming religion; in the religious respect, by contrast, everything that Scripture teaches about God and our relation to him is so deep and clear that it will always constitute the surest foundation of faith¹⁾. The religious person therefore, on his first reading through Scripture, observes the general type of the doctrine, in order under its guidance to pass on to an examination of the individual dogmas, so that there comes to be a reciprocal relation between the universal and the individual moments. This must be the right

¹⁾Since the Protestant Church grounds the authority of the biblical books chiefly on the power with which they themselves bear witness to their higher character and origin, it is, at least immediately, as little touched by the doubts that scientific criticism raises against the genuineness and integrity of the New Testament as one who is absorbed in glad contemplation and enjoyment of a work of art lets himself be disturbed by the reasons with which the art critic disputes its standing as a work of this or that famous master. *Dr. Scharling*. (*Theol. Tidsskr.*, ed. by *Dr. Scharling* and *Dr. Engelstoft*, 4th vol., 1st no., P. 16).

method for the treatment of theology, since it attends equally to all the moments of truth; for it holds fast to the positive and objective moment, — one idea that pervades the Church, one and the same need in the religious mind, one Holy Scripture, finally, amid the vicissitudes of the centuries —, and yet preserves, in the midst of this unity of faith, the freedom of the individual; for within the general limits everyone can form the doctrine for himself in his own way, and choose for himself what best accords [102] with his inclination²⁾. Just as Holy Scripture has two different sides from which it ought to be treated, so it now goes with sacred history too. If one regards it from its rational side, if we may say so, one will know the events set forth in the accounts as such; then it is subject to the same relations as profane history; if, on the other hand, it is regarded from its religious side, one sees at once that it stands infinitely high above the latter. For although we do not conceive history, we cannot, when it presents its sublime examples to us, avoid receiving into our consciousness, through the religious view, an image of the sublime idea itself, whereby the matter itself is confirmed and at the same time takes root in our conviction. Therefore we should above all strive to appropriate the image of Christ as it is painted in the N. Test., and we shall then reap from it the most glorious fruits for a religious life¹⁾. — It lies in the nature of the case [103] that this theology cannot disdain philosophy, much less exclude it from its precincts, since its aim is precisely to bring cognition to ever greater development; the spirit of man constantly goes forward, and what power could halt it in its progress! But philosophy too is a human work, and we all know that philosophers constantly waver

²⁾*Nemini totum est necessarium, alium alia pars ad salutem ducit. Bengel.*

¹⁾For this way of treating sacred history De Wette has earned extraordinary merit, something we gladly acknowledge, even if we do not approve his metaphysical system. Ethics in particular owes him much gratitude, since it was he who led the principle of morality back to Christ himself, whereas before it contained nothing but general laws of conscience and reason, confirmed with the seal of Christ and the apostles. Cf. *Lærebog i den christelige Sædelære og sammes Historie*, translated by Mag. Scharling P. 3 § 4 ... Christian (ethics) presents the (moral) tasks already actually solved in revelation in definite exemplary images ... or the existing Christian morals not merely in empirical-historical (positive) form, but also in a distinctive material ... what is distinctive about it lies in the same sphere in which the purely Christian doctrines of the Christian doctrine of faith lie, in the domain of presentiment, where the idea and actuality interpenetrate each other. P. 36 § 62 Christ is ... the principle of wisdom, but primarily for feeling, which apprehends in him the perfection of life. In order to become clearly conscious of this principle, we must resolve it into a concept of the understanding.

The highest that Christ is ... consequently the principle of feeling that transcends every concept is the idea of the Son of God ... the Son of God is at the same time the Son of Man ... and the divine image is the pure archetype of humanity.

between the most opposite theorems. Therefore this method has also taken care to find a remedy against this inconstancy of the philosophers. When the theologian takes up a philosophical system, he must not intend to pursue the system itself through the countless labyrinths of its thoughts, in order with the very power of dialectic to refute its content and expose its metaphysical errors; for that is an insuperable labor, and all the more troublesome since most systems are intricate and obscure and in addition engage in so many abstract considerations about God and his inner life, wholly superfluous for the development of Christian piety, that the true theologian, in pursuing them, could easily run the risk of being himself swept along into the abyss of philosophy and becoming a philosopher instead of a theologian.

Since it is the Church, and above all Scripture, that communicates the Christian faith to us, we consequently have in them certain fixed and unshakable points of the doctrine of faith with which we can compare the results at which the philosophical systems arrive by the way of philosophy. We can then adopt these insofar as they accord with those articles of faith, reject what stands in contradiction to them, and for the rest let the philosopher keep what belongs to him as such; for thus we give each [104] his due. — How sure this procedure is can be seen most clearly by citing examples of the test that the theologians, according to this method, make the philosophers undergo. *Spinoza* thus taught that God was substance, and that the phenomena of the world were nothing but forms and modifications of this substance; but by this pantheism the whole doctrine of the personality and immortality of human beings is abolished, and as a consequence the whole of ethics; his system thus conflicts both with faith and with Holy Scripture; it ought therefore to be excluded from theology.

Fichte taught that the human I was the author of all things, and thus fell into atheism and crass Pelagianism; but a philosophy that conflicts so openly with all sound reason and can have so pernicious an influence on religiosity naturally cannot be tolerated in Christian theology.

Theology consequently stands with absolute authority over philosophy; and in this way one can test ten philosophers in one hour.

§ 19.

Examination of Critical Theology.

We readily grant that this theology has taken all the moments of truth up into itself; we allow that it is right that the Christian religion is a positive revelation whose ideas cannot be found or developed by abstract, a priori speculations; we admit that [105] Holy Scripture is the rule for Christian doctrine, and so forth; — but because it touches on all the most important moments of truth, it is not yet settled that truth itself is actually present in them, any more than one can say that a man lives because all the individual parts of his body are present.

The task therefore becomes to examine how the moments are united and how they are to be united, to test whether a true transition takes place between the individual moments. And it will then soon become apparent that the alliance that was concluded between faith and reason is not of a lasting nature, and that they did not enter into this peace because it actually satisfied both parties, but rather had seen themselves compelled to enter into an armistice in order to avoid the danger that hung over them both. — If we thus consider first the relation between subjectivity and objectivity, we see that the subjective freedom this theology extols is at once far too unbridled and far too restricted and bound. One starts from the faith that lives in the consciousness of the person brought up in the Church, thus from the general influence that Christian life exerts upon everyone; one is thus agreed not to go further into the particular modifications under which this faith appears in individuals, for that each individual has, and has the right to have, his own distinctive subjectivity is a settled matter. But since the same circumstances and the same upbringing act differently upon different minds, and since no doctrine can assert itself except through subjective faith, it is not objective truth that corrects and transforms the mind, but rather the subjective spirit that chooses and determines what seems to it to be the good and the true. *I will* [106] *believe what most appeals to me*¹⁾. And yet this freedom is not very far from being servitude; for precisely because subjective nature is urged to such a degree that it keeps

¹⁾Compare with this Dr. H. Martensen's remark on the solipsism of critical theology: "Since, then, the idea of God first acquires validity through practical reason or through absolute feeling, not conversely, it loses the character of the constitutive, and if one ascribes such a significance to it, this happens only

one element for itself as its incontestable property, namely the right to preserve its immediate distinctiveness inviolate, objectivity on the other side determines and fixes its limits all the more firmly, so that the positive moments, which are given in a wholly external way, demand an external obedience; but in this way the objective, positive elements that remain do not become flesh and blood in us. This self-contradiction will emerge still more clearly in what follows. — As a great merit of this theology, one emphasizes the separation between the essence of faith and its external form, according to which Christian faith is indeed to be sought in the Church, but cannot acquiesce in its forms. The ecclesiastical forms, it is said, are not perfectly adequate. But what is an adequate form? If one means by it such a form as immediately expresses the divine essence itself, then according to this theology there can be no adequate forms at all; if, on the other hand, one means such forms as preserve and indicate faith in its truth, one will hardly be able to avoid the dilemma: either to assume that the Church is in possession of the true and adequate forms for doctrine, and then the Church's doctrine must have the same validity as the doctrine of Scripture; — or [107] to take the Church's forms and modes of expression to be erroneous in a greater or lesser degree; but then the faith that the Church communicates must also be more or less distorted, and one will then also be unable to arrive at any true interpretation of Scripture, since such an interpretation requires that the Church have handed down to us the true faith. An attempt to hold fast to the faith the Church has called forth in us, while rejecting or doubting the individual propositions of the Church's doctrine, will prove the truth of this. Can one who removes all definite representations of faith, and then reads Scripture doubting everything that faith has taught him about God, Christ, etc., really have faith? Must he not then also doubt the existence of God, the redemption and salvation of human beings through Christ, — in other words begin his study of Scripture with an absolute negation of faith, something that conflicts with all reason? If one considers this, one can hardly deny that the faith received from the Church is bound up with the general articles of faith, so that it is impossible for anyone to take up Scripture without preconceived opinions about the truths he will

nominally; for what constitutes and *determines* everything is surely rightly to be regarded as the *actual* God, the omnipresent Godhead in consciousness, even if it does not receive the name of God." Selvbev. Autonomie, translated by Petersen.

find expressed in it. The main question thus becomes how the fundamental articles of faith can put off the concrete but not perfectly true forms of the Church and put on the authentic forms of Scripture.

The Church teaches that God exists; but what attributes he has, and what feelings he bears toward us, Scripture is to teach. One then demands of whoever would read Scripture in the right way that he abstract from all God's attributes insofar as the Church has described them, and find out from Scripture itself the concrete concept of God; but it is impossible to think God without having a certain representation of him, and the Church's doctrine of God's essence will thus always, voluntarily or [108] involuntarily, make its influence felt on the reader's spirit. For if he is satisfied with the description of God that the Church has given him, he will find the Church's God again, in complete likeness, in the God of Scripture; if, on the other hand, before he reads Scripture, he departs in one point or another from the Church's doctrine of God, he nevertheless cannot negate the Church's doctrine without a positive concept of God appearing with greater or lesser clarity in his consciousness. (Thus if someone cannot in the negative respect acknowledge the Trinity of God as it is taught by the Church, he must nonetheless in the positive respect worship another God, whether it be that of the Jews or of the Muhammadans, or rather, whether it be God as he is depicted by the Jews or by the Muhammadans; and if he has the Jewish or Muhammadan faith, it goes without saying that he also cannot find the triune God in Scripture, since precisely Christian faith, according to this theology's own principle, is the first condition for the right reading of Scripture). But the Christian reader, it is said, must not urge, or with presumptuous self-confidence hold fast to, his preconceived concepts of divine things, even if he cannot wholly abstract from them; his spirit must have a willing mobility, always to adjust its subjective opinions to the statements of Scripture: he must have the true method of interpretation. In what, then, does the method consist by which we are to seek to find out the meaning of Scripture?

First of all one must clear away the obstacles that the difference in language and in time puts in the reader's way; and how great the merits of the learned critics and philologists are in this respect is well enough known. But once one has examined the general conditions of speech and action to which the sacred authors were subject,

added the necessary psychological remarks, and thus come to know with fair certainty the meaning of the individual words and expressions that the authors must be assumed [109] to have wished to put into them, — one is still very far indeed from having penetrated to the eternal significance of their subjective opinions and determinations. Here, now, a double difficulty arises; for, first, the words and expressions of Scripture are nothing but imperfect designations of the highest, divine objects; and, second, the particular circumstances of that age made it a necessity for the authors, for both inner and outer reasons, to avail themselves of a mode of expression wholly peculiar to those times. The whole yield of such acute exegetical investigations is then confined to finding out how the sacred authors expressed their objects; how these objects themselves are to be thought, they cannot teach us, for since the difference between the idea and the forms in which it is expressed is so great, it was conceivable that the apostles had set forth the doctrine in this or that way, while we cannot think it in the same way¹⁾. One must thus grant, as far as dogmatics is concerned, that these investigations have in the negative respect removed many a false application of individual passages of [110] Scripture, but in the positive respect can accomplish nothing at all; if one would find the dogmatic ideas themselves, one must therefore strike out on an entirely different path for one's investigation. We thus come here once again to the question from which we started, namely how we can find out from Holy Scripture the positive forms for faith.

Interpretation is to move forward step by step from the easier and more comprehensible expressions in Scripture to the more difficult and obscure. But since the immediately evident concepts are almost always hollow, empty, and therefore meaningless, the result of such a comparative procedure is only all too often that the deeper ideas vanish entirely. Thus if it is asked what is meant by Christ's sayings (John 15,

¹⁾An example of this we find in the doctrine of the devil. As regards the principle of separation itself, cf. Dr. Hagenbach: *Encyclopædie u. Mthdl. der theologischen Wissenschaften* P. 174 and 175. Sache der Auslegung ist es, in Stellen, wie Rom. III, 24. 25. IV, 25. V, 9. 10. VIII, 34. 1 Cor. XV, 3. Eph. I, 7. 1 Pet. I, 18. 19. II, 29. 1 Joh. I, 7. Hebr. VII, 26. IX, 28 u. s. w. die Versöhnungs- und Opfertheorie als eine den Schriftstellern des N. T. geläufige Idee factisch anzuerkennen. Aber verschieden kann die weitere Erklärung der Stellen ausfallen, je nachdem man sich entweder damit begnügt solche Ideen in ihrem historische Zusammenhänge mit dem alttestamentlichen Opferwesen u. s. w. aufzupassen, oder je nachdem man sie auf ein tieferes religiöses Bedürfnis nach Erlösung zurück zu führen und in ihrem innersten, geheimnißvollen Grunde erfassen zu müssen glaubt.

1, 4): Ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ἄμπελος, ὑμεῖς τὰ κλήματα, and (v. 9. 10): Ἐὰν τὰς ἐντολάς μου τηρήσητε, μενεῖτε ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ μου, one is in the greatest uncertainty as to where the development should start: whether one should assume such a relation between Christ and his disciples that love could have no true moral force, and Christians no true love, unless his life were, in the proper sense of the word, the source of their life, unless they drew their whole strength from his marrow, — or whether one should say: what a real connection between Christ and those who believe in him means, we do not understand, but what love and obedience to Christ's commandment are, everyone understands; one cannot then take this and similar expressions for anything but images drawn from an Oriental circle of representations. Just as uncertain is the interpretation when Christ (John 17, 11) says that he is united with the Father (ἵνα ὧσιν ἐν καθὼς ἡμεῖς); for one cannot know whether it is the meaning of Scripture that there is an immediate identity between the Father and the Son, and that Christians, [111] therefore, when they have faith, have entered into the same real relation of unity with God and Christ, — a relation incomprehensible to all who do not, by being born of God, become θείας κοινωνοὶ φύσεως —, or whether the meaning is that Christ and the Father are one in the same sense as Christians and Christ, namely by a moral bond of unity. What such a moral union means, anyone who has sound reason can conceive; one ought therefore to stop at this concept, for everything that aims at a substantial unity is said only in a figurative and pregnant sense and has no significance for religiosity as such.

The investigation of the concept of the Holy Spirit fares the same way. It is described (John 14, 16) as a person, and Christ says of it (John 14, 26): ὑμᾶς διδάξει πάντα, and (John 16, 13): ὁδηγήσει ὑμᾶς εἰς πᾶσαν τὴν ἀλήθειαν (cf. 1 Cor. 2, 10. 11); in Luke, by contrast, it is called a δύναμις ἐξ ὕψους; one can therefore interpret this in a double way. Those who believe that the Holy Spirit is a person do not deny that it is also a power, but only maintain that it is more than a power; those, on the other hand, who start from the immediate conceivability of the thing declare that they cannot understand how the Spirit can be a particular person in God, and think it sufficient to take it for a divine power without determining its nature more closely¹⁾.

¹⁾Numerous examples of this circular course in argumentation can be taken from Bretschneider's

To this is added, further, what dogmatics shows: that every doctrine Scripture sets forth contains moments that are mutually opposed, indeed even directly cancel each other. Thus Scripture teaches, for example, that God is not merely loving and merciful, but also that he is angry with those who have sinned. One cannot then know from Scripture whether one should urge absolute mercy and take God's wrath only for a subjective representation of human beings, or whether wrath is an objective concept that in actuality limits the infinite mercy, or whether, finally, one should think God's nature in such a way that he is indeed *ad intra* the Blessed One, but *ad extra*, on account of the sins of the world, enters into such a relation of atonement, of wrath and love, that his infinite love, through the incarnation, removes the objective wrath from those who believe in Christ. One must therefore here apply the analogy of Scripture and look to Scripture's doctrine of the atonement through Christ. It is, however, so far from being the case that the passages dealing with Christ untie the difficulty of the knot that they rather make it still more intricate. For Scripture does teach that Christ's death is a proof of God's love, but it also teaches that the love of God and of Christ shows itself chiefly in this, that the punishment for our sins is transferred to the crucified Christ; if one now defends the objectivity of wrath, one arrives at the dogma of *satisfactio vicaria*; if, on the other hand, one cannot assume that God is angry, one must refer the whole doctrine of the atonement to a change in human beings' representations of God. The concept of wrath is thus dependent on the concept of Christ's *satisfactio*, but the latter is in turn dependent on the former; one sees from this, then, that the one analogy always requires another analogy on which it can rest, or in other words: analogy itself shows that one cannot acquiesce in any analogy. [112]

It will perhaps be objected that this economy of Scripture is the best proof of the truth of the remark one so often hears, that God will not give human beings any objective insight into divine things, so that all the difficulties we mentioned before arise precisely from our having ascribed far too great a significance to the objective doctrine, — and that Scripture itself confirms this opinion by presenting God's nature, his love, and the atonement in images and general concepts adapted to men's powers of comprehension, so that, strengthened by the doctrine of the forgiveness of sins, [113]

Dogmatik; cf., e.g., on the Trinity P. 495. Handbuch der Dogmatik, 1ster Band, 2te Aufl., Leipz. 1822; on the person of Christ § 140, P. 167, 2 B.

they might be ready for every good work. — But have we not thus come back to the very same point from which we set out, to the general articles of the Church?¹⁾ The whole result of the laborious work and manifold investigations of criticism is thus the cognition that Scripture itself proves that in dogmatic respects it can teach us nothing other than what we have already learned from the Church. The critics, then, with their great exertions, have accomplished nothing but to fall into contradiction with themselves, for they promised us that the reading of Scripture would furnish us with a more concrete form of faith, if only we on our side brought faith along in its pure generality. We are thus called upon to investigate more closely whether it is also actually in the true interest of faith, as they recommend to us, to renounce every conceiving of the objective objects. — It is evident that a faith in something altogether unknown is impossible. I thus contradict myself if I say that I believe in the Creator of the world while at the same time declaring that I can know nothing whatever about [114] the manner in which the world was created. For if I investigate what creation is, I cannot avoid declaring creation to be an act of God's absolute freedom; I then think, as far as possible, absolute freedom; but this requires that I must have a representation of freedom, and if now this representation, this concept, is false, then that in which I believe is also false, i.e. I have a false faith. And if someone professes that he believes Christ to be at once in possession of a human and a divine nature, he deceives himself if he at the same time declares that he cannot conceive a union of them; for insofar as he has a concept of the divine and human nature, to that extent he can also think them united with one another; if, on the other hand, he has no opinion at all about the properties of either of these natures, so that the human nature is for him an unknown x , the divine an unknown y , — then surely he believes in a union of x and y , believes in something of which he himself does not know what it is, i.e. he believes nothing¹⁾.

¹⁾The uncertainty in such a mode of interpretation can be shown in several ways. It says, for example, in John 4, 24, πνεῦμα ὁ θεός, but in John 1, 5, ὁ θεός φῶς ἐστὶ; now if someone could not understand what it means that God is a spirit, but believed he could more easily grasp that God is a light, might one not then be tempted to believe that the God of the Christians and the God of the Magi were the very same God?

¹⁾The difference between critical and speculative dogmatics does not consist in this, that only the latter, not the former, recognizes the necessity of inner experience: they both assume that no doctrine can be developed without regard to the positive elements of the spiritual life; they both strive to give the representations and concepts inner firmness. But the difference lies in the different way in which

One often hears that Holy Scripture does not constitute a philosophical system, [115] that it is popular; but this remark, as trivial as it is true, is not taken in the same sense by everyone. For if those who speak of the simplicity of Scripture mean thereby to prove that one may leave the objective forms of doctrine unilluminated, provided only that one, according to the greater or lesser enlightenment of one's age, engages in reflections on pious feelings and moral precepts, then surely they act contrary to the whole economy of Scripture itself. For Scripture itself calls precisely for taking an entirely opposite path. It is true, to be sure, that Scripture gives the simplest depiction of divine things, but one must equally remember that its development of piety and the ethical life bears the very same stamp of simplicity. So far is it from proceeding from [116] human subjectivity that, on the contrary, it derives all piety and morality from this, that the objective God has revealed himself in a visible manner and by his Spirit has implanted in men a new principle of *wisdom* and life. Scripture, then, knows nothing at all of that separation between the objective and subjective moments of cognition. Or can anyone perhaps suppose that Paul, for example, in setting forth the doctrine of predestination, thought to himself as follows: "I do not, to be sure, know what God is in himself, or what counsels he has resolved upon, but since the idea of predestination

each of them makes use of the same positive elements. Critical theology treats the representations and ideas only negatively; therefore, when, after citing the passages of Scripture and passing judgment on the various ecclesiastical opinions, it has stated how creation is not to be thought, it contents itself with that, leaves the more precise representation of it to each person's subjective view, and passes on from there to treat another dogma in the same way. And when the critics have in this way touched upon all the individual scattered fragments of the elements without letting them take up and permeate one another, they are highly astonished that speculative theologians can think of speaking of an objective conceiving of divine things, as if the elements of such a theory could only be snatched out of thin air. "How can anyone want to think how creation took place," it is said; "does it not lie outside all experience! Centuries lie between the beginning of the world and us; — can any man experience what lies centuries back in time!" — Indeed, were such leaps of thought necessary, then not only would metaphysical investigations be exceedingly unsatisfactory, but philosophy would become more difficult day by day; for time hastens past us without pause, and we are removed further and further from the point of beginning! But the matter does not stand so; true philosophy, to be sure, never ventures to overstep the bounds of human experience; but it makes a different use of the positive elements of life. What makes it possible for us to have a representation of creation and freedom is the very same thing that makes it possible for us to arrive at the speculative concept of creation. Critical dogmatics touches only in passing on the concept of absolute freedom, but speculative dogmatics, precisely because it is science, demands that we pursue it to its utmost limits, and it is along this way that we arrive at the metaphysical concept of creation. If, therefore, one will purify in the fire of dialectic the positive moments which critical dogmatics leaves undetermined, one arrives at speculative dogmatics.

is an excellent means of impressing modesty upon the Jews and imparting comfort to the Christians, I will nonetheless set up this doctrine!” — μὴ γένοιτο! If, therefore, you will be a child in understanding the objective objects of the apostolic age, you must also regard yourself as a child with respect to subjective, critical reflections! But if your age calls upon you to undertake investigations and solve problems, you must not, directly against the example of Scripture itself, believe that you can do so without regard to the objective realm of divine things!

The same indeterminacy, — a consequence of criticism’s external juxtaposing of the individual moments —, must naturally show itself in the way in which they treat sacred history. Criticism can divide the whole of sacred history into two parts, of which the first comprises all the accounts of the holy persons that are of such a nature that one believes one can still today point to examples of the same kind (e.g. that Christ went from Judea to Galilee, that he addressed the people, that he showed great love toward all men). Events of such a nature are found in profane history just as well as in sacred history. To the second class, on the other hand, one must reckon all those [117] events that are peculiar to sacred history, namely those in which God is immediately present. With regard to these one has two demands to make: first, it must be shown that these events actually took place — otherwise they would not belong to history at all —, and secondly, the supernatural ideas must not be attached from outside to events of an entirely ordinary nature, but must be derivable from the events themselves; the supernatural and the natural moment must coincide, the former must appear as really and distinctly as the latter. But this entails the greatest difficulty for the interpreter. For the supernatural form in which the events, e.g. Christ’s birth or resurrection, appear makes it impossible for criticism to find out the purely natural moments, and even if it were able to bring these to light, it could still not do so without violating the covenant it has made with faith; it must therefore leave the natural moment in the narrative standing altogether undetermined. And as for the supernatural moment, criticism does not, to be sure, always deny the possibility of miracles in general; for according to the principle from which we set out, the supernatural realm, and therefore also miracles in general, belong to the domain of faith; but since the finite cannot contain the infinite, and the invisible cannot be present in the visible, the truth

of the miracle will nonetheless, in the individual cases, always be subject to great doubt. Now since one cannot acquiesce in the way in which the extraordinary event is narrated in Scripture, the supernatural moment too is reduced to something altogether undetermined. But in this way this part of sacred history vanishes from the realm of history itself. The positive moments that remain belong to the outward garb, which is owed solely to the religious imagination. The visible form of the Son of Man could [118] not in actuality be the true expression of the idea of the Son of God; that Son of God was then only a thought conceived in the religious minds of the apostles.

If the matter stands thus, one can hardly deny that the predominant characteristic of the critics is an external combination of positivism and, if we may put it so, liberalism; they thus stand on the standpoint of the bad middle way, a standpoint that cancels itself. This shows itself also in the fact that, when a system which, as such, can be tested only by way of thinking sets itself in opposition to criticism, one not seldom hears the critics appeal to the authority of Holy Scripture, hears them invoke the bare name of Scripture against the speculative dogmatists, drawing a sharp distinction between the word of God and that of man, just as the Catholics of old, in the struggle against Luther, constantly appealed to the Fathers. *It is true because it stands in Scripture.* — But scarcely is there talk of freedom in critical investigation before all the scruples of positivism at once vanish, before they concede that it makes little difference whether Scripture was written by the apostles or by other pious men, before they frankly and openly distinguish between the peculiar form of Scripture and the word of God. — *Scripture is holy because it speaks the truth.*

We by no means doubt that a reciprocal relation obtains between the testimony of the truth concerning Scripture and the testimony of Scripture concerning the truth; but we very much doubt that altogether opposite principles can be united with one another. Either we must, like the Fathers, unconditionally let our judgment be subject to Scripture and, as a consequence, also assume a verbal inspiration; or we must everywhere receive the truth in the name of truth, and then we have no reason to assume that God, from the time of Christ right up to Trajan, spoke immediately [119] through certain pious men, but from that time on let men's speech about divine things be independent of any divine influence. — The same uncertainty shows itself when the

talk is of the relation between the general idea of Scripture and the individual passages of Scripture. They themselves urge, where it suits them, the individual statements of Scripture, and always say, when one puts forward something that conflicts with their views: "Where is this written? There is not a word about it in Scripture!" and thus in this case dispute κατὰ ῥητόν; — if, on the other hand, one cites definite passages of Scripture against them, they always know how to distinguish between the thing itself and its outward garb, defending their freedom of thought with the assertion that one may only reason from the general idea and the whole economy of Scripture; here, then, they dispute κατὰ νοητόν¹⁾. But such a procedure is a "*mystificatio veri*", which can easily bring upon the authors of this school the suspicion that they said one thing but meant another; for the extraordinary reverence for Scripture often looks like a mask, put on so as to be able, under its cover, to give subjective freedom all the more scope.

§ 20.

Continuation. Transition to Panlogism.

Tell me which metaphysics you follow, and I shall tell you, with the exception of your purely private opinions, which dogmatic interpretation of Scripture you will put [120] forward! If you say that you follow no metaphysics at all, we do not believe you; if, on the other hand, you say that you yourself do not know which metaphysics you follow, we will believe you¹⁾. It is not, then, by renewed historical or philological investigations that criticism can hope to make any progress, but solely and only by a change of its metaphysics. If, therefore, criticism can defend its metaphysics through

¹⁾Examples of both these ways of disputing are found in Bretschneider: *De obedientia activa* § 157. (Pag. 285. 2 B.).

¹⁾Es hilft der Theologie nichts, sich dagegen zu sträuben, zu sagen: sie wolle nichts von Philosophie wissen, es seyen Philosopheme, also auf der Seite liegen zu lassen. Sie hat es immer mit Gedanken zu thun, die sie mitbringt; und diese ihre subjectiven Vorstellungen, Gedanken, ihre Haus- und Privat=Metaphysik sind dann die Reflexionen, Meinungen u. s. f. der Zeit ... diese allgemeinen Vorstellungen sind nichts, als was sich auf der Heerstraße findet, was auf der Oberfläche der Zeit umherschwimmt. Hegel: *Geschichte der Phil.* (W. 15 B. Pag. 268).

all its individual moments against the objections of dialectic, then critical theology too will stand firm and maintain its name as the highest form of science to which men can attain in this life; if it cannot do this, we are entitled to seek out another form for true science. In any case this much stands firm: that it must not seek its defense in Holy Scripture, but must remember what Clement says — a saying to which appeal is often made in our time²⁾ —: “*One must philosophize, even when one wishes to combat philosophy!*”³⁾. We are thus called upon to make the critics’ metaphysics the object [121]

²⁾Compare Fr. Baader, Vorles. üb. Dogm. 1. H. Pag. 17. J. Martensen. S. A. § 1.

³⁾The truth of this has been acknowledged also by the most brilliant and most celebrated critical theologians themselves: e.g. De Wette: ... ich schmeichle mich mit der Hoffnung, daß ich wenigstens die allgemeine Ansicht, welche für die Theologie von entscheidender Wichtigkeit ist, klar genug gemacht habe. Und diese ist keine andere, als *die Unterscheidung der Verständigen, idealen und ästhetischen Ueberzeugung*, welche ich für den Schlüssel der ganzen Theologie halte. Relig. und Theol. Pag. IV. compare also Pag. 162—172.

Thus a critic, too, seeks to combat Weise with metaphysical weapons in his review of the latter’s book “Die ewangelische Geschichte” (Kritische Prediger=Bibliothek v. D. J. F. Röhr, 20. Band, 29. Heft, Pag. 200—219). He seems, to be sure, in censuring Weise’s doctrine of a substantial unity of Christ, men, and God, to appeal to the authority of Scripture: “Diese Einheit aber der Menschen mit Gott ist nicht eine substantiale, ein Hineinbilden unserer creatürlichen Selbstheit in die göttliche Substantz, es ist eine moralische nach der ausdrücklichen Lehre Jesu und aller seiner Apostel” ... but if we consider his objections more closely, it is readily seen that they belong to metaphysics; for he first rejects that substantial relation because he cannot conceive it: “Was sollen wir uns aber auch unter jenem Hineinbilden in die göttliche Substantz Vernünftiges denken?” Next, he is convinced that the substantial relation conflicts with the true idea of God and therefore cannot serve to further morality: “und indem so der Rationalismus die pantheistischen Gedanken von einer Menschwerdung Gottes, einem sich Hineinbilden in die göttliche Substanz verwirft, weil sie einerseits unerweisbar und der reinen Gottes=Idee widersprechend, desshalb aber auch andererseits für Beförderung der Moralität gleichgiltig erscheinen ...” And lest we should object that his assertions, of which the first may seem to the reader more reasonable than the last, are without real probative force, the author declares that he wishes every investigation to be carried through philosophically; indeed he even assures us that all such questions would long ago have been satisfactorily answered had not speculative philosophy by chance displaced criticism for a time: “Hätte man hier die Bahn verfolgt, welche der unsterbliche Kant und die Anhänger seiner Schule betraten, die völlige Aussöhnung der philosophischen Speculation mit dem reinen und einfachen Christenthume würde zum Heile der ewangelischen Kirche bald erfolgt, aller unnützen philosophischen Grübeleien über Dinge, die wir nun einmal nicht zu erkennen vermögen, und die darum auch für unser wahres sittlich=religiöses Leben keinen Werth haben, würde vielleicht für immer vorgebeugt, und somit ein Höhepunkt deutscher Philosophie erreicht worden seyn, den diese Wissenschaft in keinen unserer cultivirten Nachbarstaaten so bald erreichen dürfte(!!!). Da trat die Speculation des absoluten Philosophie dazwischen ... Trotz dem aber werden diese Extreme philosophischer Speculation ihre heilsamen Folgen haben; sie werden darauf zurückführen, daß wir den Grund der Erkenntniß göttlicher Dinge allein in den Anforderungen unserer sittlichen Natur suchen ...” After adducing all these weighty reasons he takes his last objection from Scripture, disputing κατὰ ῥητόν, in order to give his remarks greater emphasis and to reduce Weise to silence by the silence of Scripture: “Wo lesen wir in den heiligen Urkunden ein Wort von einem Hineinbilden des creatürlichen

[122] of a metaphysical investigation. — It follows from the very nature of criticism that it separates the positive moments from one another (for κρίσις is precisely the activity by which one separates, sets apart, the objects). The realm of cognition touches the sphere of faith, but not in such a way that any identity of the two ever comes about; for what makes them touch one another is the very same thing that at the same time makes them repel one another. Each of them seems to acquiesce in itself within its own bounds and to take up no foreign elements into itself: they are thus indifferent to one another. Now were this indifference absolute, theology would be altogether superfluous, indeed contrary to reason; for if theological science has no other object than the realm of finite things, and if on the other hand faith, exalted above all cognition, must itself look after the interest of its objects, then faith too is secure within the bounds of its own realm, then it can and must also apprehend the divine ideas on its own account. But this mutual exclusion cancels itself on closer consideration. For if faith, left to itself, is to present its objects in their order and

[123] right relation, then the religious feelings too must stand in opposition to, and restrict and limit, one another, and in this way cognition, which is the orderer and governor of all finite, limited objects, will break through all the bounds of faith. On the other hand, the realm of cognition is not sufficient unto itself within its own bounds either; for if its finite elements are to determine one another mutually, the bounds between them are canceled, since the finite as such is like the finite and cannot be limited by anything other than its own opposite, i.e. by the infinite. It is thus altogether certain that the infinite realm of feeling touches the finite realm of cognition at every point, and that as a consequence they cannot go on being indifferent to one another.

And yet, on the other hand, one can just as little hope that they will furnish any limitation for one another, for they repel one another as often as they touch one another; one might therefore rightly call the theology that proceeds from this method bewitched, since it at once shuns and loves thought. It is cognition that determines forms and shapes, so that anyone who would hold fast to the objects of faith is compelled to appeal to it; but since the theological self-contradiction holds not merely in general but also in every individual case, and since the proposition

that the finite cannot contain the infinite returns in manifold ways, cognition always reaches *for* the objects of faith but in actuality never *grasps* them. In vain does it test the events, for natural pragmatism is the guiding rule of all its investigations: if, following this path, it could prove that the events took place, then surely everything supernatural in them would vanish; — if, on the other hand, it finds that they stand in contradiction to the ordinary order of things, then surely it must declare them untrue. — Cognition thus demands that events which are supernatural be seen to [124] have taken place in a natural manner, while it at the same time declares that these realms are mutually opposed to one another. If, therefore, we wish to intuit the objects of faith, we must renounce thinking; only on that condition do they descend from heaven in limited, determinate forms. Since the acknowledgment of divine things thus presupposes a giving up of cognition, theology as a consequence stands outside the sphere of thinking; indeed, the more often one thinks about this relation, the more entangled it looks, and the entanglement goes on to infinity. Christ is divided in this theology between the two realms; to the realm of feeling and faith belongs the Son of God, to the realm of cognition, on the other hand, the Son of Man. One would thus expect that these natures of Christ, owing to their relation of mutual indifference, would isolate themselves from one another, so that it would be no concern of faith and feeling in what manner the man Christ was apprehended, and faith would not be needed in order to conceive his human nature. — But if we consider the matter more closely, we readily see that the human nature has no other purpose than to determine the divine, and that it cannot at any point whatsoever be held apart from it, since the divine glory shines through it everywhere, so that in the man Christ the whole Christ is revealed to aesthetic feeling: we thus seem immediately to behold, think, conceive Christ. But as often as we now try to think this thought of ours, the indifferent and opposed in the relation between Christ as man and Christ as God returns again; the man Christ is then bound to the lower sphere, while the divine Christ ascends to heaven? Cognition again urges the man isolated from the divine nature, while feeling reaches for the God isolated from the human nature: Christ becomes an ordinary man, [125] an unnameable God: he vanishes like a deceptive phantom of mist as often as we reach for him; and so we stand struck by the Apostle's words: Ὁ ἀνόητοι, τίς ὑμᾶς

ἐβάσκανε; οἷς κατ' ὀφθαλμοὺς Ἰησοῦς Χριστὸς προεγράφη.

This difficulty has its ground chiefly in this, that profane cognition, which cannot conceive the divine nature but grasps only the things that belong to this world, remains behind untouched and cold, while feeling and will are consecrated to Christ, in order through him to be sanctified and animated with the fullness of the Godhead. As long, therefore, as the opposition between Christ and the world persists, so long will that discord persist as well; if faith is to be determined, it is compelled to take refuge in pagan cognition. Since, then, feeling is infinite and therefore without determinate shape, it is cognition that fixes the bounds and determines what lies within its own domain and what lies within the domain of faith. It can then also easily, when it sees fit, banish Christian faith from its realm and seize the whole dominion. Once reason has become conscious of this its authority, it will soon constitute itself absolute sole ruler and declare without hesitation that all discrete moments, heavenly and earthly, supernatural and natural, are to be sought within the bounds of its own thinking; but in this way there arises *objective rationalism*. — Thinking is reason, reason is God; but thinking is a negation of phenomena; thus the last trace of positivism vanishes. When phenomena are negated, one has arrived at speculative logic, that is, the concept of pure being, God as he was before the creation of the world. But just as pure being cannot be except through an actual phenomenon, so too God is not except
 [126] through the world, and thereby one has freed oneself from the last remnant of the older supernaturalism. The world, next, is a complex of finite phenomena; considered immediately for itself, it is in opposition to God. But since this opposition concerns things only in their immediate existence, a perfect agreement between God and the world will set in when one gives up every, if one may say so, crude immediacy. The individual moments of existence are then, considered in and for themselves, nothing; they are to be considered and judged only in their dialectical transition into other moments; there is thus only *a logical progress*. The revelation of absolute spirit is, to be sure, posited as its final goal; but the absolute criterion of this revelation is solely and only the immanence of ideality and reality, essence and phenomena. One may thus rightly call this system *panlogism*, since its development is a movement from logic through logical moments to logic.

The true apprehension of things in this their new, cosmic mediation requires that one distinguish between the potential being of the principle and its revelation. In the dark womb of the principle the immediate identity of essence and phenomenon is present in hidden form, but only through its going forth into its manifold, various moments does a true, concrete immanence come about. Essence must therefore descend from its sphere of pure being into the outer realm of phenomena; there is thus something more to be sought in phenomena than bare phenomena, and herein lies the spur to further advance. For insofar as essence needs the phenomenon, to that extent it posits and preserves it; but when it has developed its existence through it, as far as was possible within its bounds, it breaks down the bounds and annihilates the outworn phenomenon in order to let a new and more excellent one come forth in its place. And if one asks why the more excellent appears only now, after the former, and is not present at once in the beginning, the answer must be that the excellence of the second phenomenon is mediated precisely through the existence and destruction of the first; for precisely by positing and again destroying the first has essence gained new strength. Amid the alteration of phenomena essence always holds fast to itself, and, like substance, preserves in every new phenomenon it creates all that was essential in every preceding phenomenon, while it destroys all that is corruptible and inadequate. [127]

The manner in which this development takes place differs in the different spheres. In the lower realm of nature the power of essence to maintain itself is weaker; hence the tautological repetition and uniform circular course observed in the phenomena of this realm. Progress in its true development must be sought in that realm of existence where, in the midst of the disagreement between essence and phenomenon, there appears at the same time the firmest bond between the two: where essence returns to itself through a negation and restoration of phenomena: where the alteration of the outer moments is at the same time an assimilation of the inner: where phenomena can be preserved in a recollection, i.e. in *the history of the human race*.

God, then, having gone forth from the realm of his pure ideality, has posited visible phenomena in the realm of nature in order, through the negation of these, to come to subjective spirit, i.e. to human self-consciousness. Our self-consciousness belongs to two spheres. Bound to the realm of finite and sensuous phenomena, we are

sinner, forfeit to death; but raised up to the sphere of the absolute essence through the negation of phenomena, we have God present in us and are thus reconciled with him.

[128] *The absolute foundation of history is therefore religion, its absolute goal the revelation of God.*

Since the whole cosmic mediation must thus be considered in the light of religion, what we have here developed about the relation between essence and phenomenon in general holds also of the bond by which religion unites men with God. God is at first immediately present to human self-consciousness, so that he can be pointed out visibly in a determinate, individual phenomenon, i.e. God is revealed. But in every revelation a twofold moment is to be observed, a phenomenal and a spiritual. For the organ of revelation, the phenomenon, can neither be acknowledged nor worshipped as such unless the same principle of religion that is present in the phenomenon is also present in the one who beholds the phenomenon. The idea of religion is therefore formed in every beholder from both sides; on the one side he beholds the particular phenomenon and attaches himself firmly to it; — on the other side he seeks to find out and explain to himself the essence of the phenomenon, and thus negates the particular, contingent phenomenon in order to make the general, the essential, that shines forth in it his true property. And here the proposition holds: *as God is in the phenomenon, so is he also in consciousness*. Just as, therefore, no religion and no revelation of God can be given except through a sensuous phenomenon, so on the other hand no phenomenon is an immediate or absolute expression of the idea of God. Here, therefore, a mediation must take place, in order that the empirical phenomenon may be negated and a new, more perfect phenomenon, more satisfying to religion, may by the idea's own power take its place. This negation and restoration human self-consciousness undertakes [129] according to a certain instinct, so that the same thing that causes the phenomenon to be embellished in the interest of the Idea at the same time procures it credence as objective and real.

From this derive all the accounts in sacred history of God's revelations, and the miracles; and one will now easily understand the agreement and the disagreement between panlogism and criticism. For both insist in the strictest manner on a pragmatic development of nature, which cannot possibly be interrupted by the intervention of a

higher power¹⁾; both call miracle into doubt. For the true concept of miracle requires that an actual opposition must take place between God's will and the laws of nature, so that the moments of nature proceed from one another according to a certain law of necessity; for were the objects of nature, in their general development, immediate expressions of God's will and counsels, they would surely all be miracles, and then no miracle at all would take place; but in the opposition there must at the same time be an identity present, for had God not himself established the laws of nature, and did he not know them, neither could he alter them. Faith in miracles thus presupposes an identity of God's will and the laws of nature, but assumes at the same time that in historical development this identity passes over into an opposition, so that collisions can occur, — assumes that in divine providence in general there shows itself a care for the human race in particular, according to which God, although our phenomenal world does not correspond to God's own essence, where he finds it needful, uses for special purposes and glorifies the natural phenomena: so that not only do human [130] beings believe that they see in one or another phenomenon a special revelation of God, but God himself also, according to a special counsel, presents himself to human beings in this phenomenon.

Criticism doubts the possibility of miracles because God, although he is perfect in himself, is so exalted that it would be beneath his dignity to descend into sensuous phenomena, — so wise and unchangeable in his counsels that he would never alter the laws to which he has from the beginning bound the development of natural objects. The sharp opposition between God's abstract essence and the realm of phenomena thus makes it impossible for the critic who inclines to deism to believe in miracles.

The panlogists, by contrast, posit an immanence of God and world; yet the immanence holds only of the general world order, — if natural objects are taken in their singularity, the opposition asserts itself. That God himself should in actuality be present in a special way in this or that phenomenon is impossible for two reasons. First, God would then have to have a supramundane self-consciousness, reflected

¹⁾Diese Ueberzeugung ist so sehr Bewußtseyn der neuen Welt geworden, daß im wirklichen Leben die Meinung oder Behauptung, eine übernatürliche Ursache, eine göttliche Wirksamkeit habe irgendwo unmittelbar eingegriffen, geradezu als Unwissenheit oder Betrug betrachtet wird. Strauß. L. J. § 14 Pag. 91.

into itself, in order to be able to think of a special revelation — but this obviously conflicts with the cosmic mediation we spoke of earlier —, and second, the infinite God would have to be present in a finite phenomenon; but this is equally impossible. The transfiguration of phenomena, the thought of special revelations, cannot then be referred to any objective activity of God, but can only derive from subjective, human representations. Now although the sacred accounts must thus be assumed to derive solely and entirely from subjective religiosity, they could nonetheless not arise without some sufficient ground, since they hold good and find credence among [131] many at once. The ground and occasion is thus the objective moment in the miracle accounts, whereas the forms in which they are clothed are owed to the spectators and listeners: one may therefore rightly call such accounts *myths*.

In myths, then, there are two moments to hold fast, an objective and a subjective; in manifold ways these pass over into one another, and it is in the development and assessment of these moments' mutual transition into one another that criticism diverges from panlogism. For the critics commend everyday experience and regard objects from outside; they therefore want a tangible actuality; for since the concept of mediation is obscure to them, they cannot understand why one does not straightaway, from the very beginning, make this separation between the objective actuality and the subjective representations of it. They do acknowledge that it was necessary, on account of the spiritual immaturity of that age, or at least in keeping with its peculiar spiritual standpoint, to spread such traditions; but deism often drives them so far that they would rather declare those accounts products of cunning and deceit than assume God to be their author¹⁾.

In panlogism they are judged in an entirely different way. The separation that criticism insists on between the idea of God, as it hovers before the pious mind, and God himself, conflicts completely with the principle of panlogism. If, therefore, criticism concedes that the traditions of miracles and revelations have issued from an idea of God, panlogism proves that they have come about through an activity of God immanent in human consciousness:

[132] But since these revelations of God, of whatever nature they may be, thus constitute

¹⁾Cf. Strauß. *Leb. Jesu* (1838) Einleit. §§ 5. 6.

a necessary stage in the history of revelation, they also belong to the cosmic mediation and are not to be despised. It is so far from being the case that they must be regarded as invented fables, that they rather hand down to us phenomena restored and embellished in the interest of religious truth. Myth thus contains, according to its concept, not only a moment of revelation but also a moment of illusion¹⁾. Those who handed down the myths to us believed that the accounts were objective, i.e. that God himself, outside human consciousness, had taken on those finite forms. But this error is revealed and removed in the course of time; for every subsequent historical stage always surpasses the preceding one, and the revelation of the divine Idea becomes ever more and more perfect²⁾. One now sees that the things one has hitherto believed were false, and this becomes a source of sorrow and grief; but one also sees, when cognition has reached its full development, that it is the same activity of God which was formerly the source of the myths that has now in turn brought about the cognition of their untruth. It [133] is so far, then, from being the case that God abandons us when we have discovered the error, that he rather now draws nearer to us, and this is the source of consolation and joy. For in this too panlogism diverges from criticism, that the former has an ever-continued revelation of God, while the latter, after denying the sacred records their validity, has at the same time lost the last traces of an actual divine presence. — For God does not exist outside the human race: the spirit of God and the spirit of human beings always preserve their identity, God goes out into human beings and human beings return to God.

What thus holds of sacred phenomena in general can naturally also be applied to the most excellent phenomenon of the absolute religion.

For the right understanding of the mythical Christ, i.e. of Christ as he is depicted

¹⁾Wenn man die Religion im Verhältniß zur Philosophie bestimmt als das Bewußtseyn desselben absoluten Inhalts, aber nicht in Form des Begriffs, sondern der Vorstellung: so ist leicht zu sehen, daß nur unter und über dem eigentlichen Standpunkte der Religion das Mythische fehlen kann, innerhalb der eigentlich religiösen Sphäre aber dasselbe wesentlich und nothwendig vorhanden ist. S. S. Pag. 98. § 14.

²⁾Wie aber Bildung überhaupt Vermittlung ist: so wird die fortschreitende Bilder der Völker auch der Vermittlungen immer deutlicher bewußt, welche die Idee zu ihrer Verwirklichung bedarf; und so erscheint jene Differenz der neuen Bildung und der alten Religionsurkunden ... Das Göttliche kann nicht so (theils überhaupt unmittelbar, theils noch dazu roh) geschehen seyn; oder das so Geschehene kann nichts Göttliches gewesen seyn — so wird die Differentz sich aussprechen. Strauß L. J. § 1: Pag. 2.

in Holy Scripture, the following three moments come into consideration.

First one must consider the phenomenon as it could be apprehended through everyday experience, — imagine Christ as he would have appeared to the enlightened people of our time, had he arisen among us. Considered from this side, he must be assumed to have been a human being who was perfectly clearly conscious of the idea of religion; otherwise he would not have brought about so great a change in the religious sphere. — But that he apprehended the absolute idea of religion by no means entails that he was an eternal personality, endowed with power to work miracles; indeed, such an assumption even conflicts with the idea of religion itself. For insofar as Christ was a human being, he could neither, as a single individual, contain the whole fullness of God in himself, nor reveal it to his contemporaries. The presentation of Scripture [134] can thus give everyday experience no more than certain fragments and outlines of the true image of the Messiah¹⁾. — He appeared in the fullness of time, when the age already had a rich apparatus of prefigurations and figurative designations; now since that religious principle which stood clear before Christ's consciousness came in and, as it were, gave these elements a new life, and since the particular phenomenon in the service of the Idea became the prey of death, the religious idea conceived from this had so great a power in the consciousness of those who had been the great Master's disciples, that they restored his life and his personality anew, and thus handed down to the believers the fullness of the Idea made intuitable in a phenomenon which, as such, could become an object of worship. We must therefore, although that Christ whom the apostles have described to us is composed of such opposed moments, concede that the people of our time would not have been able to grasp the religious idea in an inward way had it not first been made intuitable for us in this outward way. One must therefore not despise that Christ, for though he died as a single human being, as a unique phenomenon (κατὰ σάρκα), he rose glorified as a symbol of the human race (κατὰ πνεῦμα), and we thus owe it to him that we have come to know the absolute concept of truth. — Everyone who is content with the God of panlogism must therefore also approve the mythical treatment of sacred history. Although, then, no reality remains save with an altogether momentary existence, and although subjective and

¹⁾Cf. Strauß: L. J. Schlußabhandlung.

phenomenal life is continually swallowed up by the objective and essential: yet God remains the same in the realm of ideas, yet the human race, despite the mortality of individual human beings, vindicates its stamp of eternity, yet the true Messiah takes [135] his seat on the mount of panlogistic blessedness and teaches his people:

“Blessed are they who believe in the speculative immanence of heaven and earth, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven; blessed are they who cleanse themselves of all prejudices about a God existing above the world, for in the pure mirror of the Idea they shall see God; blessed are they who scorn their own personal immortality, for their reward shall be great in the realm of memory!”

§ 21.

The Metaphysical Testing of Panlogism.

Should anyone object that nothing but neglect of the study of Scripture can have called forth this development of the Christian religion, we answer that it is rather acute, learned men, well versed in Scripture, who recommend it. They have neglected none of the critics' introductory investigations; equipped with the whole apparatus of sacred philology, they distinguish with the greatest subtlety among all of Scripture's ζεύγματα and other figures; indeed, they even know all the attempts to reconcile Christ's genealogies down to the last jot, — but all this does not convert them. For the following reciprocal relation obtains between life and philosophy: life posits the moments as positive, separated, but at the same time preserves them all at once, lets them all subsist side by side, connects the individual moments with one another without sublating their singularity; thinking, on the other hand, negates and restores the phenomena of life, conceives through an intuiting, intuits through a conceiving, and in consequence insists now on the separation of the elements, now on their identity. And precisely herein is grounded the whole legitimacy and illegitimacy of critical deism and of speculative pantheism. Among the Orientals, where the dull [136] eye of the human soul can discover no other opposition than the opposition between the multiplicity of phenomena and the abstract unity of essence, everything finite

is swallowed up by the infinite; *there*, therefore, the reconciliation also takes place in the most immediate way. — Consciousness, which thinks, is subject to sensuous nature; the natural moment thus preponderates in consciousness, and it is therefore by a certain immediate instinct that consciousness grasps the ground of its existence. It can then raise itself above nature only by voluntarily giving nature what belongs to it; it therefore returns through asceticism to its original nothing (essence in its pure abstraction). The consciousness of nature is thus here limited by the nature of consciousness. — With Christian life the case is quite otherwise; it permits no sinking into dreams of nature; only through manifold position and negation of the given facts, only after spirit had overcome the manifold difficulties that stood in its way, only then could panlogism appear as the final result.

We have already remarked earlier (cf. § 7) that the restoration to which the dialectical stimulus leads consciousness differs according to the differing nature of the phenomena that are negated. Yet the restoration is not always such a reinstatement of the negated phenomena that these come to occupy the same dignity they had before; for the dialectical restoration is at the same time a testing. We must therefore investigate whether panlogism will be able to prevent those moments of the ancient essence of the Christian religion which it has bound with the chains of dialectical negation and thrust down into the shadow-world of subjective representations from stepping forth anew, — or whether it is the eternal ideas of truth on whose ruins [137] speculative philosophy has built its palace, and which will therefore, after a longer or shorter time, burst their prison once more and avenge the injury done to them. Fear not, they will say, we are good Christians! The God we preach, is he not the absolute spirit, which negates nature in all eternity precisely in order to glorify it? Is not the God who through the metaphysical trilogy unceasingly goes out of himself and returns to himself the Triune? Here there can be no talk of a profanation of revelation; we do not profane God, as though he ever shut up heaven out of envy; no, the loving God constantly makes human beings partakers in his life! What else, after all, does the personal unity mean than precisely this inward union? Yes, Christ is religion itself; he was a historical person in whose consciousness the identity of both moments became visible; but where he now is, what does that concern us? It is the human race that is

that θεάνθρωπος; this is really present in every human being, — if only it comes to a revelation! We gladly bid farewell, then, to the vanishing individual, Christ, in order to come into possession of the eternal, present, and thus in truth historical Christ¹⁾. For what, after all, is true history but the eternal presence of actuality? Why then [138] should one covet a subjective immortality? Whoever seeks his life shall lose it! Such egoism was not found in the Christ whose praise you yourself so often have on your lips. He sacrificed his subjective personality in order to rise in the consciousness of others and ascend to the heaven of a grateful remembrance. — In Christ, then, we shall live, die, and rise!

We shall now test somewhat more closely that immanence of ideality and reality on which the whole interpretive method of this view of religion is built. An abstract ideality requires that all the moments which by the power of negation mutually exclude one another must at the same time have this negation so thoroughly reflected within their own limits that position and negation everywhere coincide. But the truth of infinite determination and limitation depends on the actuality of negation. Now abstract ideality contains only an abstract identity with itself; its true opposite it keeps outside itself. Therefore its moments everywhere lack, within its limits, a true opposition; the ideal does seem to be limited by the ideal, negation by negation, but this limitation does not actually take place. Since abstract ideality thus has its true negative outside itself, which conflicts with the nature of ideality, it vanishes. Only the realm of external negation, of empirical actuality, remains, built on the ruins of ideality. — Here it is the first principle that positive things exclude one another; this mutual exclusion is indeed at first thought of as such that each single thing rests undisturbed within its rightful limits; but since the thing's limit is itself a thing, and the thing thus becomes its own opposite: there arises an incessant opposition without rest, an incessant drive to alteration and annihilation pervades the marrow of the thing, [139]

¹⁾... durch die Belebung der Idee der Menschheit in sich, namentlich nach dem Momente, daß die Negation der Natürlichkeit und Sinnlichkeit, welches selbst Negation des Geistes ist, also die Negation der Negation, der einzige Weg zum wahren geistigen Leben für den Menschen sei, wird auch der Einzelne des gottmenschlichen Lebens der Gattung theilhaftig. (With these words Strauß refutes the objection that Schaller raises against him in his work: *der historische Christus und die Philosophie*. S. 64.) Diess allein ist der absolute Inhalt der Christologie: daß dieser an die Person und Geschichte eines Einzelnen geknüpft erscheint, gehört nur zur geschichtlichen Form derselben. Strauß, *Schlußabhandlung L. J. § 159* Pag. 768.

the realm of abstract reality annihilates itself. But as reality, through this destroying, carries through the negation of itself, the relation of ideality returns again. Since, then, neither pure ideality nor abstract reality is anything in itself, it naturally follows that this restless oscillation between ideality and reality is not only the beginning of, but also the principle for, our existence in this life. Beginning and principle coincide. Since nothing can emerge in the conclusion that was not already in the beginning, it is no wonder that the fluctuation goes on to infinity. Ideality does always seek to find its existence in the realm of reality; but the individual moments of empirical knowledge are perishable; therefore all its attempts are in vain; — were ideality true and perfect in itself, it would also have its subsistence in itself; it would then also be able to gather together the scattered moments of reality and reveal itself in the empirical sphere; but as it is, reality remains corruptible through the impotence of ideality, and ideality remains impotent through the corruptibility of reality.

It is from this self-dissolution that that θεάνθρωπος suffers which is to take Christ's place. In the God who dwells in the sphere of ideality the human race sees its Father, but this God is not a subject established in itself, unshakable, not Jehovah, who in his unshakable holding fast to himself has all his opposites outside himself, but it is the Father who seeks his existence in eternally begetting the Son, i.e. the human race. But what existence, now, does this Son of God have? He is not pure ideality — for this belongs to the Father alone —, nor abstract reality, which unfolds itself through individual things and individual human beings; — he is the very transition [140] from the Father's ideality to the world's reality, the Mediator (*mediator*) between God and world. We must then test this mediation more closely.

One must distinguish between the general consciousness of the human race and the individual consciousnesses of individual human beings. Christ is this general consciousness — not that eternal individual I which once revealed itself on earth and now reigns in heaven (for then one would surely have to take refuge again in the Jesus born in Bethlehem and crucified on Golgotha, whom speculative immanence has long since made antiquated!) —, but the general consciousness which procures itself existence through the individual consciousnesses, so that, for the same reason, namely because it does not want to be anything in and for itself but only to have everything

through the individuals, it demands that the individuals must not want to be anything in themselves, but that they should give up their subjectivities and return into it. The development of this general consciousness through the individual consciousnesses, — the historical operation by which the discord between the human race and individual human beings is more and more sublated, is the Spirit, — yet not the Spirit that, as the third I, unites the life of the Father and of the Son, leads God's negativity back to being an immanent negativity within the limits of the divine life, and thereby can at the same time allow the individual consciousnesses to have their own negative, true ideality, eternal life, in themselves, — but the spirit that imparts to the actuality of the moment all the ideal treasures of past ages and sincerely declares that it has its existence only in this immanence of ideality and reality. But the momentary actuality that has unfolded itself through the individual consciousnesses already shows itself to have become another (altered); the objective spirit is thus limited by the sum of finite consciousnesses. For considered according to its real existence, human consciousness has other consciousnesses posited outside itself, so that there is no ideality present in [141] their sum; considered ideally, on the other hand, the one consciousness takes up the other's life into itself. The single real self-consciousness thus takes up into itself the spiritual fullness of the other consciousnesses. It is therefore in the individuals that one must seek the immanence of ideality and reality. But this immanence continually dissolves into scattered moments; for insofar as the really existing consciousness thinks, it also has the immanence in itself, but insofar as it really exists, the scattering sets in. For the ideality that is present in real consciousness is only entrusted to it for a time; thinking consciousness does indeed recognize that the fullness of this ideality is infinite, but it will never be able to exhaust it completely. For since the real self-consciousness, which, as it is said, has its negation outside itself but not within itself, must die, ideality continually seeks out another real self-consciousness in order through this one to preserve its identity with itself. But since every real self-consciousness is subject to the same fate, contradiction and opposition penetrate right to the innermost core of this spirit. For real self-consciousness remains the necessary organ without which spirit cannot exist, but exposed as it is to infinite alteration it will never be able to take spirit up into itself; this incommensurable relation will then

persist in all eternity.

Since the matter stands thus, one cannot confuse the panlogistic Trinity with that of the Church. The God of panlogism is not our Father, ὁ μόνος ἔχων ἀθανασία, but an intoxicated God who cannot collect his scattered thoughts and reels drunkenly about among the scattered fragments of existence. Its Son of God is not the eternal Son, who declares of himself that he had glory with the Father before the world was, [142] but the son whom the Father begot, spurred on by the contradiction of ideality and reality, — who brings to nothing the hope of the Father grasping after existence, who mocks the nakedness of his abstract ideality and is therefore followed by the Father's curse. We know this spirit too, which is sent forth by such a Father and such a Son; it is the spirit of this world, which everywhere betrays the σκάνδαλον of the Father and of the Son. Its immanence is a contradiction, its reconciliation a horror. I, it says, wipe away all tears and still all pains. For in order to be seized by pain one must have the positive fullness of life in oneself, a fullness of life that suffers under a contradiction penetrating to the innermost; but were life completely negated, and had it only its negative outside itself, a sudden death would set in, and then there would be no pain; the painful life, dissolved and scattered in its innermost, thus remains equal to itself, and thus identity is preserved. Pain is the innermost root of human existence; for as soon as the human being gathers all his powers in order to intuit his own nature in complete clarity, ideality and reality coincide: there is a true identity of them, for precisely this constitutes life itself, but there is at the same time, as we have seen, a fundamental contradiction between them, and herewith the dissolution of life, and pain, are given. In this, then, consists sin, that the human being is carried away by love of life; but love of life begets fear of death, and this is precisely the punishment for the former; if, then, we are seized by both, we cannot doubt that sin and punishment interpenetrate, and that reconciliation consists precisely in this pain. Pain is the most perfect immanence of contradiction and identity, it is precisely the eternal spur to striving after eternal life, it is God's holiest mystery; pain is blessedness; — but it is a blessedness that recalls the Devil's roaring laughter! Human self-consciousness [143] hears it and shudders; for the more attentively it regards the elements of this realm, the more sharply and clearly it sees the contradiction of pain, in a thousand different

shapes, stream through all its individual parts. But when in this hell of darkness it hears the Church sing the praise of its Christ, who was crucified but rose from the grave and sits at the Father's right hand, behold! then he rises again, like the man who wakes from a dreadful dream and gladly greets the light of day; what draws him is not a calculating egoism that knows only how to seek its own, no, it is the objective power to which he gives himself with all his heart, the true longing for the true God, and he is no longer carried away by a blind passion, once he has thus experienced the bitter pain of the dialectical contradiction. Get thee hence, Satan, thou who deniest the holy! Unto us come the negation of the negation!

§ 22.

Return to the Church. Speculative Theology.

“Let hissing sound in serpents’ yard
That I am now laid waste;
I crown my year no less for that
With fruitfulness and harvest;
Yes! up I rise like ear in field,
Like May in beechen woods,
And splendid, amid song of birds,
Like golden sun from wave!”¹⁾

These words, with which the poet sings the victory of the Christian faith amid the various vicissitudes of the ages, resound not only in the life of the Church but also in science. Human reason moves in two opposite directions, from God to the world and to itself, from itself and the world to God. It was not, indeed, to be expected that this transition should take place calmly and without interruption in our sinful and finite world; but we nevertheless always see that reason, although it often seems to turn

¹⁾Grundtvig: Den christelige Tro.

altogether away from the truth of Christ, repents of this apostasy again once it has fully tasted its sorrowful consequences. — One must undeniably recognize panlogism as the highest stage of self-cognition to which abstract reason can attain, and one cannot rightly reproach it with unwillingness to return to positive life; but is it also the right way by which it returns to this? If there were no world order that could be negated, the human I would never be able to arrive at a development of the logical concepts either. But from this it follows that the system of concepts that panlogism sets up is only a formal one, that it everywhere lacks positive actuality and is at every point filled with a need, a longing, for this. And panlogism itself fully recognizes this. But it is precisely its *πρῶτον ψεῦδος* that it ascribes divine authority to this ideality and takes its impotence for omnipotence. For this ideality is nothing other than the shape of human reason itself. Yet the error lies not so much in its assuming an identity of divine and human reason as in its declaring the immanence of both to be immediately given in the latter. For an identity that does not rest upon an opposition is, according to the testimony of speculative logic, just as surely unstable and bad as a commingling of divine and human reason is, according to the testimony of the Church¹⁾, the true [145] mark of rationalism. Panlogism has a false God; it is therefore illogical (*ἄλογος*) if it does not go beyond itself; but it has a true logic and therefore needs only to take refuge in Christ in order to find a God of a truly logical nature. It itself declares that the way to immanence passes only through the greatest oppositions, but its own oppositions are of an all too light nature; if, therefore, it comes to a complete cognition of the logical principle that nothing can emerge in the conclusion which did not in actuality lie in the principle, it is also compelled to recognize that the opposition which shows itself in this world between the ideal and the real has its presupposition and ground in an immanence of both mediated from eternity, in other words, in a divine, uncreated reason, *qualitatively* different, as it is said, from our human reason. But once God's absolute freedom has thus been recognized, the whole relation between the positive moments and the logical categories is reversed; we then see that it is a positive divine power that has founded the whole of real existence and precisely thereby posited the ontological forms as immanent in things. We are then referred to

¹⁾How forcefully and acutely J. H. Fichte has combated this rationalism is well enough known.

the whole fullness of actual life, in which all figures must be considered as they meet us in life; and thus the moment of faith and of view again asserts its right. We then consider the human community in which we find ourselves, and through which the idea of eternal personality shines; we look to the divine founder of this community, who came forth in the fullness of time, when the law that had been given to the Jews had developed the consciousness of sin; we then recognize that God, by this way of revelation, has come forth as the Triune, and so on. It is contrary to reason to want to call some of these elements into doubt, with the thought of arriving, by means of other elements, at a dialectical necessity of that which is the object of doubt; for if one [146] really entertains doubt about one moment or another, one must also necessarily think the remaining positive moments with which it is connected in such a way that the doubt about the former lies hidden in their concept. It therefore helps but little against the deist to appeal to the revelation of Christ, since he has a one-sided concept of God. Nor, therefore, is theology to prove that it follows from God's Trinity that Christ, with dialectical necessity, had to reveal himself in this or that place; but since he has once revealed himself, theology must be able to conceive how this positive phenomenon of revelation hangs together with the other positive phenomena; this revelation is, as it were, a real thought that must be capable of being reconciled with the other real thoughts. The absolute presupposition of religious conceiving is therefore absolute faith, and so far is science from being injured by this inviolability of faith that it is rather only by its help that dialectical necessity and negation can penetrate all the elements of the system. As, therefore, abstract logic passes over into the positive elements, so on the other hand must the positive elements necessarily pass over into a concrete metaphysics and speculative empirical knowledge. When the objects are put together in an external manner, it is all over with science, and it has therefore almost become a common proverb that every philosophy ought to begin with doubting, although one ought rather to say: "with negating"; for doubt¹⁾ stands in opposition to [147] faith, but that negation and abstraction do not injure it we have already shown earlier. As, therefore, the positive moment of objectivity is absolutely preponderant in faith, so

¹⁾That an untruth lies hidden beneath this doubt, the philosophers have already acknowledged. Thus J. L. Heiberg: All true philosophy must unite both the mottoes cited by Mr. Martensen: the fear of God it must have in its heart, doubt in its eye. *Perseus* Nr. 1. P. 41.

through negation the absolute freedom of subjectivity returns, for all moments must be negated and tested in such a way that not a single phenomenon is left untouched¹⁾. What is cited as a merit of Hegel's logic, namely the great acuteness with which, through a thorough negation and contradiction, it sharpens the dialectical spur, we shall find the same also in dogmatics, if only we take the right path.

The mutual opposition of the individual moments has far greater depth in Christian dogmatics than in panlogism, and it is precisely thereby that the former leads to a true identity and reconciliation. Precisely because panlogism, in order to reach immanence, divided existence into two abstract parts, precisely for that reason it could not reach identity; Christian dogmatics, on the other hand, posits an absolute opposition between the truly triune God, complete in himself, and the created world; but through this fundamental contradiction a true reconciliation can come about between the peace of eternity and the struggles of temporality, since the knots that are tangled here are already untied there, in the principle itself.

In order to unite and reconcile all the ideas, panlogism sacrifices the individual self-consciousnesses and precisely thereby moves in an eternal opposition between reality and ideality; Christian dogmatics, on the other hand, ascribes to the individual self-
 [148] consciousnesses an inner infinite immanence in themselves, according to which they die, to be sure, *ad extra* (ὁ ἔξω ἄνθρωπος), but nonetheless *ad intra* (ὁ ἔσω ἄνθρωπος) preserve themselves for all eternity. But while it thus, as it were atomistically, separates them all from one another, gives the nature of sin the deepest development, and unshakably holds fast the ethical relation of opposition between God and man, it also penetrates to a true immanence of all these different moments, in that it develops the deepest concept of freedom, of conversion, and of love.

When panlogism would transfer to the whole human race what the Church ascribes to its Christ, without remembering on the one hand the inner, infinite fullness that is the essence of human self-consciousness, and on the other the mutual relation between Christ and the Holy Spirit, it mixes together in pitiable confusion moments that are really opposed to one another. Christian dogmatics, by contrast, ascribes to its Christ a perfect and absolute identity of God and man, and so far are the equal

¹⁾It is this testing that Sibbern requires when he demands: "an all-embracing debate of all against all."

right of the ideas and the identity of all from being disturbed by this, that rather the incorruptibility of life becomes the portion of all through the One, since the individual members of the body hang together organically with the head.

When, finally, panlogism, without knowing the true and actual mediation of the cosmic system, constantly has the word mediation in its mouth and assumes that the whole dialectical course of development has in actuality always been the same, as if the relation that obtains in our time between nature and subjective spirit were eternal, it seems to contradict itself in a remarkable way when it nevertheless promises a time when spirit and nature shall infinitely penetrate each other. Christian dogmatics, by contrast, although it proceeds from a true metaphysical identity of the divine will and the laws of nature, presents objective mediation in such a way that God on the one hand has made nature the foundation of subjective spirit and therefore also lets his ideas develop through the objective forms of nature, and on the other hand also transfigures nature in a peculiar manner by his presence, since sin had darkened human self-consciousness and given the worldly and profane moment an isolated development, from which it then follows that at times a sharp and actual opposition appears between the general divine governance and supernatural revelation, — a doctrine of mediation that contains a true presentation of God's essential accommodation to the peculiar character of different times and men. [149]

Human reason does not shun these actual oppositions and fundamental contradictions; for it recognizes that they all have their origin from, and their existence in, itself. As, therefore, the I of the regenerate man remains the same although an entirely new life is created in it, so too, far from the oppositions that penetrate and, as it were, dissolve human reason abolishing its identity with itself, it rather overcomes the contradiction of pain and attains reconciliation in proportion as it more and more immerses itself in and appropriates these oppositions. From this it becomes evident that created reason is in actuality determined and conceived through the uncreated, and that the mediation of the supernatural and natural moments takes place precisely through the absolute opposition; indeed, one can truly say that every sacred history, that is, every opposition between the pragmatic development of the world and the miracles, has precisely the task of leading to a reconciliation of those opposed

moments.

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§ 23.

Miracle and Sacred History.

As it is with revelation, so it is also with sacred history; the truth of revelation depends on the actuality of miracle, but this is developed through the cosmic *mediation* of things. For the inquiry into the actuality of miracle does not aim at showing that God's will has influence on nature; for there is an actual connection between God's activity and the forces of nature, and every time we move hand or foot we ourselves give an example of how thought has influence on the body; — but its aim is, as we have already remarked before, to demonstrate an immediate suspension of the opposition that exists between the divine counsels and the laws of nature.

All miracles thus seem contrary to reason, because God always works everywhere equally mediately and immediately; but such a presentation of the metaphysical relation is just as unsatisfactory as it would be if someone thought he had understood the concept of human freedom because he had observed that God works everything in man and that man is at the same time self-active. All such fundamental relations must necessarily unfold through the oppositions of temporality. Thus it becomes impossible to present a thorough mediation of divine and human relations without granting miracle a definite place.

Deism, which above all insists on a natural world order, is nevertheless itself compelled to appeal to one miracle as the starting point of its whole pragmatism, namely creation. The same holds of panlogism; for while it has discovered the moment
[151] of illusion in the Christian traditions, so that these no longer present God to us as immediately present, it nevertheless also concedes that objective spirit has been able to reach the standpoint of enlightenment that distinguishes our time solely and only through this standpoint of illusion. What is presented mediately in philosophy was thus immediately present in those narratives, so that the separation between ordinary events and the phenomena of revelation returns here again. The development of all

things thus has the aim of leading to a mutual immanence of nature and spirit at every point, so that the *mediate* and the *immediate* may everywhere coincide; but if this harmony is to become actual, the elements must first separate from one another, so that nature and spirit on the one hand each have their own peculiar points where they work in isolation, in order on the other hand, precisely by reason of this separation, to be able to penetrate each other mutually at other points.¹⁾

If, therefore, one considers the miracles in isolation, they seem contrary to reason; but the reason for this is precisely that the immediate is always determined by the mediate, just as the latter in turn is determined only by the former. If, on the other hand, they are considered in the general light of all that goes before them and follows [152] after them, they are of a logical nature and can consequently also be conceived. Miracle can therefore be called an anticipation of the relation which, according to the religious spirit, already obtains, metaphysically taken, and shall one day be seen realized, between created nature and the Creator. The God who appears in the miracle is therefore the same who is present in religious consciousness. Miracle is thus the very root of religion (we are speaking, namely, of the miracle that is the most important in each religion); it contains the peculiar moment of view whose inner essence the spirit of religion is more and more to unfold. Since miracle thus constitutes the very content of the spirit, the religious spirit itself must also waver as soon as doubt arises about the actuality of the miracle, and if it is discovered that the miracle is untrue, the spirit itself must as a consequence vanish and bow beneath a mightier spirit that is mediated through a truer actuality. That the panlogistic spirit cannot reconcile itself to the historical Christ¹⁾ therefore has its natural ground in the fact that it is not mediated through Christ; — if one considers its three main objections, this will easily

¹⁾An example of this mediate and immediate relation is offered by daily life itself: external nature is, namely, transformed more and more by the human spirit, but in a *mediate* manner. Therefore Strauß rightly says: . . . “sie (die Menschheit) ist der Wunderthäter: sofern im Verlauf der Menschengeschichte der Geist sich immer vollständiger der Natur, im Menschen wie außer demselben, bemächtigt, diese ihm gegenüber zum machtlosen Material seiner Thätigkeit heruntergesetzt wird. J. L. Schlußabhandl. § 149 Pag. 767.

But this mediate activity is bound up with the immediate and real connection that obtains between soul and body; and if one would now call this mythical, one would also have to call all narratives of such works myths.

¹⁾Cf. Strauß L. J. Pag. 766.

become evident. For it denies, first, the possibility of an individual union of God and man, because it does not know the inner fullness of the individual consciousness; but the reason for this ignorance we have already stated above. It remarks, next, that it would conflict with the nature of the Idea as such to enrich and exalt one particular organ at the expense of the other organs; but here it does not take due account of the real moment of mediation (cf. § 22). And when it finally objects that Christ, as an individual phenomenon, is neither more nor less than what presents itself to us in his phenomenal existence¹⁾, we remark on this that existence cannot be considered from its sensuous side alone, — for from that one would merely extract the contradiction that the sensuous is not the spiritual; if, on the other hand, it is understood to mean that there lies nothing else in the phenomenon than what can be derived by a negation of the phenomenon, then precisely a spiritual interpretation becomes necessary; but what extent this is to have, the Spirit alone can teach us. There thus arises an intimate connection between Christ and the Holy Spirit: what lies *implicite* in Christ, the Spirit sets forth *explicite*. The Spirit would thus not have presented the idea of eternal personality to us in the Church, had not the infinite fullness of the Godhead (πᾶν τὸ πλήρωμα τῆς θεότητος) dwelt in Christ. Therefore Christ nowhere says that the Holy Spirit will one day come of its own prompting and teach that he himself was only a vanishing individual; but he promises that the Spirit shall come from the Father in his name, and adds: “When the Spirit of truth comes, he shall guide you into truth. For he shall not speak of his own, but what he hears, that shall he speak, and the things to come he shall proclaim to you. He shall glorify me; for he shall receive of mine and proclaim it to you. All that the Father has is mine. Therefore I said that he shall take of mine and proclaim it to you.” (John 16, 13—15). There are therefore two fundamental miracles in the Christian religion, the *Incarnation* and the *Inspiration*.

When the disciples at first gathered around Christ, already then it was in truth the Spirit that unconsciously drew them, but only in that it shone forth immediately

¹⁾Allein, wie Schmid gründlich nachgewiesen hat, ein geschichtliches Individuum ist eben nur das, was von ihm erscheint; sein inneres Wesen wird in seinen Reden und Handlungen erkannt; zu seiner Eigenthümlichkeit gehört die Bedingtheit durch Zeit- und Volksverhältnisse mit, und was hinter dieser Erscheinung als An sich zurückliegt, ist nicht das Wesen dieses Individuums, sondern die allgemeine menschliche Natur überhaupt, welche in den Einzelnen, durch Individualitet, Zeit und Umstände beschränkt, zur Wirklichkeit kommt. Strauß L. J. Pag. 740

from the Savior's own person; therefore Philip, with the words "Come and see!", calls on Nathanael, who doubts that the Messiah can come from Nazareth, to follow him (John 1, 47). Yet only when the apostles, after having received the necessary religious preparatory formation in their life together with Christ and through his oral teaching, had seen his death, — when he, glorified after the resurrection, had stood before their beholding gaze as it were on the boundary between the heavenly and the earthly kingdom, presenting to them in his essence the individual and the universal in true unity, — when he finally, lifted up to heaven after giving them the promise of the Comforter who was to come, had left them for a time to their own reflections: only then was it that there revealed itself immediately the sending of the Spirit in the miracle of Pentecost, prepared by a true mediation within them. Christ's external phenomenon was negated, and the interpreter who already lay hidden in their consciousness came forth suddenly into the full light of consciousness. As, therefore, Christ had previously been revealed in his glory in the external world, so now for the first time he was present in perfect glory in the inner kingdom of consciousness. This relation between Christ's immediate presence and the immediate activity of the Spirit sent by him gives precisely the apostolic age its peculiar character. If, therefore, one considers Christ's life in its entirety, one will easily find that mutual relation again. For just as his public life belongs most nearly to the phenomenal actuality of history, so that the moment of view is here preponderant, but the true understanding [155] and development of it is first given by the Spirit, so his glory with the Father reveals itself most nearly to the searching spirit, but the truth of the appropriation of this revelation is in turn conditioned by the believing reception of the teaching about his life here on earth. Christ's entry into the world and his exit from it are thus forms of revelation that by the nature of the case hover between phenomenal actuality and spiritual ideality: anyone who does not believe in the Spirit mistreats history.

From this it is also evident that the reconciliation of the world, too, must be referred to Christ's sacred history, rightly understood. For the reconciliation has been accomplished in that Christ underwent the harshest oppositions of life and came forth victorious from the struggle. Just as the natural man enters this world in such a way that he has darkness behind him, so that he does not know whence he comes, and just

as he must pass through the hard trial of the struggle against all the contradictions of life and death without knowing whither he goes, so conversely Christ, who is the way and the truth and the life, goes forth from the kingdom of eternal light, reveals God's presence in the world of pain, while his divine spirit always remains like itself, and wanders through the darkness of death back to the kingdom of glory. ("I came forth from the Father and am come into the world; I leave the world again and go to the Father."). He thus not only shows individual men the way, but also reveals the true history of the whole world.

But just as the miracle of inspiration is mediated through the individual Christ, so the apostolic age also prepares the subsequent formation of the Church.

[156] For it presents to us, on the one hand, a fixed and unchangeable image of Christ, so that Scripture utters its "Come and see!" to anyone who longs to see Christ; but on the other hand it leads beyond itself to another form of the Church. All the institutions of the Church aim, namely, at developing the idea of freedom more and more, so that human consciousness, reflected into itself, may through the cognition of its own nature seek, find, and thoroughly appropriate God. That our time cannot show any miracle is thus so far from grounding any suspicion against the truth of the miracles of the apostolic age that we must rather turn the matter around and say that the miracles of that age precisely explain to us the reason why no miracles take place in our time.

The manifold fluctuation that takes place in the Church in the course of the ages between real objectivity and abstract ideality, as they alternately succeed each other and pass over into each other, serves to reconcile the concept and the view with each other ever more truly and inwardly. If, therefore, one of these moments becomes preponderant at one time or another, we always see the other emerge and moderate it.

For the dialectical development always proceeds in such a way that on the one hand spirit is formed through a negation of the phenomena of life, and on the other these are developed and explained by it; as, therefore, the spirit is, so also is the explication and interpretation of the phenomena. Therefore the Apostle's words: "Beloved, believe not every spirit, but try the spirits whether they are of God!" sound constantly through the Church. But that which tries the spirit is precisely the spirit itself, for of the spirit it holds: "*verum est index sui et falsi*". Therefore the spirit of abstract freedom and

personality will always come forth victorious from the trial. — It will then be clear from this that the principle in sacred history is God's true, real accommodation. God, conscious from eternity of his absolute freedom, formed the counsel to develop a [157] human freedom and personality; therefore all such phenomena as men cannot but take for definite manifestations of divine assistance, aimed at the realization of that counsel, must also necessarily be taken as having in actuality belonged to the divine counsels. If, therefore, the sacred phenomena are considered in the light of such an accommodation, one must also ascribe actuality to them in the deepest sense of this word. For if such phenomena are considered in and for themselves, they are by their nature adequate expressions neither of the things that belong to the temporal life nor of those that belong to the eternal. For insofar as the supernatural things are revealed, they must also find expression in phenomena that belong to our empirical knowledge, and thus put on forms that are incongruous with their own nature; and although they descend into our sphere, the phenomena in which they are revealed must nonetheless be glorified in a peculiar way so as not to be confused with other, ordinary events, or — the descent of the essence into the lower sphere must at the same time be the elevation of the phenomenon into the higher sphere. Therefore illusion, too, is always a necessary moment in every temporal phenomenon of revelation. — The actuality of the sacred phenomena therefore always presupposes a peculiar governance by God. When men see a peculiar and wondrous phenomenon (τὸ τέρας), they conclude from it that God will make known to them his immediate presence (τὸ σημεῖον); if this conclusion is false, even the most exalted phenomenon remains without effect; if, on the other hand, it holds as true, the hovering, double nature of the phenomenon puts no obstacle in the way of the working of revelation. For it is God's supernatural power that gives the phenomenon its peculiar stamp; and that it does not fully express the essence itself stems from his accommodating himself to [158] man's power of comprehension. It is thus without significance for the truth of the miracle whether the angel Gabriel revealed himself to Mary as it were at one stroke, or whether she, through the cooperation of God's Spirit, only later saw presentiments that from the beginning had merely stirred in the innermost depths of the virginal soul rendered visible in complete clarity. For Gabriel, invisible by nature, becomes

visible at God's command, in order to give us a representation of Christ's supernatural conception. Gabriel is only a serving instrument in God's hand. — The same holds also of the cloud that, according to the account of Scripture, surrounded Christ when he ascended into heaven. For the cloud formed a visible transition from the earthly to the heavenly kingdom. One can then say with as much right that it existed as that it did not exist; it is therefore indifferent with regard to the truth of the miracle whether it consisted in the transformation taking place visibly in the external world, or whether God's Spirit merely presented the phenomenon in this form to the thoughts of the apostles, provided only that it stands firm that God has been a truthful and not a misleading spirit. One can thus quite well hold different opinions about the origin and formation of the phenomena and nonetheless have the most unshakable faith in their full actuality. But this difference of opinion is not on that account dependent on our subjective discretion; for we ought to take account of vulgar empirical knowledge *ad extra* just as much as of God's actual and true accommodation *ad intra*.

The older Church insisted one-sidedly on God's objective activity, but thus did not give human freedom its full due. For the miracle of inspiration was developed in a sensualistic manner, if we may say so, so that the activity of the Holy Spirit was placed [159] not so much in the interpretation of the events that had taken place as in the faithful recollection of them; as, therefore, the Spirit had suppressed the self-activity of the apostles, so now also ecclesiastical faith sought to bring reason into bondage. Criticism has taught us that revelation did not take place in so slavish a manner. For just as the religious relation between God and men first becomes true through the moral exertion of the latter, so also inspiration has freed the consciousness of the apostles in such a way that they could pass a freer judgment on the events that had taken place. And so far is the truth of revelation from being weakened by the discrepancy between the individual moments of sacred history that it is rather strengthened by it. For had Christ not descended from his glory with the Father into the realm of everyday experience, that is, into the frailty of our existence, he would not have been a true man (υἱός τοῦ ἀνθρώπου); he would then have remained standing in the clouds, like the Son of Man in the prophet Daniel's vision (*Bar enash*), and we should then have to call his earthly life an apparent existence (δοκεῖσμος). But by thus appearing

in the realm of phenomena he has given the spirit freedom to gather the scattered moments of experience into the Idea's own clear, intuitible totality. Here, then, the old maxim also holds, that disagreement in what is inessential confirms agreement in what is essential, so that we have before us not an ingenious fiction but an actual revelation. And just as the Spirit asserted its freedom to create the forms — so that the same divine honor belongs to the Holy Spirit as to the Son —, so it also granted the apostles and the apostolic age freedom to present the same truth in different words. It regenerated the apostles, to be sure, but did not sanctify them at one stroke, so that every manifestation of the frailty of the human will suddenly became impossible for [160] them; it enlightened their spirit, to be sure, but not in such a way that it suddenly removed every subjective one-sidedness or error from them. — Scripture's depiction of the sacred phenomena therefore contains at once the divine truth in its highest actuality and the freest, purely subjective movements in the consciousness of the sacred writers; the sacred phenomena are not either the one or the other, but are precisely only in the intimate mutual transition of both these moments into each other, and cannot be determined by any external boundary whatsoever.

But a revelation and tradition for whose whole economy freedom is the principle naturally cannot be appropriated before the true method of freedom has been found. Now since the older Church and criticism sought to appropriate the supernatural idea by holding fast the phenomena by themselves, it followed as a matter of course that they could only infer by analogy and careful analysis of the individual moments. From this it followed that on the one hand the older faith had to insist on the verbal agreement of the narratives, and on the other criticism had more and more to extend its doubt to the miracles in general as soon as it had discovered discrepancy in particulars; *for if the lesser miracles cannot stand the test of inquiry, how much less can the greater.* But this positivism and probabilism is abolished at the root when, through the negation of the phenomena, we penetrate to the Idea itself: we then also hold unshakably fast to the fundamental miracles, in order to be able to consider the more special miracles in their light. The restoration of the phenomenon of Christ must then take place in such a way that the individual narratives of his life each keep their place, in order thus each in its own way to reveal the idea of the Incarnation. We thus return again [161]

to the ecclesiastical image of Christ, but in such a way that, after having subjected its individual traits to a separate analysis, we see that the same Christ whom the Church believed it could behold in the external realm of everyday experience must not be considered outside the mirror of the Spirit.

Inspiration as such ceased, to be sure, but the Holy Spirit continues its life in the Church: amid all the vicissitudes of time it fights with might against the spirit of this world; whenever sacred history is distorted, it is the Spirit that anew refreshes, vindicates, and by its divine light transfigures the Church's divine image of Christ; and it will continue to illuminate it until the moments of the concept and of the view fully penetrate each other; — until Christ is revealed in his glory and his voice sounds to all: "Come and see!"

Conclusion.

If one grants the truth of the development we have thus given, one will also agree with us in taking the speculative treatment of sacred history to be the only true one.

On the one hand it preserves the positive character, for in the recognition that objective reason cannot be conceived except through a careful observation of the given objects, it receives with joy the treasures that the learned have gathered, and leaves none of the investigations of criticism unheeded. But on the other hand speculative theology well knows how to distinguish between the apparatus of science and science [162] itself; therefore it follows with care all philosophical investigations; not in blind adherence to this or that system, but in order, as the teacher of abstract philosophy, after careful testing of each of its systems, to lead created reason back to its true dependence on uncreated reason, and through this reconciliation of both to interpret the phenomena of religion. — It is far from all craving for novelty; for its endeavor aims precisely at bringing to light all the true moments that are found in the older systems. But above all it demands a true transition from one sphere of cognition to the other

and an inner dialectical connection between the individual parts; it therefore rejects every mixing together of opposed elements, disdains all the artifices of eclecticism, and flees the mediocrity of the bad middle way.